exposures

Photography and Cinema

David Campany



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Contents

Introduction 7

one Stillness 22

two Paper Cinema 60

three Photography in Film 94

four Art and the Film Still 119

Afterword 146

References 148
Select Bibliography 154
Acknowledgements 156
Photo Acknowledgements 157
Index 158

‘ . . . everything starts in the middle . . . ’
Graham Lee, 1967

Introduction

Opening Movement

On 11 June 1895 the French Congress of Photographic Societies (Congrès des sociétés photographiques de France) was gathered in Lyon. Photography had been in existence for about sixty years, but cinema was a new invention. Louis and Auguste Lumière had just been granted a patent for their Cinématographe, the first movie camera and projection system. Louis, who worked for the family's photography business, was there to demonstrate it. A boat trip to Neuville-sur-Saône had been arranged for the photographers and Louis set up his camera to record them. He filmed as they came down the narrow gangway onto the quayside. The Lumières made several films of people filing past their camera, including one of workers leaving their factory, the first film to be screened publicly.[1] The subject matter was ideal: endlessly different figures passing through a fixed frame express so much so simply, about photographs in motion.

The photographers had heard of the Cinématographe and were keen to see it. In the film, which is less than a minute long, some smile self-consciously as they pass, others wave their hats. One man, looking more serious, clutches a large plate camera to his chest. He slows down as he passes, takes a quick photo of Louis and the movie camera and rejoins the flow.[2] The whereabouts of his snapshot is unknown. He may have not actually taken one. Perhaps what really mattered was the filming of the gesture, the first footage of a still photographer 'in action'. Louis was not bluffing. In fact, those photographers were the first to see the film when it was developed and projected for them the following day.

What might they have thought of what they saw? Was the Cinématographe something familiar and agreeable or radically different? What effect would it have on photography? What purpose might it serve? Was it competition? Was it a novelty or would it last? And what was the meaning of that moment when Louis was photographed and the photographer was filmed? It passes in seconds but its enigma remains. Was it a friendly affirmation that photographer and filmmaker were essentially the same, or a realization of profound difference? Was this cinema affirming a debt to photography or distancing itself? The questions must have been felt acutely. Whatever curiosity or trepidation the photographers experienced as they were filmed would have been compounded as they watched their encounter played back in real time.

Of course, we can trace the depiction of movement in images as far back as we like, via the perceptual revolutions wrought by railway travel, optical toys, theatre, panoramas and narrative painting, back to the shadows flickering on the wall of Plato's cave, but there is no particular origin. The Lumières' film is a good enough place for us to begin here. Not only was it the first meeting of photography and cinema, it was also a meeting that seemed to take place on cinema's terms. This book is at heart a reflection on what cinema has done for, or to, still photography. It looks at the influences of cinema – aesthetic, intellectual and technical. It looks at the influence of the moving image on the social function of photographs. It looks at questions of cinematic time and motion and how they have reconfigured photographic stillness.



1 *Arrivée des congressistes à Neuville-sur-Saône* [The Photographic Congress Arrives in Neuville-sur-Saône]. (Louis and Auguste Lumière, 1895), frame.

From One to the Other

Photography has been more dispersed than any other medium, including film. Almost from the beginning it was put to use across the spectrum of the arts and sciences. In fact, it spread so quickly that getting a grip on the particular nature of photography soon proved difficult, and it has remained so. How can one unite under a single identity images as varied as passport photos, advertising, topographic studies, family snaps, medical records, news pictures and police documents? Faced with such

diversity, definitions of photography have tended to rely upon comparison and contrast. Painting, literature, sculpture, theatre and cinema have offered different ways to consider what photography is. Not surprisingly, different ideas have emerged. Painting puts the emphasis on questions of description and actuality. Literature puts the emphasis on realism and expression. Sculpture emphasizes matters of volume and flatness. Theatre emphasizes the performative. Cinema tends to emphasize aspects of duration and the frame (I am simplifying, of course). Such approaches are unavoidable and we see them in all kinds of discussion of photography, both popular and specialist.

Perhaps the first great attempt to bring cinema and photography together for mutual definition was the ambitious *Film und Foto* exhibition held in Stuttgart in 1929.[3] It was organized by the Deustsche Werkbund, which had grown out of the Arts and Crafts movement at the turn of the century in pursuit of the reconciliation of art and technology. By the end of the 1920s film had established itself as a medium of popular entertainment and news. Photography had also become a mass medium via the illustrated press. Meanwhile, artistic photography was emerging from its fawning imitation of painting to pursue a modern independence of sorts, while seeking more progressive alignments, particularly with film.



2 Poster for the *Film und Foto* exhibition, Stuttgart, 1929. Anonymous.

The show drew together nearly a thousand photographs, including images of old Paris by Eugène Atget; the Dada and political photomontages of John Heartfield and Hannah Höch; the New Vision photographs of Germaine Krull, Aenne Biermann, Albert Renger-Patzsch and László Moholy-Nagy; the crisp formalism of the Americans Brett and Edward Weston; camera-less abstract images by Man Ray; photo-text graphics by Piet Zwart, El Lissitzky and Karel Teige; and portrait, fashion, industrial, scientific, sports and news photography.[4] In other words, *Film und Foto* characterized photography through its breadth. In addition, there was a film festival programmed by Hans Richter displaying the vanguard cinema of Europe, Soviet Russia and North America, including the work of Charlie Chaplin, René Clair, Sergei Eisenstein, Vsevolod Pudovkin, Dziga Vertov, Robert Wiene and Carl Theodor Dreyer. Some practitioners showed their photographs *and* films. Indeed, one of the aims of *Film und Foto* was to highlight how central the photographic sensibility was to the

development of avant-garde film, a trend that continued for several decades. Moholy-Nagy, Man Ray, Francis Bruguière, Paul Strand and Charles Sheeler, along with later figures such as Helen Levitt, William Klein, Robert Frank and Ed van der Elsken, made significant contributions both to photography and film.[5] Most often they made moving equivalents of their still photographic work, producing multi-layered film essays. Against mainstream cinema, avant-garde film evolved across the middle decades of the twentieth century as an anti-narrative poetics. Its preference was for the expressive montage of fragments, resisting the presentation of seamless stories. Photography has forever struggled with narrative, as we shall see in the coming chapters, but this predisposed it towards an alliance with avant-garde film.

While *Film und Foto* made clear this connection, in other respects the event was not the great unifying force that was intended. Critics and historians of cinema see the event primarily as a landmark showcase for the advanced film of the time, while historians of photography see *Film und Foto* as a defining moment for their medium.[6] Part of the problem was the complete difference in modes of display and attention. The photography was hung in exhibition spaces, while the films were shown in a separate cinema. This did not cohere as a visual experience, even though audiences of the 1920s already moved easily at an imaginative level between the photographic and the filmic. We might contrast this with today's situation in which exhibition spaces have become a context for all the arts, including film. For example, recently at Tate Modern in London, Moholy-Nagy's hybrid work *Light-Space Modulator* (1930) could be viewed in all its forms in one room, as a sculpture, as a film and as photographs. Online at home I can view the photos and play the film on the same screen. Even so, conceptualizing the relationship between photography and film remains complex. Should one proceed on the grounds of a shared technical base? Shared aesthetic concerns? Shared cultural aims? Or are the differences just as defining?

An obvious way to think about the relation is to weigh up what their mechanisms do and do not have in common. But stressing the apparatuses over their social uses or their aesthetic dimensions will give us only a partial account. In as much as photography and film depend upon the

making of optical impressions of the world, both require subject matter. In fact, we might say that photography and film are almost meaningless without subject matter. They are to a great extent the sum of the kinds of images we have chosen to make with them. In this sense it is almost impossible to separate what we think photography and film *are* from what we think they are *for*. If, for example, we think of photography as a medium for 'capturing moments', 'treasuring memories' or 'recording facts' (all familiar, even clichéd uses), does this mean that these functions are inherent in the medium, or is it that these are roles that have been given to photography for a long period of its history? Similarly, if we think film is a medium of movement and narrative, is this a technical definition or a description of its more familiar applications? It is this interplay of the technical and the social that has fundamentally shaped how photography and film have developed. The capturing of moments and recording of visual facts were potentials of photography that shaped everything from camera manufacture to the expectations of their users. Film did not have to become the commercial mass medium of popular narrative cinema, but a significant part of it did, and in doing so it shaped the direction of its evolution and the viewing habits of its audiences.

When the film theorist Christian Metz attempted to map out the fundamental relation between photography and film, he noted that they share a technical similarity while having different relations to time, framing and objecthood.[7] For Metz, the photograph belongs inextricably to the past, while film always seems to unfold in the present tense as we watch. Film is a virtual, immaterial projection, while the photograph is a fixed image and a fixed object. As such, the photo is capable of becoming a kind of fetish, standing in for the absent subject or moment. By contrast, film, in its orchestration of the viewer's desire through the fullness of its unfolding, is closer in structure to voyeurism. It is easy to identify with this line of thought, but what is at stake here are not so much the differences or similarities between film and photography per se (if such things exist), but between film in its popular narrative form as presented in the cinema and the photograph as domestic snapshot or mnemonic aid. Film is not inherently narrative or popular. Photography is not inherently domestic or a snapshot. The analysis starts off general and technical but soon



3 *Decasia: the State of Decay* (Bill Morrison, 2002), frame.

becomes a particular account of quite specific social uses of the still and the moving image. Even so, such a binary approach remains useful, not least because it prompts us to look for exceptions. For example, can a film be grasped as a material object? In the era of home DVD perhaps it can. And as important archives of old movies shot on nitrate stock begin to rot away perhaps they too are becoming more object-like than they were ever intended to be. Bill Morrison's elegiac *Decasia* (2002) shows us just this. It is a film that records the fading away of old and almost forgotten movies, turning their chemical breakdown into a memento mori.

We can grasp this relation between the technical and the cultural more clearly with some further examples. Hiroshi Sugimoto's photographs of movie theatres take in entire films. He sets up his large-format camera at the back of cinemas and leaves the shutter open while a whole movie is projected. The camera lacks our physiological capacity to register those flashing images as motion, or even as time passing. The result is an image of a bleached-out screen of over-exposure, the trace of hundreds of thousands of still photographs projected 24 per second. On one level Sugimoto's simple method enables us to think about film and photography as machines involving speed, light, exposure, projection, duration and motion. At the same time light bouncing off the screens illuminates



4 Hiroshi Sugimoto, *Plaza New York*, 1977. Black and white photograph.

the movie theatres, showing us all the architectural details we are ordinarily encouraged to forget as we watch a film. Sugimoto has made dozens of such photographs across North America in everything from Art Deco movie palaces to modern multiplexes and drive-ins. So on top of that technical meditation his photos also offer a kind of sociology of one country's cinema-going, in all its particularity.

For his first feature film the director Federico Fellini made a light-hearted but perceptive comment on stillness, movement and the depiction of stories. *The White Sheikh* (1952) revolves around the making of

fotoromanzi. These were quickly produced photo-stories printed as cheap magazines for post-war movie audiences (see chapter Two). At one point we see what looks like a regular film crew setting up on a beach. They are about to shoot a scene in which the White Sheikh – a chubby and pale imitation of the silent movie heart-throb Rudolph Valentino – slays his foe and rescues a 'damsel in distress'. A frantic director readies his ragbag crew and marshals his performers, none of whom can get jobs in the real film industry. They begin to play the scene when suddenly, in a comic reversal of cinematic action, the director shouts 'Hold it!' The performers freeze as if in a party game. A stills photographer takes a single shot. The performers spring back into movement and continue the scene. Sometimes they pose themselves or halt when the director yells.[8] To draw out the absurdity Fellini modelled the photo-shoot very closely on film-making, playing it as a battle between the humble snapshot and the juggernaut of cinema's momentum, as if a photographer were trying to take photos during an actual movie shoot. Photography is shown as a poor relation of cinema, one that serves it as an imitator and handmaiden, which in many respects it already was by the 1950s. Fellini returned to



5 *The White Sheikh* (Federico Fellini, 1952), still.





6 A 'paparazzi' shot of actress Anita Ekberg arriving in Rome from her native Sweden in 1959 for the shooting of Federico Fellini's *La Dolce Vita*.

7 *La Dolce Vita* (1960), publicity still of the starlet Sylvia, played by Anita Ekberg, arriving in Rome for a shoot.

the idea in *La Dolce Vita* (1960). Famously, the film describes the newly emerging class of photographers (one of whom is called Paparazzo) who made their living taking candid shots of celebrities to sell to trashy magazines. In the scene in which Anita Ekberg plays a movie starlet arriving in Rome to shoot a film, the media greet her as she disembarks from the plane. But it is not the pack of hungry paparazzi to which she gives her attention. She singles out the lens of the sole news movie camera in their midst, giving it all her best gestures. The photographers are left to grab what they can, even though their role in the publicity game is so vital.

Fellini was not the first to depict the relation between photography and cinema in this way. We see it in Will Connell's book *In Pictures: A Hollywood Satire* (1937). In one image a film cameraman is shot from below as a towering colossus commanding all before him. By contrast, the 'stills

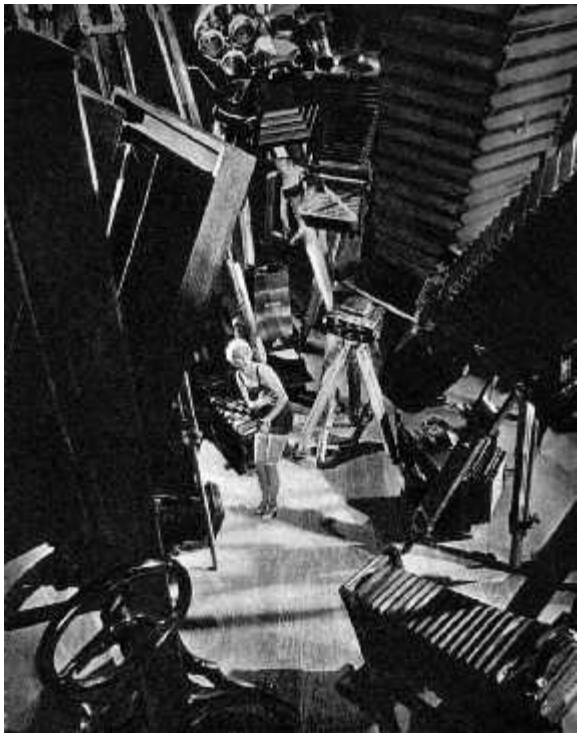




8, 9 and 10 *Cameraman*, *Stills Man* and *Find* by Will Connell from his book *In Pictures: A Hollywood Satire* (New York, 1937).

man' taking shots on set is a lowly functionary scuttling through the legs of others. But in a third image a crowd of giant stills cameras dwarfs a hopeful starlet. Even earlier, in *The Cameraman* (Edward Sedgwick, 1928), Buster Keaton plays a news photographer losing out in love and work to the movie newsreel cameramen who were already beginning to soak up photographers' opportunities. The pecking order is clear.

It is a view that many photographers would accept. Beyond any aesthetic preference for stillness over movement what appeals to them is photography's relatively simple working procedure. In an exchange between the photographic artist Jeff Wall and the filmmaker Mike Figgis, Wall remarked: 'I tend to think of filmmakers as gigantic people, capable of mammoth achievements, and so the making of a "movie" in the conventional sense, which has serious artistic qualities, always strikes me as an almost superhuman accomplishment.'[9] Nevertheless, the distinction



has never been entirely clear-cut. Wall himself has made complex staged photographs at the scale of cinema (see chapters Two and Four), while Figgis is one of several directors who have experimented with digital video cameras and minimal crews, seeking the lightness and independence we associate with footloose photographers.

In the 1960s Andy Warhol took cinema away from narrative and motion and close to the stillness of photography. His first film, comprising six hours of a sleeping man, was an almost pure expression of time passing, ending in a freeze frame (*Sleep*, 1963). His *Screen Tests* (1964–6) were single-take short films of friends and celebrities. The 'sitters' remained before his 16mm movie camera for four minutes, the length of a film spool. Often Warhol would simply walk away leaving the camera rolling and the sitter to do as they wished: sit bored, stare into the camera, flirt with it, pose as if being photographed, or act up. The films were lit like *noir*-ish film stills or more flatly like a passport photo booth, which Warhol also used to make simple time-lapse portraits. Unsure as to quite what the *Screen Tests* were, Warhol toyed with calling them Living Portrait Boxes, Film Portraits or even 'Stillies' (rather than 'movies').

For Warhol, 'The great stars are the ones who are doing something you can watch every second, even if it is just a movement in their eye.'[10] He soon concluded that the attention of the movie camera could make anything a star, even the Empire State Building. Asked what he hoped to do in films, he replied: 'Well, just find interesting things and film them.'[11] What mattered was duration, the passing of cinematic time. The *viewer's* movement as they adjust to what they see was more important than any depicted movement.

Cinema's 'long take' may strike us as boldly photographic and it is often described as such. Even so, when asked about the difference between a photograph of a static object and a film of it, Jean Cocteau

replied that in the film 'time courses through it'. Even mainstream cinema has within its grammar the long take of immobility (think of the classic establishing shot, or pensive spaces awaiting movement, such as railway platforms and empty rooms). The Japanese director Yasujiro Ozu punctuated his films with the real-time shots of almost static subjects: a breeze on grass, rippling water, trembling trees, an unoccupied bed or just an object, like a vase. In his analysis of cinematic time Gilles Deleuze noted:

> At the point where the cinematographic image directly confronts the photo, it also becomes radically distinct from it. Ozu's still lifes endure, have a duration, over ten seconds of the vase: this duration of the vase is precisely the representation of that which endures, through the succession of changing states.[12]

The remark is from his taxonomy of cinema that maps in detail the changing ways that cinema understood and shaped movement and time across the twentieth century. Deleuze offers an extraordinarily rich framework for thinking about film's protean form that makes photography seem impoverished by contrast. Of course, to an extent it is, because it is deprived of so many of the resources of cinema. And more often than not film theorists tend to see photography as a raw and elemental unit, awaiting cinematic articulation as one of 24 per second.[13] Yet, away from cinema we can see that photography has always had its own complex engagement with time and movement. Think of the 'decisive moment', the pregnant moment, the constructed tableau, flash photography and the long exposure, to name of few of its different temporalities. To these we could add all the procedures of assembly so central to the development of photography: the album, the archive, the diary, the photo-novel, the photo essay, sequences, juxtapositions, montage, collage, the slideshow and all the new modes opened up by electronic technologies (see chapter One). The time and movement of photography deserve an analysis every bit as sophisticated as those extended to film.



11 Andy Warhol, *Empire* (1964) ?16mm film, black and white, silent, 8 hours, 6 minutes (approx.), frames.

12 Andy Warhol, *Mary Woronov*, black and white photo booth strip, 1964.



13 *Screen Test (Susan Sontag)* (Andy Warhol, 1964). 16mm black and white, 4 mins (approx), frame.

Where To Start

Studies such as this book are pieced together from fragments, and the work of assembly usually begins somewhere in the middle. I 'began' with one of the Lumières' films, but what really prompted this book was not the invention of cinema, or photography, but an image from a point halfway between the invention of cinema and today. It also comes from halfway between photography and cinema. It is a publicity still from *Rear Window* (1954), Alfred Hitchcock's film about a photojournalist stuck in his apartment with a broken leg, his girlfriend and a murder.

We will come to the film soon enough, but first let us consider the still. The man in the wheelchair with the camera is the actor James Stewart playing L. B. Jeffries, a New York photojournalist who works for magazines such as *Life* and *Look*. These magazines offered a mix of entertainment and news. Along with reportage photography arranged as photo-stories they carried publicity for movies in the form of advertisements, portraits and previews. Film stills such as this one and the reportage of the kind made by Jeffries may strike us as opposites. On the whole, popular cinema was and remains escapist fantasy, while the subject of reportage is actuality, the real events of the world. But each in its own way had to solve the same two problems: visual clarity and narrative stillness. Film stills achieved it through the group effort of staging and the detail afforded by large-format cameras. Reportage took another route: a picture taking rather than making, reliant upon speed, lightness and economy of expression (see chapter One). Where the film still remodelled motion, reportage used fast shutter speeds to freeze it. Each sought to secure detail and master time in their own ways. Both pursued 'the blurred parts of pictures'.[14] The woman in the still is the actress Grace Kelly playing Lisa Fremont, who works for a fashion magazine. The couple are looking intently for evidence of a murder. But they are not looking into the courtyard where the action takes place. If they were, we would see only their backs. For our convenience they look out of the right of the frame. *We* can see the courtyard and in the windows the various characters from the film – some newly-weds, a lonely spinster, a dancer, an artist, a group of musicians and a murderer. The time of the film has



14 *Rear Window* (Alfred Hitchcock, 1954).

been compressed so that they are all there for us at once, as if in a gallery. We cannot actually look at them all at once, but we can roam around the picture at our own pace. (In fact, this is just how the film opens, with a long take that moves around the courtyard and the apartment). The photojournalist is hunting a single moment perhaps, but we get the whole scenario in a different kind of photograph with a different sense of time, closer to the tableau. It is an image not so much 'from' *Rear Window* as 'of' it, as a whole.

This image could only be a film still. It looks like nothing else, except perhaps the kind of contemporary art photograph that is indebted to

cinema. We recognize something unique in its qualities while knowing that those qualities are themselves a mix of codes derived not just from cinema and photography but also painting and theatre. It is a distinctive combination of unoriginal parts. The still also presents in compressed form many of the concerns of this study. The first chapter is a brief history of stillness, looking at what it meant for photography and film across the twentieth century. Chapter Two takes up the fact that photographs have been made to work in relation to each other often on the printed page, as sequences and series, as stories and anti-stories. Chapter Three looks at the way cinema thinks about photographs and photographers, while Chapter Four reflects on the place of cinema and the film still in contemporary art photography.

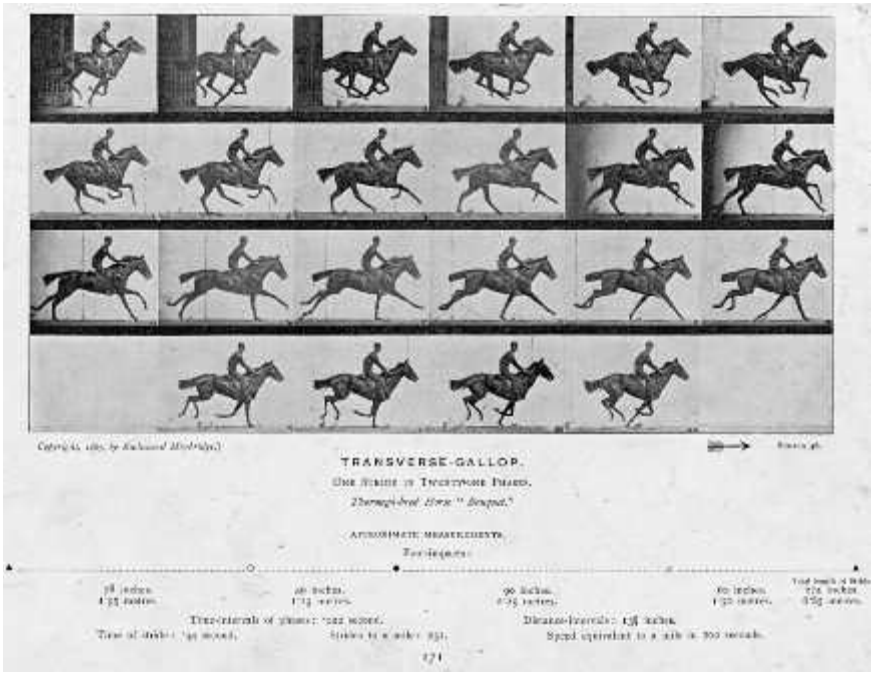
This is a relatively small book about a large subject. As such, it is not an exhaustive encyclopaedia. The aim is to offer a framework for thinking about the profound interrelation of photography and cinema and the equally profound differences. The reader is free to reshuffle the theories and images discussed into a history of sorts. There is certainly a history here, but chronology has not been the primary aim. Rather, the approach is thematic.

one

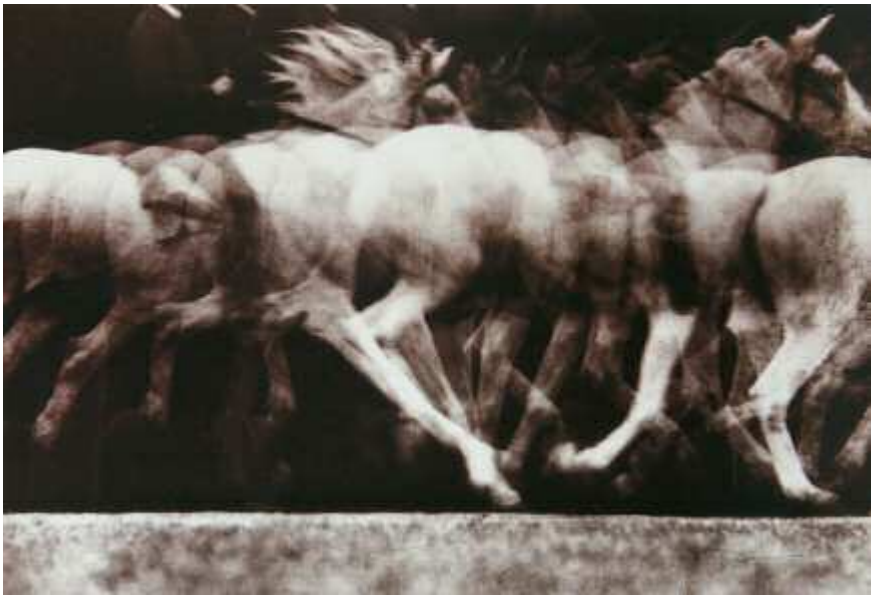
Stillness

Photography preceded cinema, but does this imply that photography is the parent of cinema? Certainly many of the written histories tend to think so. The two share a photographic base, but beyond this the link is usually made through 'chronophotographers' of the late nineteenth century, primarily Eadweard Muybridge and Etienne-Jules Marey (although there were several others). Muybridge used banks of cameras to record sequential instants of human and animal locomotion. Marey produced multiple exposures of movement on single photographic plates. Both lived long enough to see the Lumière's cinématographe, but as 'parents' they were indifferent. It was cinema that claimed the lineage. To cinema, Muybridge's grids of consecutive photographs looked pre-animated, as if awaiting motion to come. Marey's images resembled translucent film frames layered on top of each other. Both pursued instantaneous arrest, the decomposition of movement, not its recomposition. Stopping time and examining its frozen forms was their goal. It was a noble goal, pursued diligently and achieved comprehensively. Marey even told the Lumières that their Cinématographe was of no interest because it merely reproduced what the eye could see, while he sought the invisible. Muybridge did come up with a means of animating his images (the Zoopraxiscope of 1879), but he saw it as a novelty, far removed from the serious project of stilling things. Nevertheless, it is almost impossible not to see a connection between these instantaneous consecutive images and cinema. The problem is that chronophotography and cinematography give rise to incompatible yet intertwined ideas about the truth of images and the understanding of time and motion. In addition, they are aesthetically distinct forms.

15 Eadweard Muybridge, 'Transverse Gallop', book plate from *Animals in motion. An electro-photographic investigation of consecutive phases of muscular actions* (London, 1907), first published in 1887.



16 Etienne-Jules Marey, *Cheval au galop* [*Galloping Horse*], 1886.



Stillness and movement are mutually exclusive, despite their genealogy and mutual interest.

That said, sooner or later the comparison of photography and film always comes around to questions of stillness and movement, confronting what is at stake in the common assumption that 'films move and photographs are still'. What *is* the movement of film and what is the stillness of photography? Is it that the film image changes over time while the photograph is fixed? Not exactly. That photographs are *about* stillness and films *about* movement? Possibly, but it still misses something. As we saw earlier, we soon come up against the limits of thinking about the question outside of subject matter. The film image certainly has duration and thus movement at a mental level. Yet, when we think of the film image moving, it is also because it has tended, conventionally, to select subject matter that moves and can be seen moving. Similarly, the stillness of photography is given to us most clearly when it arrests or fails to arrest movement, or when it confirms the immobility of inert things. Of course, we can film or photograph a moving subject (say, workers leaving a factory) or a still one (say, a building). The Lumières could have filmed motionless buildings without people, but they did not. We had to wait for Andy Warhol to separate cinematic duration from depicted movement. Muybridge could have photographed at high speed a sleeping horse or a human figure reading a book, but he did not. Each chose subject matter appropriate to their ends, as do all image-makers. And since subject matter has changed so radically – think of the changes that have taken place across the histories of these media – our conceptions of photography and film remain perpetually uncertain. This is especially so in the way that we understand their relation to movement and stillness.

Stops and Flows

The most significant subject for photography and film has been the human body. The second most significant has been the city. Let us begin with the city. The developments of modernity, photography and film are thoroughly intertwined and inseparable from the evolution of the modern

city. When Christopher Isherwood set out to describe daily life in Berlin before the Second World War, he wrote:

> I am a camera with its shutter open, quite passive, recording, not thinking. Recording the man shaving at the window opposite and the woman in the kimono washing her hair. Some day, all this will have to be developed, carefully printed, fixed.[1]

Like many writers and artists of that period, Isherwood adopted a camera-eye, or camera-I, as the ideal ego for urban living. Responding to the visual stimulation of the city, it neatly collapsed being and seeing into a single condition. But was this metaphor photographic or cinematic? Isherwood keeps it open. 'Printed, fixed' suggests the still image. A 'shutter open' at length might imply something more like a running film camera, or perhaps a long exposure capturing an abstract trace of movement over time. Such ambiguity was a symptom of the temporal challenges of modern life. Was the metropolis to be experienced in fits and starts, or in its continuous unfolding? The photographer Henri Cartier-Bresson also spoke of the camera as an extension of his eye. Here he recalls developing in the 1930s what came to be known as his credo, the 'decisive moment':

> I prowled the street all day, feeling very strung up and ready to pounce, determined to 'trap' life, to preserve it in the act of living. Above all I craved to seize the whole essence, in the confines of one single photograph, of some situation that was in the process of unrolling itself before my eyes.[2]

'Trapping' and 'seizing' belong to photography's quick snap. The 'whole essence' suggests a longer situation condensed into one frame. And 'unrolling before my eyes' hints at an observer not quite *in* the world but removed, as if watching it on a screen. In the opening paragraph of his book *Images à la Sauvette* (translated as *The Decisive Moment*, 1952), Cartier-Bresson tells of 'bursting' into photography as a boy, taking snapshots with a Box Brownie. The second begins: 'Then there were the movies. From the great films I learned to look and to see'.[3] In the third he describes



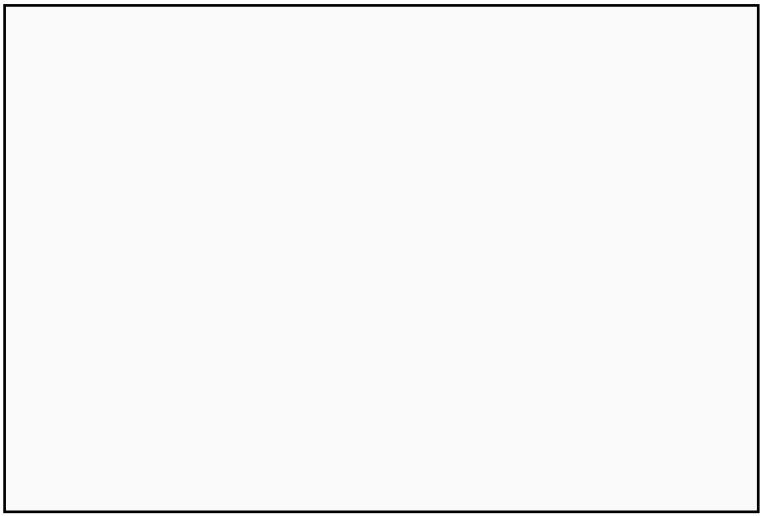
17 Page spread from *The Decisive Moment* (New York and Paris, 1952).

Eugène Atget's sedate photographs of Paris, which prompted him to try a slow plate camera and tripod: 'instead of a shutter a lens cap', which 'confined my challenge to the static world'. The most celebrated spread from his book makes a comparable switch in tempo. On the left, a man is frozen in mid-air as he jumps over a puddle, his heel almost touching its reflection; on the right, an older man, solid on his feet, pauses as if reflecting upon a decisive moment in his past. The first jumps quickly through his sleepy surroundings; the second is almost as still as his. The first photo looks like a decisive snapshot because we can see the arresting effect of the fast shutter. The second looks calmer because the scene is calmer. In reality, both might have been shot the same way, with the same shutter speeds, but a photograph tends to look 'decisive' if there is

something to arrest. This is photography of the lens and shutter actively combined, colliding and colluding with the world in motion. The frame cuts into space and the shutter cuts into time, turning the photographic act into an event in itself.[4]

Cartier-Bresson's compact Leica camera, so vital to the development of mobile reportage, took 35mm stock made standard by the film industry. Indeed, the Leica was in part designed to enable cinematographers to make exposure tests on short lengths of ciné film, without having to thread up a bulky movie camera. So while photography may have begat cinema, cinema begat the 'decisive moment'. This is true in more than a technical sense. Stillness became definitive of photography only in the shadow of the cinema. Specialists like Muybridge and Marey had pursued instantaneous photography since the 1870s, but the *widespread* desire for the precise freezing of action took hold in the era of 'moving pictures', which had themselves taken hold in the era of modern metropolitan motion. Likewise, the term 'snapshot' dates back to the 1860s, when the instantaneous photo became possible, but it was not until the 1920s that the snapshot was professionalized via reportage and democratized via amateurism. It was then that it came to be understood as the very essence of photography, for a while at least. It was almost as if cinema, in colonizing the popular understanding of time, implied that life itself was made up of distinct slices and that still photography had the potential to seize and extract them.[5]

Cartier-Bresson's most celebrated photographs are of everyday situations made eventful only by his precise framing and timing. The subject matter is often insignificant until it is photographed – the jumping over a puddle, the fleeting gesture of a face, bodies moving through space flattened suddenly and beautifully into two dimensions. He was present at a great number of historical events, but he was indirect, shooting bystanders rather than the main attraction, the diffused effects rather than the cause. Best when conjured out of next to nothing, *his* decisive moments avoided competition with history's decisive moments. The exception is the photograph titled 'A Gestapo informer recognized by a woman she had denounced, deportation camp, Dessau, Germany, 1945'. Here the image is a decisive event, but it is also *of* an event, a momentary



depiction of something momentous. Suddenly we sense photography's shortcomings as a historical record. We need know nothing more about that puddle-jumper because nothing more is at stake, but the violence shown here demands to be explained, demands that title to account for it. Cartier-Bresson's titles were rarely more than place names and dates. This one is long, like a newspaper caption describing the action as if it were ongoing.[6] Such a photograph does not so much narrate as *require* narration. Photojournalism *requires* journalism, because facts, however 'powerful', cannot speak for themselves. And, to be precise, the title here does not refer to the outburst at all but to the *earlier* moment, when the informer was recognized. In filling in the missing context the title stretches the time of the image to include the moment before.

There is something theatrical in this shot of a visceral slap at the end of the war. The scene is reminiscent of a show trial taking place before the glare of the camera. The vantage point is ideal, as if the photographer had been granted it in advance. It is also a highly visible vantage point and may have influenced what was going on. To the photographer's side an assistant was filming with a movie camera and a more comprehensive account of the scene appears in Cartier-Bresson's documentary film *Le Retour* (1945).[7] While its individual frames show less than the photograph,

19 Frame sequence from the documentary film *Le Retour* (Henri Cartier-Bresson, 1944–5).

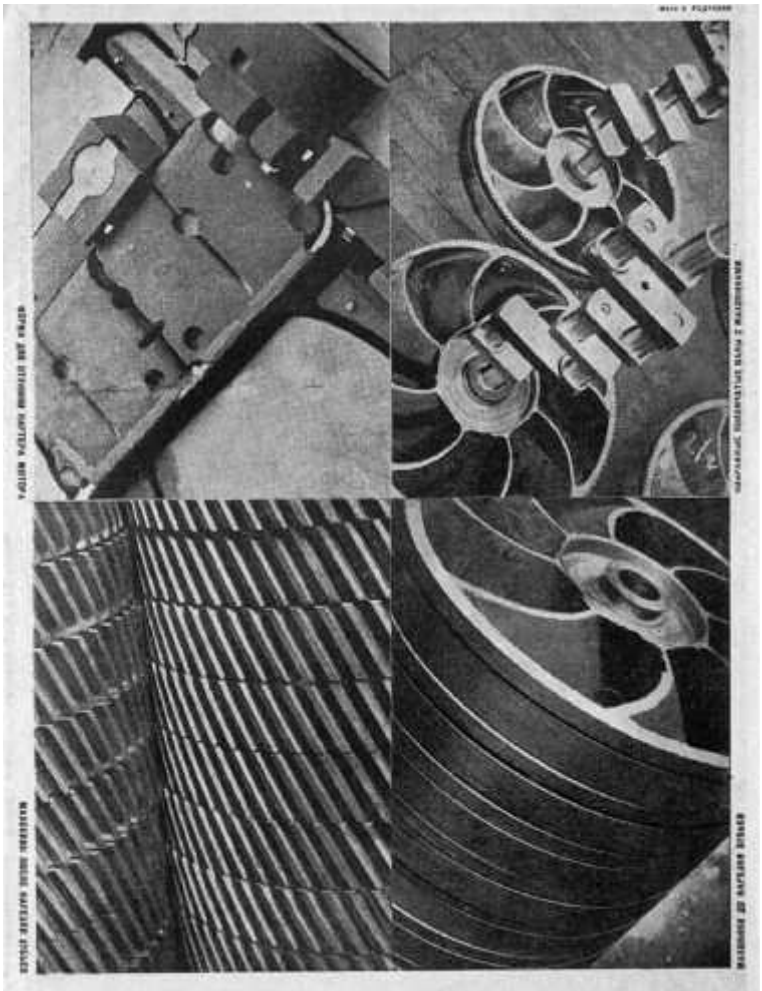
18 *top left*: Henri Cartier-Bresson, 'A Gestapo informer recognized by a woman she had denounced, deportation camp, Dessau, Germany, 1945.'

the unfolding film can explain more of what is going on. The photograph may be summative, but it is in the end compelling only in its fragmentary incompleteness.

Stillness, Movement, Montage

In 1925 the Russian artist and photographer Alexander Rodchenko visited France to witness at first hand the growing energy and speed of Paris. While there he bought a camera called the Sept. It could shoot stills, short bursts of frames (like a motor-drive), as well as moving footage, all on 35mm film.[8] In fact, he bought two, the second for his friend the filmmaker Dziga Vertov. Launched well before the Leica, the Sept was a canny response to an emerging desire to close the gap between photographs put together as sequences and cinema broken down into shots or frames. That desire was nowhere stronger than in Soviet Constructivism. Here photography and film came to share many of the same concerns. What facilitated this was not so much technical equipment but *montage*, a principle of assembly that could be applied to still and moving images. Jean-Luc Godard has suggested that what made possible the kinds of montage advocated by Vertov, Sergei Eisenstein and other filmmakers was the angled shot: the look sharply up, down or at a tilt so characteristic of Russian avant-garde cinema.[9] Renouncing the supposedly 'straight' shot – frontal, rectilinear and neutral – did not simply energize the frame with dynamic composition, it also announced it as a partial image, just one choice among many. As Dziga Vertov put it in 1922: 'Intervals (the transitions from one movement to another) are the material, the elements of the art of movement and by no means the movements themselves. It is they [the intervals] which draw the movement to a kinetic resolution.'[10] The following year he was more explicit:

> I am kino-eye. I am a builder. I have placed you, whom I have created today, in an extraordinary room, which did not exist until just now when I also created it. In this room there are twelve walls shot by me in various parts of the world. In bringing together shots of walls and



20 Page from *Daesh'! [Give your All!]* no. 14, special issue on the AMO automobile factory in Moscow 1929. Design and photography by Alexander Rodchenko.

details, I have managed to arrange them in an order that is pleasing and to construct with intervals, correctly, a film-phrase which is the room.[11]

Tellingly, there is little mention here of *depicted* movement. These are virtually still shots pieced together as film, as if the world's own movements must be subordinated to the control of the editor/monteur. Vertov's



21 Helmar Lerski, images from the series *Metamorphosis Through Light* (1936).

words apply just as well to the montage of still images on the printed page or poster. Indeed, Rodchenko extolled much the same approach in photography. He rejected what he called 'belly-button shots' (the waist-level view offered by the standard use of popular box cameras), favouring unusual angles. Many images moving around a subject could overcome the fixed shot, not unlike the concatenation of views and moments in Cubism. In 1928 he declared: 'Take photo after photo! Record man not with a solitary synthesized portrait but with a mass of snapshots taken at different times and in different conditions.'[12] In theory at least montage of this kind could mobilize subject and audience at once. Thus in Constructivism still photos began to look like film frames, while films were built up with almost still photographic shots.

While the Constructivists explored this intensively, the basic premise was widespread in the European avant-garde. In his book of portraits *Köpfe des Alltags* (*Everyday Heads*, 1931), Helmar Lerski offered several photographs of each of his sitters, shot from different angles under different lighting.[13] Lerski had pioneered chiaroscuro techniques in

Expressionist theatre and cinema in Germany, using multiple lamps and mirrors to produce stylized and unnatural effects. In his photography he explored the belief that human identity will always elude the single, static image. In a bourgeois culture quick to embrace the definitive portrait of the citizen (the police mug shot, the passport photo), Lerski's approach was unsettling. His circling of his subjects, a literal embodiment of Vertov's call for the multiple portrait, was in stark contrast to the work of his celebrated contemporary August Sander.[14] Where Sander aimed to make representative images of 'typical' Germans, Lerski aimed for the opposite. With *Metamorphosis Through Light* (1936) the idea was pushed to its limit. He photographed the head of one man 175 different ways. Perusing the project one becomes less and less sure what the man actually looks like and quite clueless as to who or what he 'is'. Lerski sought a form for his ideas somewhere between photography and film, in which the factual promise of each still image could be deferred to another and another. In 1938 a slide show from the series ran for several weeks before the main feature at the Academy Cinema in London. Decades ahead of the slippery masquerades of Cindy Sherman's photography (see chapter Four), Lerski produced a cinematographic performance of a face, a mercurial façade beyond any knowable person.[15]

What Lerski sought in the face, Moï Ver sought in the city. His book *Paris* (1931) forced photography through every conceivable variant of montage – sequences, series, double printing, multiple exposure, Cubist collage, Constructivist assembly and Surrealist juxtaposition.[16] The individual shots are unremarkable, but the assembly is ceaselessly inventive, using Paris to explore photography and photography to explore Paris. There are few fixed points of reference. Instead, Moï Ver accepts that a report on the modern city is going to be fugitive, layered and contradictory, beyond a totalizing grasp. In 1929 the writer Siegfried Kracauer had come to the same conclusion:

> The street in the extended sense of the word is not only the arena of fleeting impressions and chance encounters but a place where the flow of life is bound to assert itself. Again one will have to think

22 Page spread from Moï Ver's *Paris* (1931).

mainly of the city street with its ever-moving crowds. The kaleidoscopic sights mingle with unidentified shapes and fragmentary visual complexes and cancel each other out, thereby preventing the onlooker from following up any of the innumerable suggestions they offer. What appeals to him are not so much sharp contoured individuals engaged in this or that definable pursuit as loose throngs of sketchy, completely indeterminate figures. Each has a story yet the story is not given. Instead an incessant flow casts its spell over the flâneur or even creates him. The flâneur is intoxicated with life in the street – life eternally dissolving the patterns which it is about to form.[17]



Whether critical or celebratory, representation of the city would have to emerge less from definitive images than the marshalling of pieces. Thus modernist photography and film sought to cut out and then cut together pre-selected parts. The implied point of view was compound, like a fly. Ideally, the agility of the photographer or filmmaker as they shot in the street would be matched by the juggling of the pieces in the edit. The collage by Umbo for the cover of Egon Irwin Kisch's *Zurivy Reporter* (*The Frantic Reporter*, 1929) is a heightened expression of this. The reporter is a man-machine observing, recording and interpreting all at once, just like the figure described by Isherwood. Straddling the city, he has a car and an aeroplane for feet, pens for arms, a typewriter for a chest and, of course, a camera-eye. The time lag necessary for critical reflection on the world has gone. Immersion and immediacy are all, anticipating the myth of instantaneous assessment typical of our 24-hour news television. Despite all this, in reality life in the 1920s and '30s was not actually particularly fast for most urban dwellers. The new speed was certainly felt to some extent, but it was anticipated much more. Speed was as much a seductive and utopian promise as a fact of life, particularly for the avant-garde.

What finally broke that first bond between photographers and filmmakers was the arrival of sound in 1929. It disrupted film's photographic idea of the 'shot' and for a long while it confined film production to the controlled sound studio. Vertov's silent *Man with a Movie Camera* (1929) was the pinnacle of roving film, completed just before the paralysis. Taking the familiar structure of a 'day in the life of a city', it cuts together documentary footage of urban life and combines it with a highly reflexive account of the film's own making. We see the athletic cameraman at work and the sights he records intercut with images of Vertov's editor at her table seemingly putting together the very film we are watching. That level of immersion in the city was surpassed only decades later with the coming of portable video. Even so, the lure of footloose city filmmaking never went away. European Neo-realist cinema of the 1940s and '50s strived for the freedom and mobility of the documentary photographer, as did the French New Wave. In 1959 Jean-Luc Godard made much of *Breathless* on the streets of Paris. His cinematographer Raoul Coutard had a light





23 Cover of Egon Irwin Kisch, *Zurivy Reporter* [*The Frantic Reporter*], 1929. Collage by Umbo.

24 Stills from Dziga Vertov's *Man with a Movie Camera*, layout by Jan Tschichold for the book *Photo-Eye* (Stuttgart, 1929).

enough camera but could find no ciné film stock fast enough to shoot the city on the hoof without additional lighting. The only solution was to tape together short lengths of Ilford HP5, the film manufactured for reportage and sports photographers.

Critically Slow

The physical/mental montage of shots constitutes one version of 'pure cinema'. The other, advocated by the film theorist André Bazin, minimizes montage and emphasizes the 'pro-filmic event', that is, the unfolding of

action in front of the rolling camera. For Bazin, the synthetic nature of montage should be subordinate to the organic nature of the individual shot. When the experimental filmmaker Hollis Frampton imagined the 'infinite film' it included both versions:

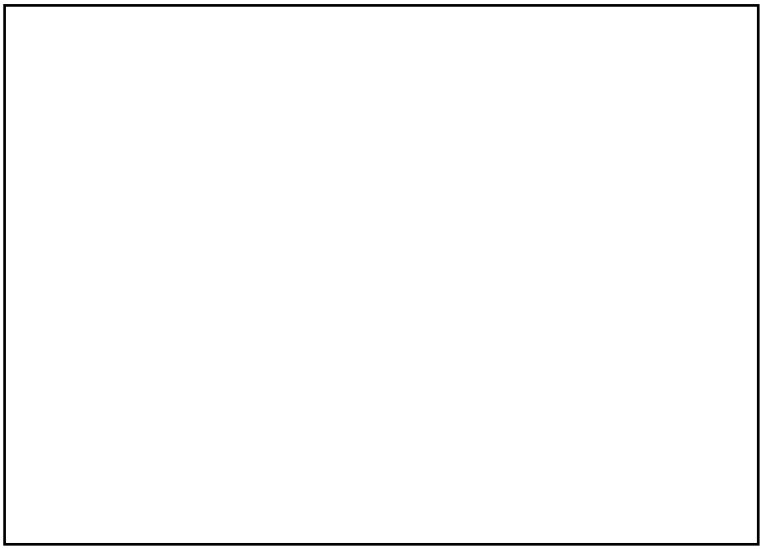
> The infinite film contains an infinity of endless passages wherein no frame resembles any other in the slightest degree, and a further infinity of passages wherein successive frames are as nearly identical as intelligence can make them.[18]

Popular narrative film stays away from endless difference and endless sameness. It occupies a small mid-ground of 'sentence-length' shots, neither too short to be comprehensible nor too long to be tolerable.[19] By contrast, the history of avant-garde cinema is a history of gravitation to those two extremes. At one end there is the film built up from rapid cuts and at the other the long single take. Significantly, at both ends we find versions of photographic stillness. Montage sees the photograph as a partial fragment, as we have seen. The long take sees the photograph as a unified whole. The shorter a film's shot the more like a photograph it gets, until one ends up with a single frame. The longer the shot the more like a photograph it gets too, the continuous 'stare' of the lens giving us a moving picture.[20]

The advanced art and film of the inter-war avant-gardes were characterized by their engagement with speed and montage. But by the 1950s speed had lost much of its artistic appeal and almost all its critical potential, particularly in Europe. Beyond the sobering effects of the war, modernity had developed a terrifying autonomy, not least at the level of the image. The 'society of the spectacle', diagnosed by Guy Debord in 1967 but intimated much earlier, relied upon the breathless turnover of popular culture with is ephemeral advertising, commodified news and droning television. Speed and montage were degenerating from the promise of mass mobilization into mass distraction. The accelerated image world began to feel dehumanizing, repetitive and monotonous. In this context *slowness*, the deliberate refusal of speed, became central in vanguard art and culture and we can see this change of pace both in photography and film.

Influential filmmakers such as Ingmar Bergman, Roberto Rossellini, Robert Bresson, Yasujiro Ozu, Michelangelo Antonioni, Pier Paolo Pasolini, Andrei Tarkovsky, Danièle Huillet and Jean-Marie Straub, Stanley Kubrick, Chantal Akerman, Wim Wenders and latterly Terence Davies, Hou Hsiaou-Hsien, Tsai Ming-Liang and Béla Tarr have exploited the long take, the locked-off camera and the extended tracking shot. The often glacial tempo of their films seeks a distance from the spectacle of Hollywood and the cut and thrust of television. The fleeting was considered irredeemably frivolous and artistically beyond the pale. Instead, cinema's gaze would be extended to become so long and so penetrating as to estrange what at first looked and felt familiar – a roadside, a face, a building, a landscape, the sea. The embrace of the slow was also a sign of increasing uncertainty about the recorded image in general. The long look would describe the surface of the world, but doubt would creep into the equation between seeing and knowing. As Wenders put it in 1971: 'When people think they've seen enough of something, but there's more, and no change of shot, then they react in a curiously livid way'.[21] The existential entropy of post-war modern life was diagnosed by Antonioni's films of the early 1960s, in which he developed an aesthetics of decelerated alienation. Here the almost-nothing of the image drained of narrative urgency and quick cuts flirts with the audience's everyday experience of doubt about the world and its future.[22] At the same time the slowness of the image on screen opened up a space for philosophical and aesthetic reflection *within* the film.

Art film and experimental film of the 1960s and '70s took a similar approach, typified by Warhol's movies and the enquiries of Structuralist and Materialist filmmakers. Structuralist film tended to take a single organizing idea from the grammar of cinema and interrogate it (e.g., shot / counter shot, the zoom, the tracking shot, the dissolve, split-screen, dialogue patterns, gestures, sounds, narrative elements). Materialist film tended to emphasize the mechanics of the apparatus and the act of viewing (camera, celluloid, projector, screen, the physiology of perception). Michael Snow's *Wavelength* (1967), a landmark in experimental film, is as Structuralist as it is Materialist. The film appears to be an imperceptibly slow 45-minute zoom across a bare apartment space, ending on a still



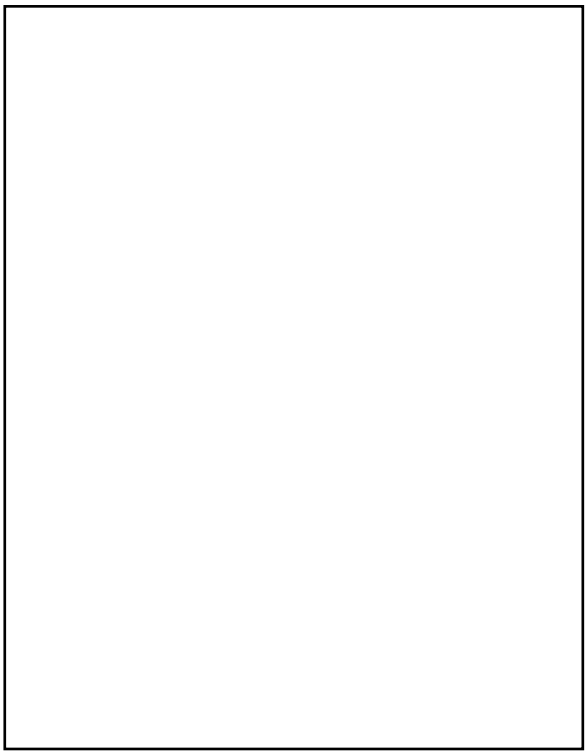
25 *Wavelength* (Michael Snow, 1967), frame.

photograph of ocean waves pinned on the opposite wall. In the course of the zoom the image flickers through different colour filtrations and switches day to night and positive to negative, highlighting the physical substance of the projected image. Fragments of narrative are introduced when a man enters the room and collapses on the floor, but the unwavering zoom continues on its way to the photograph. *Wavelength* builds up a tension between human and mechanical vision, which is never resolved but is dramatized as its central idea. The film is neither fast enough to feel like movement nor slow enough to register as stillness, neither eventful enough to feel like a story nor uneventful enough to set the viewer free of narrative.

Forty years on, subsequent generations are still unpacking the ramifications of the intensive experimentation of the 1960s and '70s, just as many artists continue to look to the equally productive Conceptual art of that period. A significant change is that experimental cinema has been taken up substantially by contemporary art. It has left behind the film co-ops and alternative cinemas in which it developed to move into the gallery. Despite the variety, a certain slowness predominates in these new practices. We see it in the work of Bill Viola, Douglas

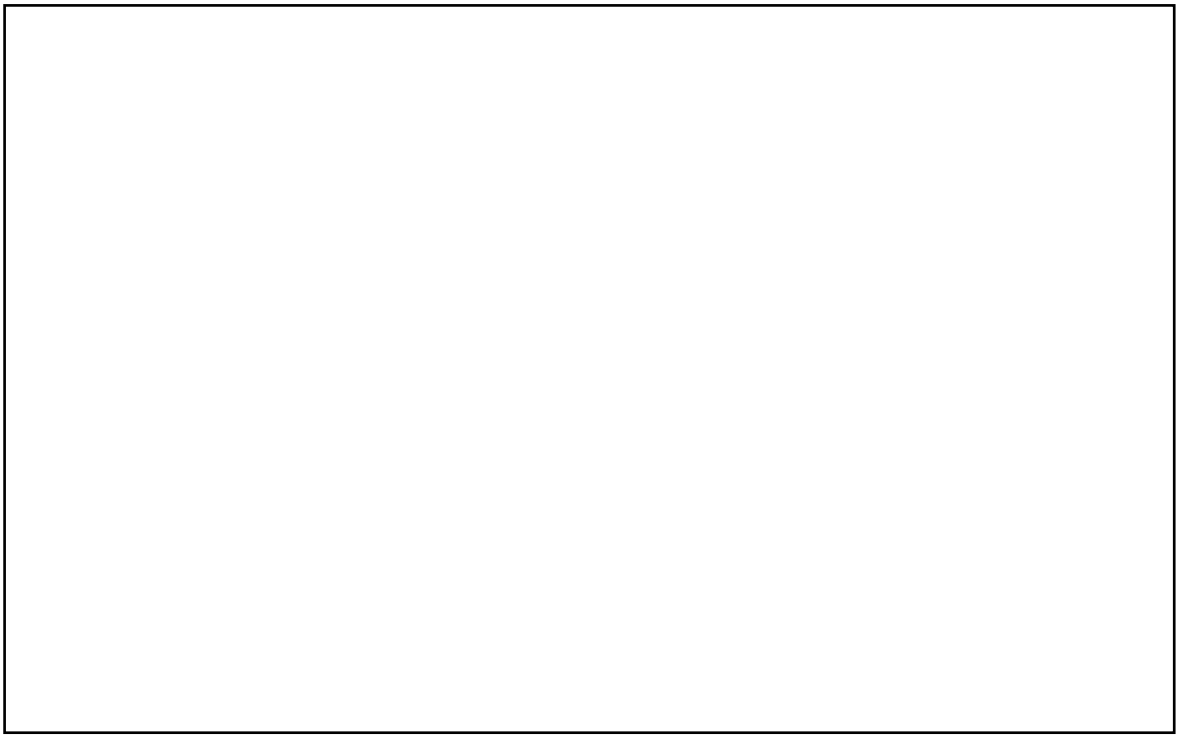
Gordon, Gillian Wearing, Fiona Tan, Eija-Liisa Ahtila, David Claerbout, Steve McQueen, Sharon Lockhart, Stan Douglas, Mark Lewis, and Victor Burgin, among others. Art's preference for the slow is motivated by more than the desire to separate itself from mainstream cinema and spectacle at large. Slowness enables film to approach the traditional sense of 'presence' typical of art's materially fixed media such as painting, sculpture and photography, all of which have valued the depiction rather than re-creation of movement. The fact that things happen only incrementally in films often screened as loops means that one has the opportunity to contemplate and interrogate *while looking*, an experience that continues to remain central to the depictive arts, regardless of media.

26 Douglas Gordon, installation shot of *24 Hour Psycho*, 1993. Video installation, 24 hours.



In 1993 Douglas Gordon transferred Hitchcock's *Psycho* (1960) to video, silenced it and slowed it down twelve-fold so that it lasted a whole day. Running at two frames per second, *24 Hour Psycho* invites a microscopic dissection of the original, holding each scene long enough to yield more meaning than was ever required by the narrative. Three years later Gillian Wearing assembled police officers as if for a photograph but had them attempt to hold still for an hour in front of her video camera.[23] A snapshot is replaced by 60 minutes of stiff posing, except for the inevitable sniffing, coughing, shuffling and yelps of relief when the hour is up. But the extreme had already come in 1978 when James Coleman had made half a second of James Whale's film version of *The Invisible Man* (1933) last more than eight hours.[24] Transferring twelve frames to mounted slides for projection, he produced a sequence of twenty-minute long dissolves from one to the next, in which the invisible man is shot and becomes visible as he dies. To the eye the transformation is neither visible nor invisible, but hovers somewhere in between.

Pursuing what he terms 'part cinema', the artist Mark Lewis makes single-take short films that extend



the principles of Structuralist film. Each of his works lasts roughly as long as the shortest reel of commercially available film stock. Lewis respects the notion that historically the art gallery has been the space of the silent pictorial tradition. His uninterrupted shots without sound produce what can be described literally as moving photographs. In this his films connect as much to painting and photography as to the single-reel films of the Lumières or Warhol's long takes. They are often set in the in-between parts of the city, the 'no man's land' that has neither the dynamism of the centre nor the stillness of the neglected periphery. Shot on Super 35mm film and transferred to DVD, *Queensway: Pan and Zoom* (2005) presents three different framings of the same almost still scene within one take. The first, held for about a minute, appears to be an establishing shot of a nondescript roadside building. A woman in the middle distance stands rummaging in her bag. A sharp pan to the left reframes on a second

27 Gillian Wearing, video still from *Sixty Minute Silence* (1996). Rear projection video, 60 mins, colour, sound.

28 Three frames from *Queensway: Pan and Zoom* (Mark Lewis, 2005). 3 minutes 3 secs. Super 35mm transferred to DVD.

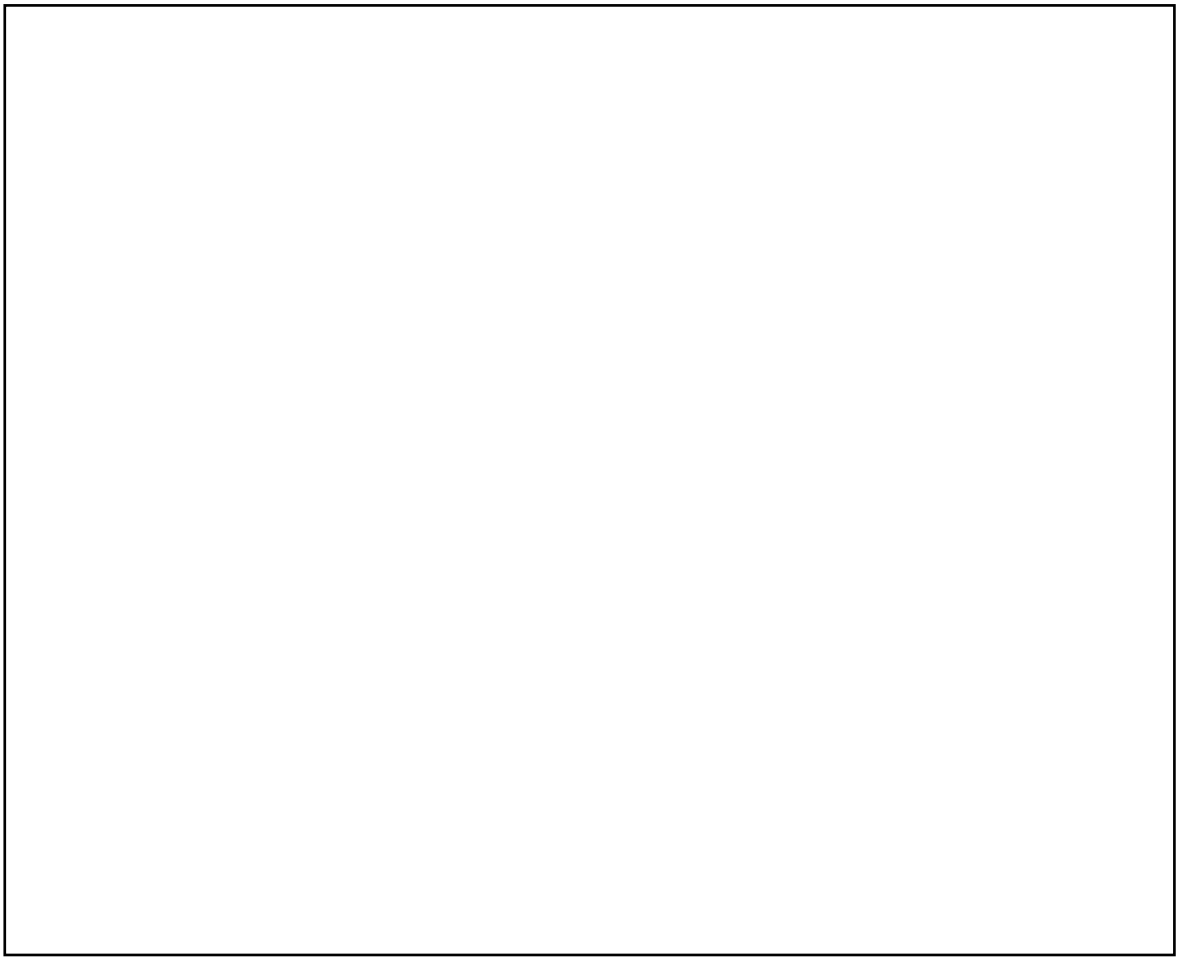
figure seated outside the building's entrance. A minute later the camera pans and zooms swiftly to frame a curtained window. A minute later the shot ends, only to start again on a loop. Nothing seems to connect the three framings or the people besides their coexistence in space and time, but Lewis plays on our compulsion to look for meaningful coherence and narrative momentum.

Victor Burgin's recent video works have established a new ground between stillness and movement. *Nietzsche's Paris* (1999) draws on the written correspondence between Friedrich Nietzsche, Paul Rée and Lou Salomé in which the three envisioned living together in Paris. The *ménage à trois* never happened. Burgin's video combines three deceptively simple elements. The first appears to be a series of circular pans, shot from the promenade of the new Bibliothèque Nationale in Paris. In fact, the images are long panoramas made by digitally stitching together 24 separately shot stills. The feeling of movement comes from their slow and steady scroll across the screen. Intercut with these are short allusive phrases appearing on screen that could be quotations from a written text, or captions, or intertitles for a silent film. We also see a second image, of a typically 'nineteenth-century woman' seated on a park bench. While the leaves around her tremble in the wind, she seems even more still than her stiffened posture suggests. She is in fact a freeze frame, key-holed digitally within a real time shot of her surroundings. The overall effect gives *Nietzsche's Paris* a temporality all its own, one that is uncannily well suited to its subject matter: a past moment of future hope, re-imagined in the present.

In photography something of this loss of faith in speed can be measured against the steady waning of interest in the instantaneous snapshot. As we have seen, it was only from the 1920s, in the shadow of cinema and with the growing dominance of print journalism, that photography became the modulator of the concept of the event. Good photo-reporters followed the action, aiming to be in the right place at the right time. This lasted until the late 1960s, with the standardized introduction of portable video cameras for news coverage. Over the last few decades the representation of events has fallen increasingly to video and was then dispersed across a variety of platforms. As television overshadowed print media, photography lost its position as a medium of primary information. It even lost its monopoly over stillness to video and then digital video, which provides frame grabs for newspapers as easily as it provides moving footage for television and the Internet. Today, photographers often prefer to wait until an event is over. They are as likely to attend to the aftermath because photography is, in relative terms, at the aftermath of culture. What we see first 'live' or at least in real time on television might be revisited by photographers depicting the stillness of traces.

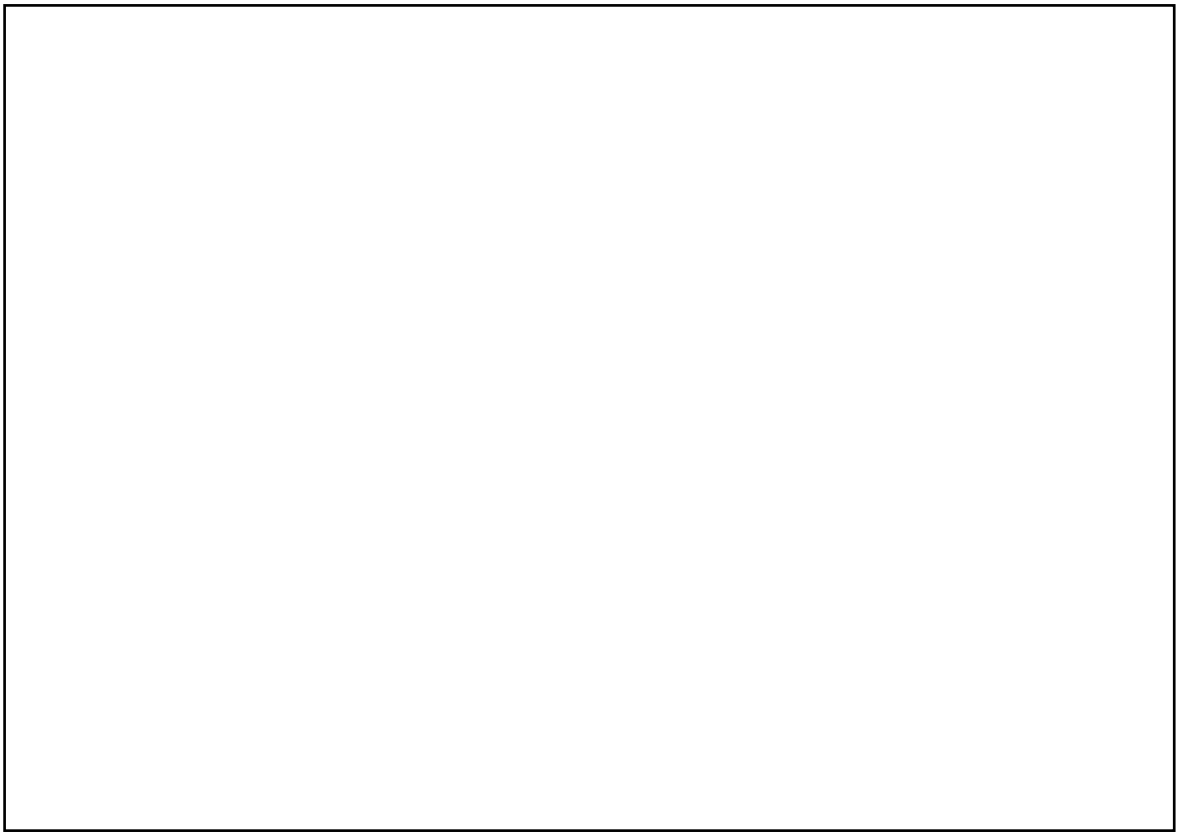
In this way immersion in subject matter has given way to distance. Sharp reflexes have given way to careful strategy. The small format has given way to the large. Nimbleness and a 'quick eye' are passed over as photographers attune to the longer wave rhythms of the social world. As a consequence the photographic image becomes less about the 'hot' decisiveness of the shutter and more about the 'cold' stoicism of the lens. Where the boundaries between the still and moving image are breaking down the photographic image circulates promiscuously, dissolving into the hybrid mass of mainstream visual culture. But where photography attempts to separate itself out and locate a particular role for itself, it is decelerating, pursuing a self-consciously sedate, unhurried pace. Slower working procedures are producing images more akin to monuments than moments. Many of the defining photographic projects of the last decade or so have been depictions of aftermaths and traces in the most

previous spread: 29 Victor Burgin, *Nietzsche's Paris* (1999). Single screen video projection.



30 Simon Norfolk, 'Bullet scarred outdoor cinema at the Palace of Culture in the Karte Char district of Kabul', 2002, from the series *Chronotopia*.

literal sense. They include projects as diverse as Joel Meyerowitz's documentation of Ground Zero in New York; Paul Seawright's and Simon Norfolk's images of the traces of war in Afghanistan; Robert Polidori's records of the damage wrought by Hurricane Katrina on New Orleans; and Sophie Ristelhueber's images of the sabotaged Kuwaiti oilfields in 1991. In all of these examples photography has re-engaged its forensic function, although none of these photographers makes images that resemble police pictures. Instead, forensic attention to traces is spliced



with an almost classical sense of place typical of traditional landscape photography. Just as the medium has been sidelined from events, these image-makers find their outlet away from the popular press, in the expanded field of fine-art photography. In parallel to this, others have focused on the time *before* the event. At first glance An-My Lê's series *29 Palms* (2003–4) look like battlefield photographs from a contemporary war zone. In fact, they document the military preparations of US Marines on American soil for conflict in the Middle East. This is not the 'theatre of war' but its rehearsal studio.[25]

That many photographers now work in these 'late' ways is not just a consequence of their coming to terms with the marginal status of the

31 An-My Lê, *Night Operations*, 2003–4, from the series *29 Palms*.

medium. It is also a question of coming to terms with the idea that documentary and photojournalism are now thoroughly allegorical. These photographers know full well that their restrained images are read through the barrage of mass-media coverage of the events they so studiously avoid.[26]

Body, Gesture, Action

How does the dialectic of stillness and movement impact upon the representation of the human body? Let us consider 'posing' and 'acting' as two distinct modes of bodily performance. We might associate acting with unfolding or 'time-based' media like cinema or theatre. Posing may suggest the stillness of photography or painting. Of course, plenty of examples complicate this. Think of scenes of arrest such as the *tableau vivant* in theatre, cinema's close-ups of faces in stilled contemplation, blurred gestures caught but escaping a long exposure, or narrative scenes acted out for the still photograph. Such things are too common to be exceptions.

In Alfred Hitchcock's *North By Northwest* (1959), Cary Grant's entire performance is a series of balletic swoops and pirouettes strung between archly frozen poses. He is on screen almost the whole time and his intermittent halts provide the suspense in the hurtling story of mistaken identity. Early in the film he stoops to aid a man who has been knifed in the back. Stunned, Grant puts his hand on the weapon and becomes easy prey for the incriminating flash of a press photographer. We see the resulting image on the cover of a newspaper: his indecision has framed him decisively. He flees in panic, setting the plot in motion.

Grant's performance is a slick and knowing commentary on the very nature of screen presence. Each pose is a wink to the audience that he is toying with his own identity and celebrity. Fans knew Grant began life as plain Archibald Leach, a circus tumbler from Bristol. In the film he plays Roger Thornhill, an advertising executive mistaken for the non-existent spy George Caplan. Grant holds his poses for longer than is strictly necessary, long enough for the story to fall away momentarily and allow the audience to stare at a man with four names.[27] At one point Grant breaks in through





32 *North By Northwest* (Alfred Hitchcock, 1959), still.

33 *Pickpocket* (Robert Bresson, 1959), still.

a hospital window. A woman in bed yells 'Stop!', first in shock, then with a comic swoon. What if your movie heart-throb really did spring to life from a frame on your bedroom wall? Grant's technique, much like Hitchcock's, is extravagant but it differs from convention only by degree. Hollywood performances, especially in thrillers and dramas, criss-cross between filmic character and the excesses of star persona, between acting and posing.[28]

We see the opposite in the films of the French director Robert Bresson, whose pared-down style avoids all excess. Bresson disliked the very idea of stars and cast non-professionals, avoiding even the term *actor* and its theatrical implications. He preferred the term *model*, which recalls the still photograph or the painter's studio. He had his models drain their actions of as much theatre as possible, insisting they perform over and over in rehearsal until they could do it without thought or self-consciousness. Bresson wrote in his only book: 'No actors (no directing of actors). No parts (no playing of parts). No staging. But the use of working models taken from life. BEING (models) instead of SEEMING (actors)'. Later he noted: 'Nine-tenths of our movements obey habit and automatism. It is anti-nature to subordinate them to will and thought.'[29] *Pickpocket* (1959) may be Bresson's most complete exploration of the approach, since what happens on screen mirrors his own method. The film follows the career of a pickpocket as he trains himself relentlessly, perfecting his technique. The result is a performance in which everything and nothing looks

controlled as the pickpocket 'goes through the motions' possessed of an inner stillness, even when moving.

The grammar of cinema distinguished itself from filmed theatre through montage and the close-up. The close-up is a pause in the narrative flow, a stable image close to the halting stare of the photograph. In early cinema close-ups were lit by the conventions of studio portrait photography. But other photographic references soon emerged. Buster Keaton modelled his stone-faced persona on Matthew Brady's portraits of soldiers from the American Civil War, mimicking them directly in *The General* (Buster Keaton, 1927). Keaton had a huge popular following but he was equally admired by the European avant-garde, who saw in his performances something of the tension between the organic and the inorganic life that comes with modernity. While his body was capable of breathtakingly agile movement (he was a supreme athlete), his expression remained immobile, showing no strain or emotion. At times the disconnection was stark. In *The Cameraman* (Edward Sedgwick, 1928), Keaton dashes across town to meet his girlfriend. The camera tracks alongside as he races down a busy sidewalk, his limbs a machinic blur while his face is perfectly still.

Similarly, in the final moments of *Queen Christina* (Rouben Mamoulian, 1933), Greta Garbo stares out impassively from the prow of a ship, an 'untamable', restless woman. She holds herself as still as a photo, looking

34 *The General* (Buster Keaton, 1927), still.

35 *The Cameraman* (Edward Sedgwick, 1928), still.





to the horizon as the camera nears. The shot is held, letting us know that she is at the eye of her own emotional storm, sailing onward. It is one of popular cinema's most celebrated scenes, but its effect is not purely cinematic. The image clearly echoes the countless publicity pictures that had already made Garbo's face famous.[30]

The impeccable stillness of Garbo's face is offset by the wind that ruffles her hair. The little movements let us know time is passing, while signalling the unpredictability of the future. Both photography and cinema find this kind of chaotic movement highly photogenic. In a publicity still from Victor Sjostrom's *The Wind* (1927), a young Lillian Gish digs the dry earth as a dust storm engulfs her. For publicity stills hair is usually groomed to perfection, but in this still hers is a mess, obscuring her face. The film's real star was the wind itself and it looks magnificent in this technically impressive vision of semi-controlled chaos. Gish's apparent loneliness belies the reality of the shoot. She recalled:

> It is, without any doubt, the most unpleasant picture [film] I've ever made, the most uncomfortable to do. I don't mind the heat so much, but working before the wind-machines all the time is nerve-racking. You see, it blows the sand, and we've put sawdust down, too, because that is light and sails along in the air, and then there are smoke-pots to make it all look even dustier. I've been fortunate. The flying cinders haven't gotten into my eyes, although a few have burned my hands.[31]

In 1993 the photographic artist Jeff Wall paid homage to wind with an equally complex production. His *A Sudden Gust of Wind (after Hokusai)* is a 'decisive moment', assembled digitally from dozens of separately shot elements. Wall made the picture

36 Greta Garbo window display in a Spanish fashion store at the time of the release of *Queen Christina* (Rouben Mamoulian, 1933).





37 *Queen Christina* (Rouben Mamoulian, 1933), still.

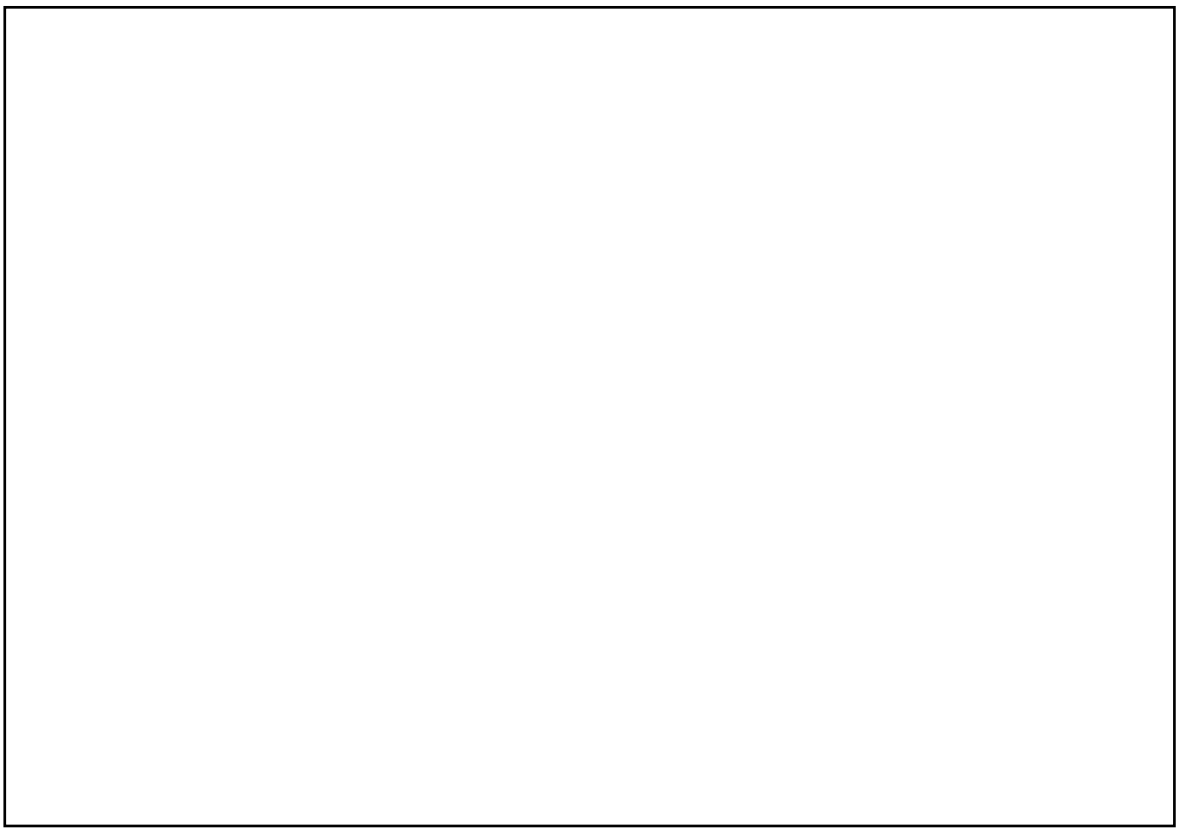
with the help of actors, assistants and a wind machine. The result does not look like a composite since it obeys the rules of the coherent, singular photograph. But once we sense or know that it may be a composite many things change, not least our relation to the wind blowing through it. It becomes a curiously airless image, certainly compared to the still of Gish. Wind animates Wall's picture at a level more conceptual than actual. It captures an idea, not a sudden gust. Moreover, there is an improbable perfection in Wall's picture. The bleak setting on the dirt ground cannot quite anchor its realism. It is as if photographic arrestedness, so in thrall to the decisive moment as a 'slice of life', demands imperfection somewhere. Perhaps Wall's perfectionism is its own deliberate undoing, allowing the viewer an entry point. Indeed, formal perfection in art often seems to have this effect. In other contexts, however, the stakes are quite different, as a comparison between Wall's image and Don McCullin's reportage shot of a Turkish gunman in Cyprus demonstrates. The light, gestures, setting and composition are all so 'right' here that they threaten to undermine the intended urgency. McCullin was reluctant to use it in a news story, since for him it seemed too much like a film still from a war movie.[32]

38 Jeff Wall, *A Sudden Gust of Wind (After Hokusai)* 1993. Transparency in lightbox, 229 x 377cm.

39 Publicity still from *The Wind* (Victor Sjostrom, 1927). Black and white photograph, 10 x 8 in.

Freeze Frame

No image seems more immobile than the freeze frame. Dramatized by movement, it is a species of still image that exists only in cinema. Most often the freeze frame is a sign of a director or editor exercising control over their film, and indeed the audience. Its sudden arrival always comes as a surprise to the viewer. So it is no surprise at all that it is most common in *auteur* cinema and particularly popular with self-consciously cinephile filmmakers. Its effect is never less than powerful, but because it is such a tempting trick it has given rise to as many blunt clichés as thoughtful insights about stillness and movement. For all their variety what is most striking about freeze frames is that we cannot help but read them as



40 Don McCullin, *Cyprus*, 1973.

photographs. Technically speaking, they are, of course, single photographic frames repeated to give the illusion of time at a standstill, but we tend to read them *culturally* as photographs too. The moment we register that the image is a freeze we have in place a number of possible ways to read it photographically: as a poignant snapshot, a telling news image, a family album photo or a mythic emblem. Indeed, it is difficult to imagine a freeze frame resistant to a photographic reading.

As early as the 1920s filmmakers made a virtue of this. In *People on Sunday* (Robert Siodmak and Edward Ulmer, 1927), we see a photographer shooting informal portraits in a park with his camera and tripod. As his sitters gaze into his lens we see their faces in direct address. Shuffling and smiling awkwardly, they either strike poses or let themselves be snapped by the photographer (to pose is to turn oneself into a photograph and pre-empt its unpredictable arrest). As the frame freezes each face in turn we read the halts as clicks of the photographer's shutter, the stilled frames doubling as his still photographs. The sequence then switches to a series of frozen faces with no movement, then to moving shots that leave the viewer to imagine the freeze, and finally to a series of typical nineteenth-century Salon portraits, as if it were not clear enough already that the itinerant photographer was replacing the formal studio.[33]

Stanley Donen's fashion satire *Funny Face* (1957) exploits relentlessly the freeze-as-photograph. Fred Astaire plays the glamorous photographer Dick Avery (based on Richard Avedon, who was the film's visual adviser). Audrey Hepburn plays an intellectual bookseller bribed into being a model. The entire film is geared around a sequence of location fashion shoots, each culminating in a freeze-frame that corresponds to the snap of the photographer's shutter. In the first, Hepburn is gauche, the photographer grabbing the moment he needs from her uncertainty. By the last she can anticipate him, freezing herself in pre-packaged 'spontaneity'.

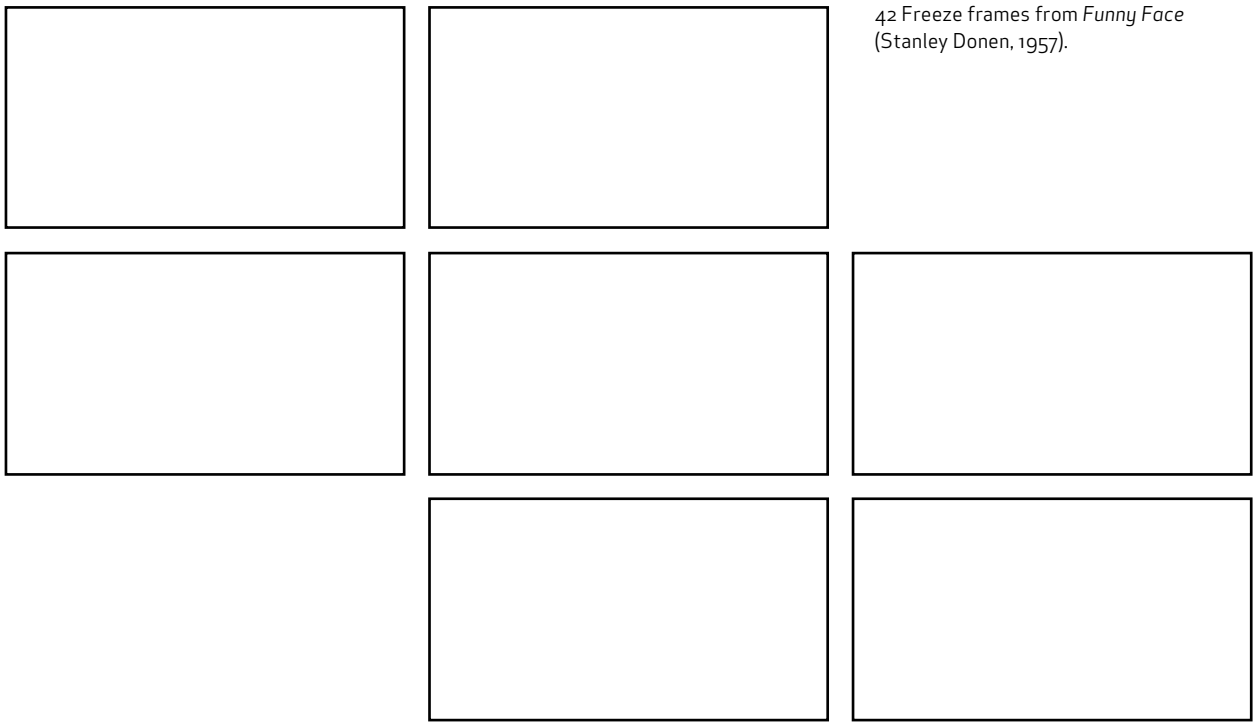
The year *Funny Face* was released the cultural critic Roland Barthes contrasted the faces of Garbo and Hepburn. Emerging from silent cinema as the embodiment of a collective wish for timeless and platonic beauty, Garbo's immobile visage was 'an idea'; Hepburn's, with its endless expressions, was 'an event'.[34] Each was filmed in ways that confirmed this. The staring lens of



41 *Menschen am Sontag* [*People on Sunday*] (Robert Siodmak and Edward Ulmer, 1928), frames.

Garbo's lingering close-ups contrasts with the eventful poses and freezes of Hepburn. Ten years on from *Funny Face*, in the other well-known fashion film *Blow-up* (Michelangelo Antonioni, 1966), the face was neither idea nor event but had become a non-event. The film dwells on the sourness of commercialized glamour and the defining image is of the model Veruschka who haunts the film with the vacant demeanour of a somnambulist, barely able to rise above her lack of interest in the world. (Among other things *Blow-up* signals the beginning of fashion's cultivated boredom.) At one point someone says to her: 'I thought you were in Paris.' She replies indifferently: 'I am in Paris.' Antonioni's long takes highlight Veruschka's apparent indifference to time itself, a theme we will come to later.

Cinema tends to freeze the idealized instant – the pinnacle of the action, the clearest facial expression or the perfect composition. In other words, it is drawn to the moments that photographers tend to prefer. Think of the car in the concluding freeze frame of *Thelma & Louise* (Ridley Scott, 1991), held at the peak of its arc so we are saved from seeing the heroines plunge into the ravine; or the runner/soldier in Peter Weir's *Gallipoli* (1981) frozen at the moment he is shot. Chest out and head



42 Freeze frames from *Funny Face* (Stanley Donen, 1957).

thrown back, he recalls Robert Capa's famous Spanish Civil War photo of a shot soldier, combined with an athletics photo finish. Or think of *Butch Cassidy and the Sundance Kid* (George Roy Hill, 1969), in which the outlaws are stilled as they run into a hail of gunfire, the freeze fading hastily to sepia to convert their violent demise into mythic destiny. Other directors adapt the freeze to expository ends. Martin Scorsese frequently turns his players into momentary portraits. In *Goodfellas* (1990), Ray Liotta's face is held as he witnesses a murder, and in voice-over he confides: 'As far back as I can remember, I always wanted to be a gangster.' It is stylish and it feels sharply modern, but it is a classical and thoroughly literary device, updating what is really the novelist's way of suspending the narrative for a paragraph or so in order to flesh out a character.

The inevitable jolt of the freeze frame stems from more than the sudden switch from movement to stillness. Sound is always disrupted. Sound



43 Publicity still of Veruschka from *Blow-up* (Michelangelo Antonioni, 1966).

does not come in frames and cannot be suspended in the same way. The freeze frame must either be left silent (very rare, either in mainstream or avant-garde film) or it is domesticated by non-synchronous sound such as music or voice-over. But most often the synch-sound continues after the freeze, emphasizing its silence as much as its stillness. When François Truffaut ended *The 400 Blows* (1959) on a freeze the silence is almost as striking as the stillness. Antoine, the film's restless adolescent hero, is running away from the world. In the final act he finds himself on a beach with nowhere left to go. He slows at the water's edge. The music surges while the sound of breaking waves marks time. As Antoine turns from the sea his eyes look at the camera as if by accident. The freeze frame catches the glance and zooms tighter into his face, which shows no clear expression. The sounds continue, but we sense their disconnection from the image, cutting Antoine off from his surroundings. In that freeze an abyss opens up between the simplicity of what is seen and the complexity of what it may mean. Antoine's face resembles a family snap but also a state identity photo. It could mean a future of frustration in schools and prisons or possible escape. It could suggest robust youth leading to a long life or the imminence of an early death. We cannot tell if this is Truffaut's certainty about how to bring things to a conclusion or his apprehension. Through the still he manages to end without concluding, opting for what is in effect the essential openness of the photographic image. Rather than taming it, Truffaut lets it loose in all its multiplicity, creating what is cinema's most definite and indefinite ending.[35]

While the freeze frame may show the world at a standstill, it cannot articulate the *experience* of such a state. Faced with a freeze the viewer is thrown out of identification with the image and left to gaze upon its sudden impenetrability. But there are a number of image forms that allude to something between movement and stillness. Since around 1980 the British filmmaker Tim Macmillan has been developing a technique known



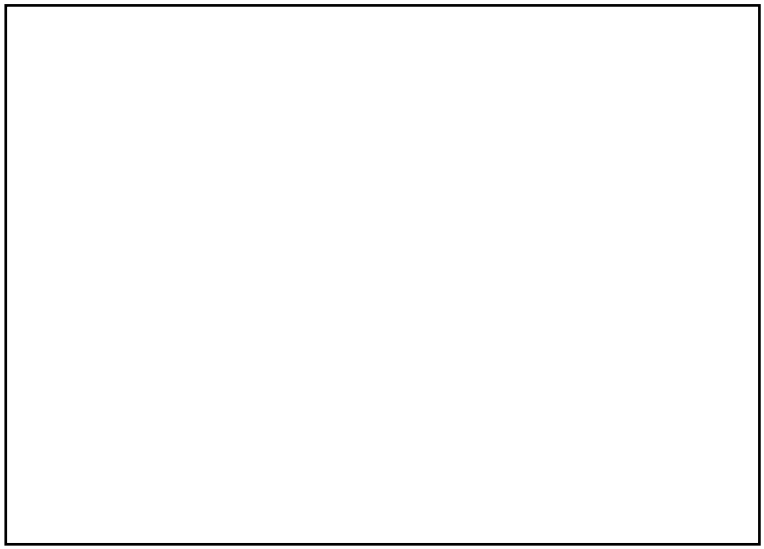






44–47 Freeze frame endings from *Thelma and Louise* (Ridley Scott, 1991); *Butch Cassidy and the Sundance Kid* (George Roy Hill, 1969); *Gallipoli* (Peter Weir, 1981); and *Les Quatre cents coups* [*The 400 Blows*] (François Truffaut, 1959).

48 Tim Macmillan, *Dead Horse* (video installation, 1998).



as Time-Slice. Multiple cameras arranged around a moving subject are all triggered at once. The resulting images are then sequenced and screened as moving footage. The result resembles a mobile gaze moving through a frozen world. The science-fiction film *The Matrix* (Andy and Larry Wachowski, 1999) made the technique famous, although the directors refer to it more dramatically as Bullet-Time. Although it feels strikingly contemporary, the technology for doing this is as old as cinema, if not older. If Muybridge had fired all his cameras at once and animated the images via his Zoopraxiscope we might have had a century of time-slice. That it came into being only recently is less an anomaly than a sign of the fact that for any image form to come into existence it must first be imagined or desired, and imagination and desire are historically grounded. The basic structures of photography and cinema have existed for a long time, but they have proved flexible enough to accommodate ever-newer conceptions of time, space, movement and stillness. That is why they are still with us rather than belonging to the nineteenth century. Macmillan's *Dead Horse* (1998), a time-slice film of a horse at the moment it is killed at a slaughterhouse, alludes to this historical delay with its clear reference back to the work of Muybridge and Marey.

two

Paper Cinema

William Henry Fox Talbot announced photography to the British in *The Pencil of Nature* (1844–6), a publication containing 24 photographs. The text laid out a range of possible uses for the medium: archival classification, science, art history, forensics, reportage and legal documents. All these potentials implied assemblies rather than single images, and his prediction was broadly correct. Photography has been developed as a medium of multiplicity and accumulation. Moreover, Talbot's chosen means of announcement, the page, has been the space where that development has made itself felt most significantly.

'To look at a photograph beyond a certain period of time', suggested the artist and writer Victor Burgin, 'is to become frustrated: the image which on first looking gave pleasure by degrees becomes a veil behind which we now desire to see.'[1] At first full, fascinating and assuring, a single photograph may soon become difficult, even resistant to the extended gaze. He continued: 'it is not an arbitrary fact that photographs are deployed so that, almost invariably, another photograph is always already in position to receive the displaced look'. We still encounter photographs en masse and if there is sustained interest in a single one it is often the result of brief encounters spread over time. But why should this be? Is there something inherent in the photographic image that precludes extended looking? Is it the coldness of its optics? Does lack of surface fail to hold the gaze? Is it the photograph's perceived limitations of time and place? Or is it a matter of cultural habit, that for generations the visual culture to which photography gave rise has been a constant stream of largely dispensable images? Did cinema, television and advertising foreclose on the long look or were the



49 Paul Nadar, a page from 'The Art of Living a Hundred Years: three interviews with M. Chevreul . . . on the eve of his 101st year',*Le Journal illustré* (5 September 1886).

photograph's deficiencies there from the start? One way to explore this is to trace the ways in which photographs have been edited and sequenced in illustrated books and magazines.

In 1886, a decade before cinema proper, *Le Journal illustré* published an extended 'photo-interview' with the scientist Michel-Eugène Chevreul, on the occasion of his 100th birthday. Twelve portraits of Chevreul in conversation with the photographer Félix Nadar were sequenced and captioned with dialogue.[2] They were not shot in the order in which they appear. What matters is the construction of a new synthetic temporality paced by reading and looking at the assembled sequence. We can see this effect more literally in an example from the following decade. A comical page from *La Vie illustrée* (1899) features two men reading the latest news of the Dreyfus Affair, a much-debated conviction of a French soldier for spying. The men are caricatures of each side of popular opinion. Their argument turns into a fight until the state intervenes in the form of a policeman. It anticipates the frontal theatre of early silent film comedy. The separate images do not represent cuts from one view to another but are more like moments from a continuous view.

While the Chevreul pictures are somewhat theatrical, they do stem from a real interview and are intended to be read as such. There is nothing particularly narrative about the photographs, but their arrangement leads to a sequential reading. The Dreyfus pictures are knowingly artificial and primitively narrative, with a beginning, middle

and a symbolic conclusion of sorts. More to the point, they are much more explicitly performative, made knowingly for the camera and the eventual viewer. They are not really a record of an event so much as an imagining of one. This difference hints at the split that haunts photography to this day, between the 'taken' and the 'made'. Of course, all taken photographs are to some extent made and vice versa. The Chevreul pictures are theatrical documentary; the Dreyfus pictures are documented theatre. The split runs through cinema history too, from the Lumières' documentaries on one side and Georges Méliès' cinema of tricks and special effects on the other. In the former there is realism in the magic; in the latter there is magic in the realism.



50 Page from *La Vie illustrée* (22 June 1899)

As we saw earlier, the rise of popular cinema in the 1920s and '30s was paralleled by the proliferation of print culture that culminated in a mass-market illustrated press. Their combined effect, as the critics Siegfried Kracauer and Walter Benjamin noted, was a cumulative conversion of all things into photographic reproduction. Nothing was beyond the scope of the camera, which threatened a levelling of experience and, for good or bad, an erosion of traditional categories of knowledge. Disparate things could be brought into equivalence via photographic reproduction on page or screen. In 1932 Alvin Tolmer summarized the rapid changes in page design:

> The mingling of real life and imaginary life, of present and past, of probablity and improbability, could only be expressed hitherto in surrealist poetry and by the technique of cinema. To-day it is one of the most powerful devices of the art of layout.[3]

Cinema's elastic construction of space, time and movement prompted a fundamental reconfiguration of the page. In 1923 El Lissitzky, setting out to redefine layout in Soviet Russia, proposed the 'cinematic book' with a

'continuous sequence of pages'.[4] The same year László Moholy-Nagy arrived at the Bauhaus in Germany intent on using the page to synthesize various artistic ideas. Both were avid consumers of printed matter. Much of their education derived from their appetites for illustrated books, journals and periodicals. Moholy-Nagy's first book *Painting, Photography, Film* (1925), emerged from that formative experience. Much of it is given over to presenting the images and visual concepts of the burgeoning visual culture around him: x-rays, animation cells, film stills, cameraless photograms, photomontages, sports photography, scientific pictures, press photos and anonymous snapshots. (This was the kind of diversity he curated for the central display at the *Film und Foto* exhibition in 1929.) Here Moholy-Nagy selects and juxtaposes. A close-up of grooves on a phonographic record is reproduced next to a night shot of light trails from cars and trams. A dancer caught in mid-air appears beside a racing bike snapped as it takes a fast corner. *Painting, Photography, Film* was a visual primer, half radical manifesto and half training manual for the new visual environment. It proposed the editing of existing images as an artistic act in itself, a creative and necessary response to the times. To be modern was to know what could be done with the images around you.[5]

The 1920s and '30s gave rise to the first generation of people to consume images in a great number on a daily basis. Professional image organizers emerged in various fields: picture editors working for popular and avant-garde publications, film editors, and new types of art historian set loose by photographic reproduction. Two significant projects of art history took shape at this time and both were indebted to cinematic assembly. The iconologist Aby Warburg's *Mnemosyne Atlas* (1924–9) comprised 79 large panels of images from all manner of sources – news clippings, postcards, photographs, advertisements torn from magazines, maps and drawings. Warburg constantly rearranged them, looking across the history of pictures for affinity in gestures, compositions, motifs and style. More than detective work, his project was actively creative. As with avant-garde film montage what mattered were the concepts and associations generated by bringing images together in pursuit of ideas that transcended any one of them.[6] In the mid-1930s André Malraux began to formulate what became *Le Musée imaginaire* (*The Museum Without Walls*),



51 Spread from André Malraux's *Le Musée imaginaire de la sculpture mondiale* (Paris, 1952).

eventually published in numerous volumes after the war. Malraux argued that it was the destiny of the art of antiquity to be redefined by modernity, first by being displaced into museums, then disseminated via the printed page. As a discipline art history still prefers to think of photography as transparent rather than transformative, enabling rather than constructing. But like Warburg, Malraux was at times overt, making use of many editorial and design tricks to bring about his visual argument. Sculptures were lit for the camera to emphasize selected qualities.[7] Images were placed side by side to assert connections; prints were flipped left to right to aid graphic flow; dramatic crops and close-ups mobilized the page.[8] All these techniques were common in cinema, but, as Beaumont Newhall noted in 1937, 'photographs of portions of objects (close-ups) were most uncommon before the moving picture'.[9]

Moholy-Nagy's *Painting, Photography, Film* concluded with the seven spreads of his 'Dynamic of the Metropolis' (subtitled 'Sketch of a Manuscript for a Film'). It combined typography, graphic design and photographs in a layout charged with the energy of a modern city on the move. There is no narrative as such, rather a 'sketch' of temporal progressions. There are typographic indices of speed and movement, vertiginous points of view and suggestions for rhythms and tempos. The subject matter was chosen accordingly: radio towers, railways, sports and military activity,



52 Final spread of Moholy-Nagy's 'Dynamic of the Metropolis' from his *Malerei, Fotografie, Film* (Munich, 1925), translated as *Painting, Photography, Film* (Boston, 1969).

exotic animals. The implied film was never made, although the kaleidoscopic approach to form and motifs in the sketch can be seen in Walter Ruttman's *Berlin, Symphony of a Great City* (1927), Dziga Vertov's *Man With a Movie Camera* (1929) and Jean Vigo's *A propos de Nice* (1930). Indeed, Moholy-Nagy's reinvention of the page as a kind of para-cinema was perhaps more radical than the slightly banal film it might have generated.

The final spread of 'Dynamic of the Metropolis' includes two film frames of a skier in action. The German director and cameraman Arnold Fanck had shot extensive cine-film of the sport in order to present frame-by-frame analysis as a teaching book. His lavish *The Wonders of Skiing* (1925) comprised instructional text, still photographs and a set of loose filmstrip sequences.[10] In his essay 'Photographed Movement', Fanck contrasted the shooting of action with a still camera and the extraction of





53 Arnold Fanck, illustration from 'Photographed Movement', *Das Deutsche Lichtbild* (Berlin, 1932).

54 Arnold Fanck, page of film strips from *Wunder des Schneeeschuhs: Ein System des richtigen Skilaufens und seine Anwendung* [*The Wonders of Skiing*] (Hamburg, 1925).

frames from filmed footage. Still photographs, he argued, provide aesthetic and emotional impression but lack the precision of the ciné-camera, which 'cannot help but record the most instructive moment'.[11] Fanck forced the argument a little, using evocatively blurry photographs and crisp film frames as illustration. His conclusion is too simple, insensitive to the fact that technical and instructive images are also aesthetic and emotional, particularly when they are new.[12] Fanck's concern echoes the debates triggered by Muybridge's work in the 1870s. Were his studies of human and animal locomotion science or art? Such things are never clear-cut. As with Muybridge's photographs, what Fanck's film-strips lacked in scientific rigour they made up for in marking the emergence of a new aesthetic of arrested movement.

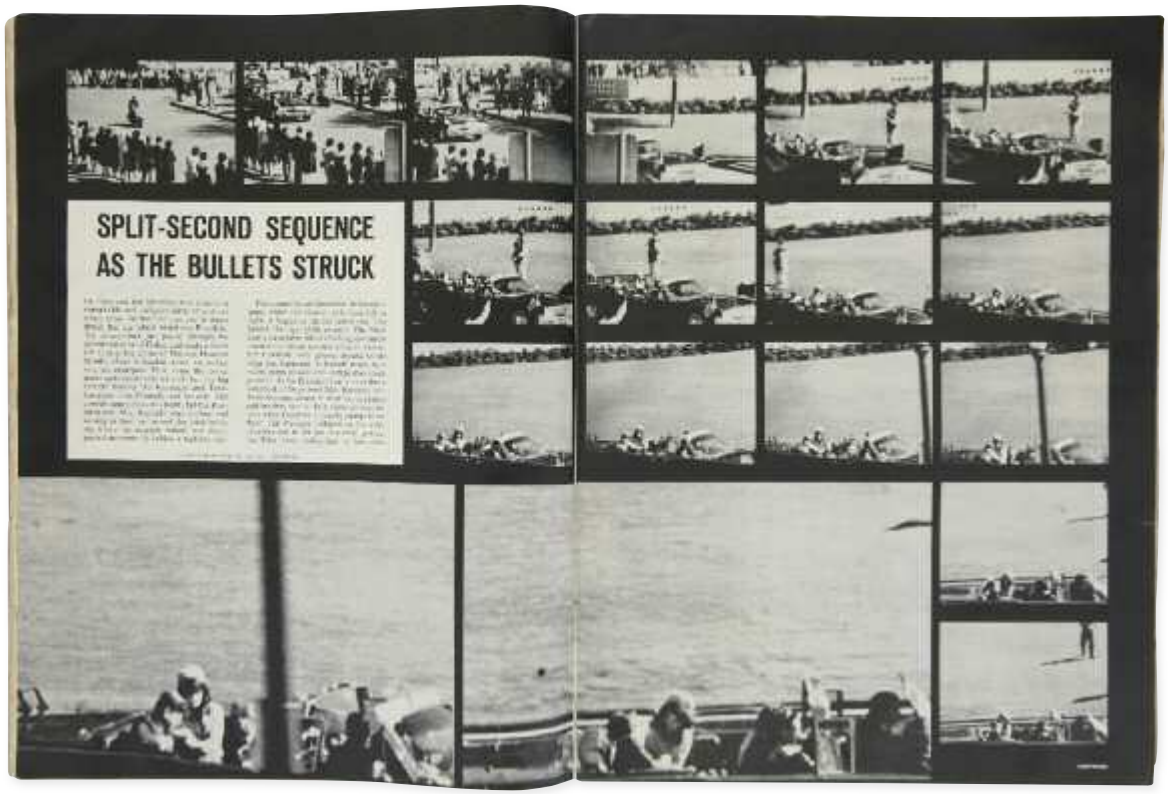
That mix of instruction and attraction led to the spread of film-strip sequences in print. They became a staple of everything from avant-garde manifestos and film journals to photo-novels and fan magazines. (To this day a column of abutted images remains the simplest way to signify 'cinema' on the page.) One of the most elaborate examples was the book *Film-Fotos Wie Noch Nie* (Film Photos as Never Seen Before) of 1929, a popular overview of cinema boasting 1,200 images. Mainstream movies were

55 Page from Edmund Bucher and Albrecht Kindt, eds, *Film-Photos Wie Noch Nie* [*Film Photos as Never Seen Before*] (Frankfurt, 1929).



given conventional layouts (portraits of stars, shots of crucial scenes). Russian avant-garde cinema was shown as strips printed at 'Constructivist' angles. German Expressionist movies appear as collaged cut-outs. More playfully, images from various films were combined by theme (Burlesque, Violence, Aerial, Speed, Mother and Child, Romance, War). A page titled 'Faces and Dreams' mixes shots from René Clair's *Entr'acte* (1924) and Jean Epstein's *The Three-Sided Mirror* (1927) to form a dream-like puzzle of displaced and condensed fragments.[13]

In 1963 *Life* magazine published perhaps the most widely seen frame sequence. Abraham Zapruder, a bystander at the assassination of President



56 *Life* magazine (29 November 1963).

Kennedy, caught the event on his amateur movie camera. The Time-Life Corporation bought exclusive rights to the 30 seconds of footage and printed several pages of frames in a number of issues of *Life*, latterly in colour.

These grainy stills were all the public saw of the confiscated film for more than a decade.[14] The sequences were certainly a voyeuristic spectacle, but they kept at arm's length the full impact of the film. Broken down on the page the event was very difficult to follow or reconstruct. The frames were not laid out in a true sequence and crucial (gruesome) frames were omitted. More to the point, as the filmmaker Pier Paolo Pasolini noted, the power of the footage lay in it being an unedited long take. The viewer stares just as the camera stared, but where the camera was unknowing, the viewer always already knows what is coming and is moved inexorably

toward it.[15] Printed frames deny this, however many are reproduced. A full quarter century earlier Beaumont Newhall had noted that 'some of the most striking news photographs are enlargements from news film'.[16] Today the frame-grab from digital video is commonplace in newspapers. Nevertheless, *Life*'s exploitation of the Zapruder footage was unusual. Newhall had in mind the isolation of single film frames, presented as if they were unique news photographs. *Life*'s layouts made a virtue of their cinematic origin.

Brian De Palma's conspiracy movie *Blow Out* (1980) deftly reworks all this. John Travolta plays a film sound engineer recording a background wild track when he inadvertently picks up the noise of a car plunging into a river. Days later he sees in a magazine a film-strip sequence of the event caught by an amateur filmmaker. He cuts out the frames and turns them into a rudimentary flipbook to see if their motion can be recreated. Then he rephotographs them one by one onto ciné film, reanimating them as a movie. He synchronizes his recorded sound with the film and discovers that the 'blow out' of the car's tyre was the result of a gunshot. It is a slick and knowing scene, blending popular history (the Zapruder film and the incident of 1969 in which Ted Kennedy's car careered off a bridge into water, killing his passenger, Mary Jo Kopechne) and film history (the edit suite sequence in Vertov's *Man with a Movie Camera* and the investigation of photographs in Antonioni's *Blow-up*).

57 *Blow Out* (Brian de Palma, 1980), frames.



Montage Expanded

Montage fundamentally shaped the vanguard art and culture of mainland Europe between the wars. In Britain and North America its impact was far less overt, but it was still considerable. The various publications of photographer Bill Brandt's work in Britain are illuminating here. At several points Brandt connected directly with cinema. For *Picture Post* magazine he shot on the set of Michael Powell's and Emeric Pressburger's war satire *The Life and Death of Colonel Blimp* (1942).[17] He took portraits of British film directors for *Lilliput* magazine in 1949.[18] The two publications were under the editorial influence of Stefan Lorant, an emigré who brought

from continental Europe new approaches to layout. For *Picture Post* Lorant refined the classical photo story. Brandt's 'The Perfect Parlourmaid' (1939) was typical. Across five pages it narrates the activities of a head parlourmaid of a wealthy home, from 'preparing the Master's bath' to 'serving nightcaps in the drawing-room'. The photo story was an adaptable if conservative form that fitted documentary photography into a familiar 'day in the life' structure. No image stands alone, each opening smoothly on to the next aided by captions. Many of Brandt's shots even resemble film stills of the period. They were often carefully prepared and collaborative, using friends as models (it is Bill himself who is served dinner by his uncle's parlour-maid in the final image).[19] To *Lilliput* Lorant introduced pointed juxtapositions, which were already a staple of European publications, such as the German *Der Querschnitt* and the Belgian *Variétés*. Drawing on the burgeoning archives of press photos, Lorant would assemble satirical and anarchic combinations with formal similarities: the face of a cat with the face of Garbo; or Adolf Hitler with Charlie Chaplin (who were born on the same day).[20]

In his first book *The English at Home* (1936), Brandt used this technique with his own images, often to highlight the class structure of British society (e.g., east London children playing in the street contrast with a child's birthday party in wealthier west London). His second book, *A Night in London* (1938), was more ambitious, fusing juxtaposition with a photo-story structure.[21] The book weaves across the city from dusk to dawn, taking in night workers, casino gamblers, pub life, policemen on duty, prostitutes, suburban dinners and upper-class parties. Many of the shots were staged and lit. Throughout the book Brandt's camera hovers between involvement and distance. One spread contrasts a scene of leisure in a Kensington drawing room with what we read as a simultaneous view of the kitchen below, where tired cooks and housemaids are finishing their day. Although they are posing, the people act as if absorbed and unaware of the camera. The result is an oddly ungrounded vantage point, drifting in and out of the scenes. This fascinated but detached approach was in part a consequence of Brandt's own wealthy emigré status: he belonged everywhere and nowhere. But while this style was unusual in photography, it was common in documentary



58 Spread from the photo-essay 'The Perfect Parlourmaid', *Picture Post*, IV/4 (29 July 1939). Photographs by Bill Brandt.



59 Photo-juxtaposition by Stefan Lorant for *Lilliput* magazine, reproduced in Lorant's anthology *Chamberlain and the Beautiful Llama and 101 More Juxtapositions* (London, 1940).



60 Spread from Bill Brandt's book *A Night in London* (London, 1938).

film. For example, the spectral overview mixing social realism and poetic estrangement can be found in Humphrey Jennings's classic short films *Spare Time* (1939) and *Listen to Britain* (1942).[22]

Any orchestration of images is montage, although the term is often narrowly understood as an opposition to the straight photograph. Bertolt Brecht's famously political call from the 1920s for a practice of montage is often read as such:

> A photograph of the Krupp works or the AEG tells us nothing about these institutions. Actual reality has slipped into the functional. The reification of human relations – the factory, say – means that they are no longer explicit. So something must in fact be *built up*, something artificial, something posed.[23]

Taken literally, this is an argument for montage of the kind associated with Dada or John Heartfield, with anti-realist staging, or with the use of text to refunction or question the image. Even so, sets and sequences can also be used to modify and modulate images in a reflexive manner close to Brecht's demand for the 'built-up'. Accumulation, repetition, seriality and sequences are certainly less assertive than overt juxtaposition. The difference is that in these modes the photographs can appear as single shots *and* as elements of a larger whole. This expanded definition helps make sense of what at first seems like an absence of montage in North American visual culture.[24] The approach of the photographer Walker Evans is notable here. He was famously sceptical of the popular photo-story format and the didactic use of photography as public information or propaganda. Too often image and text worked to secure specific meanings, to head-off ambiguity and deny space for the viewer. This was at odds with Evans' aspiration to work in the 'documentary style', but as an artist. *American Photographs* (1938), his first and most complex book, is an attempt to balance the often conflicting demands of factual description and poetic connection. At first glance the book seems a long way from montage. There is one photograph per spread, placed on the right. Nearly all of them are formal, straight shots with little hint of narrative. Even so, the sequencing entices the viewer into active decoding of relations between the images.[25] Lincoln Kirstein hinted at this in the essay included in *American Photographs*:

> Physically the pictures in this book exist as separate prints. They lack the surface, obvious continuity of the moving picture, which by its physical nature compels the observer to perceive a series of images as parts of a whole. But these photographs, of necessity seen singly, are not conceived as isolated pictures made by the camera turned indiscriminately here and there. In intention and in effect they exist as a collection of statements deriving from and presenting a consistent attitude. Looked at in sequence they are overwhelming in their exhaustiveness of detail, their poetry of contrast, and, for those who wish to see it, their moral implication. Evans develops what we might call a conceptual palimpsest in which

the memory and implications of each new photograph are mentally superimposed on the preceding one, while allowing for the kinds of forward and backward movement denied to cinema's flow.[26] For example, a shot of the front of a New Orleans barber's shop is followed by a shot of the dilapidated interior of a barber's shop in Atlanta, then by a shot of disused cars in a breaker's yard in Pennsylvania. A number of connections and associations are possible, but the unforced layout of the book leaves them as separate as they are linked.

Montage as orchestration assumes a different character when it takes up the snapshot, which announces itself as much more of a fragment. As we saw earlier, the snapshot became artistically significant when everyday life itself began to be experienced as a form of montage, that is, as a set of disarticulated moments increasingly unlikely to cohere. For many, Robert Frank's book *The Americans* (1958–9) marked the emergence of a highly subjective reportage modelled on the snapshot. Up to that point reportage had developed either towards the crystalline freezing of movement typified by Henri Cartier-Bresson or the meticulous formality of Evans.[27] Cartier-Bresson's 'decisive moments' flirted with the shapelessness of modern life only to rescue it through the perfected composition of the single, beautiful photograph. By contrast, Frank exploited excessive blur, off-kilter framing and other half-controlled accidents, recoding them as signs of a fundamentally fractured post-war experience. His photography emerged from a careful balance of Beat culture outsiderism and thorough immersion in the chaos of a world of contradictory signs. Frank's moments were rarely privileged as ecstatic or traumatic guarantees of the 'nowness' of the everyday. At times his aleatory slices of 1950s America seemed almost random and



61–63 Pages from Walker Evans's *American Photographs* (New York, 1938).

indecisive, no more important than any other. Here Frank was marking out a problem that has since become central to contemporary photographers: how to depict the encroaching banality of modern life – a banality of time as much as things – while neither succumbing to it nor transforming it into something else. Frank offered no answers, but set out the problem for others to explore. His images were informed by the dynamics of cinema, and certainly they often resemble the jitteriness of hand-held movie frames. But in retrospect we can see that it was the emergence of television, perhaps more than cinema, that dislodged photography from the centre of American image culture just enough to give it some critical distance and counter-cultural weight. Television introduced a far less selective kind of viewing experience, in which the screen is inserted into the fabric of daily life. The visual distraction of the ever-bright tube shaped the daily experience of images far more than the rapt attention demanded by the grand cinema screen. In this sense the significant images in *The Americans* are not the celebrated shots of alienated street life or the sad-looking jukeboxes, but the photos of television sets glowing in the corners of rooms. They foreshadow photography's eclipse and its relegation as social document in the following decades. A few months before the US publication of *The Americans* (it appeared first in France), Frank shot a feature for *Esquire* magazine titled 'A Hard Look at the New Hollywood'.[28] Among the spreads is a particularly telling juxtaposition. One image is a behind-the-scenes shot of a TV presenter, his fixed grin a sign of his ascendancy. In the other we see a bored-looking ticket seller in an Art Deco movie house, a sign of the decline in cinema-going.[29]

The photographic style of *The Americans* has much in common with a book made more than a decade before by one of Frank's mentors, Alexey Brodovitch. As art director at *Harper's Bazaar* Brodovitch refined a clean, elegant style of layout befitting the aspirant consumerism of its readership. But in 1945 he published *Ballet*, one of the first attempts to use motion blur, unusual focusing, errant exposure and wayward darkroom printing in an expressive documentary book. Dance and theatre photography of the time sought the pinnacle of the gesture in pin-sharp focus, but neither the moments nor the photographic technique are 'decisive' in *Ballet*. It is the boldness of the layout that holds the



64 Spread from Alexey Brodovitch's *Ballet*, *1945* (J. J. Augustin, New York).

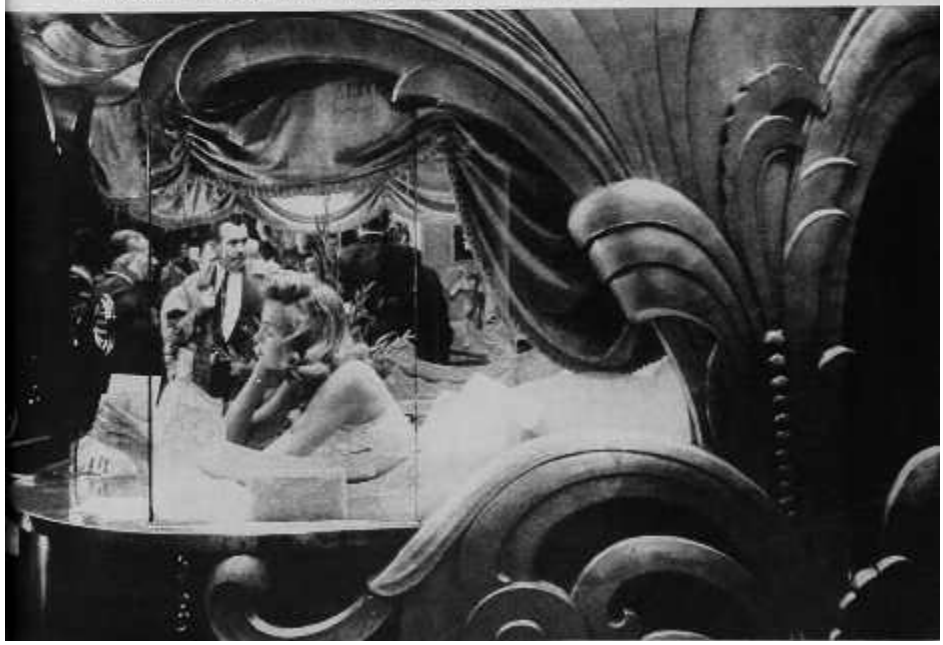
images together. Shot in New York during the rehearsals of visiting ballet companies in the 1930s, the scrappy but evocative photos were set out full-bleed on the page and butted together, the landscape format suggestive of a cinema frame.[30] The effect is supple and fluid, moving the viewer ceaselessly from one spread to the next.

William Klein's influential *Life Is Good and Good for You in New York: Trance Witness Revels* (1956) had the subject matter of Frank's *The Americans* with a design close to Brodovitch's *Ballet*.[31] Klein's trademark bustling and energetic street shots are printed in visceral high contrast, well suited to the consumer-driven, brash and mediatized New York. He made use of the newly available Photostat copier to design his 'anti-book', as he called it. Almost every spread offers a new layout idea, from teeming sequences of sidewalk scenes to sharp juxtapositions between citizens and the advertising that surrounds them. Despite the tight and highly organized framing, Klein declared: 'only the sequencing counts . . . like in a movie'.[32] Published the same year, Ed van der Elsken's *Love on the Left Bank* was even more explicitly cinematic. Van der Elsken was a pioneer of diaristic first-person documentary photography and later film. Having shot the daily lives of his bohemian friends in Paris, he organized the photos into a fictional narrative, held together by captions. The structure is a simple love story (with a surprisingly filmic 'flashback' at the end)

65 An illustrated page from 'A Hard Look at the New Hollywood', *Esquire* magazine (March 1959). Photographs by Robert Frank.



Even if TV, the lens of Elton is drawn in anticipation of a camera smile, and never (ever) takes a telling look.





66 Spreads from William Klein, *Life Is Good and Good For You in New York: Trance Witness Revels* (London, 1956).

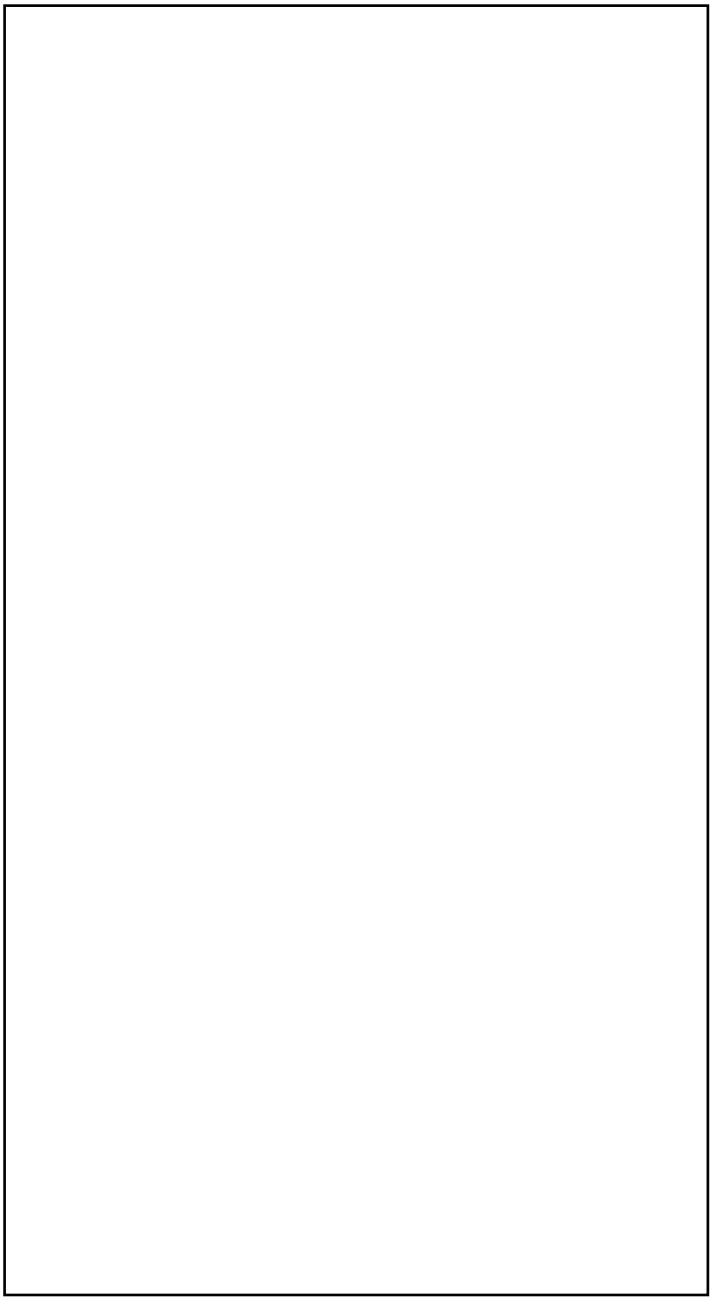
made vivid by attention to details of the milieu. Van der Elsken's camera pores over the particulars of clothing, interiors and faces, capturing the innate theatricality of his friends. Their gestures and mannerisms are so archly self-conscious that it is as if they are permanently performing, smoothing the book's passage between documentary and fiction. When *Picture Post* serialized the story for British audiences it announced: 'This is not a film. This is a real-life story about people who do EXIST', but the truth was somewhere in the middle.[33]



67 Spread from Ed van der Elsken, *Love on the Left Bank* (London, 1956).

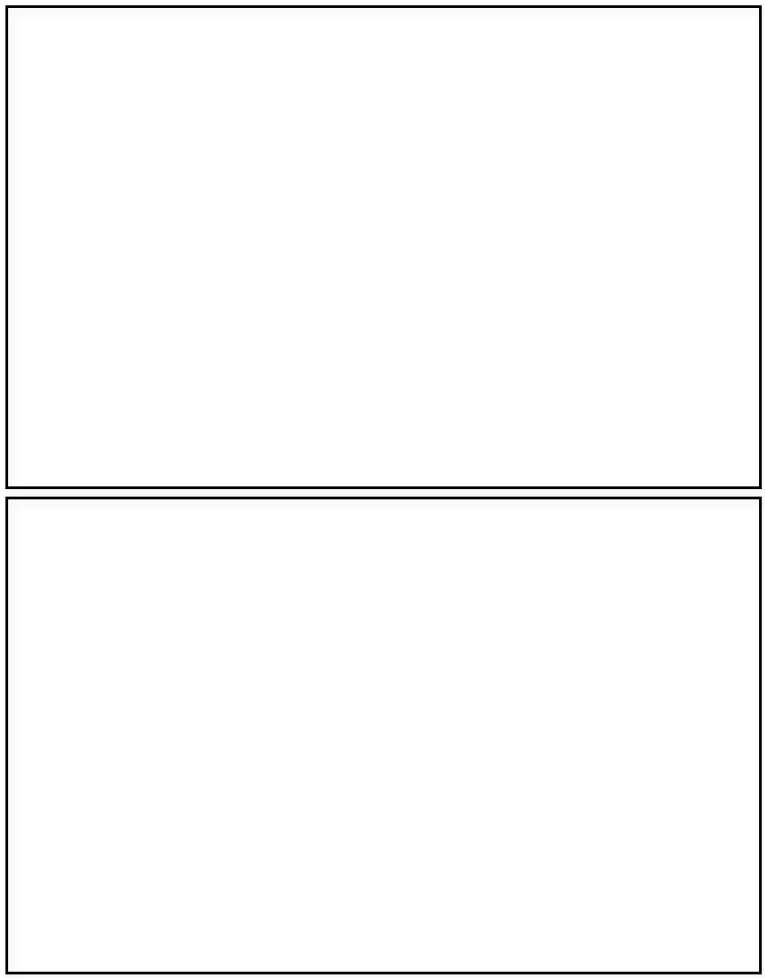
Love on the Left Bank was romantic nostalgia for an earlier Paris. Frank's *The Americans* was marked by Beat culture weariness. Klein's *New York* was caught between attraction and disgust with mass culture, close to the ambivalence of Pop Art. All three were expressions of post-war counter-culture at the onset of its suffocation by consumerism. All three photographers turned to filmmaking but took up the same concerns, making moving equivalents of their photographs. Stop a William Klein film anywhere, noted his friend the photographer-filmmaker Chris Marker, and you will see 'a Klein photograph with the same apparent disorder, the same glut of information, gestures and looks pointing in all directions, and yet at the same time governed by an organized, rigorous perspective'.[34]

Even more disenchanted was *Bye Bye Photography* (1972) by the Japanese photographer Daido Moriyama, which pushed photographic sequencing to breaking point. Along with several others (including Shomei Tomatsu, Eikoh Hosoe and Takuma Nakahira), Moriyama railed equally against the narrow conventions of photographic good taste and the repressive social order of late 1960s Japan. *Bye Bye Photography* is a bleak and relentless onslaught of dissolute frames, many appearing to



68 William Klein's film *Who Are You, Polly Magoo?* (1966), frames.

69–70 Spreads from Daido Moriyama, *Bye Bye Photography* (Tokyo, 1972).

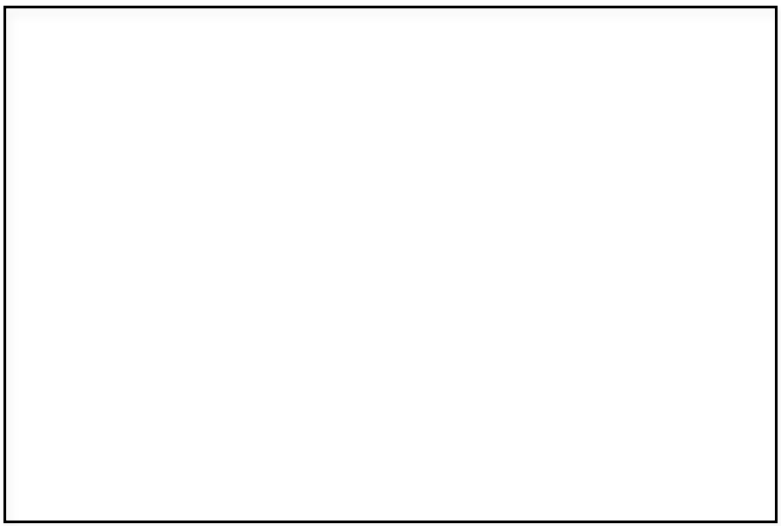


hang off the page by their sprocket holes. Any sense of social or photographic stability is junked for a roaming, churning, fractured vision. He explained:

> For me photography is not about an attempt to make a two-dimensional work of art, but by taking photo after photo, I come closer to truth and reality at the very intersection of the fragmentary nature of the world and my own personal sense of time.[35]

The images look at first like leftovers, those frames shot swiftly and carelessly to complete a roll of film. Yet, far from being an alienated work about alienation, the consistency of Moriyama's tone, sustained across 300 pages, speaks of a concentrated and focused effort to express incoherence.

Also in 1972 Robert Frank returned to publishing with a scrapbook of frame sequences and photos. *The Lines of My Hand* was once again a response to an inability to make life add up (North America's and his own). No attempt at a visual argument is made this time. Instead, he produced a book full of confessional regrets, second thoughts and disassembled bits and pieces. On the opening spread loom grainy film frames of a stark human eye superimposed on a bleak landscape. Beside them he wrote: 'Twenty-five years of looking for the right road. Postcards from everywhere. If there are any answers I have lost them.'[36] The tone and style of *The Lines of My Hand* have since become widespread in photographic publications and exhibitions, visual shorthand for ragged outsiderism. The half-cinematic, half-photographic diary has grown into a flexible genre of its own through the work of photographers such as Larry Clark, Nobuyoshi Araki, Jim Goldberg, Danny Lyon, Wolfgang Tillmans and Rinko Kawauchi.[37]



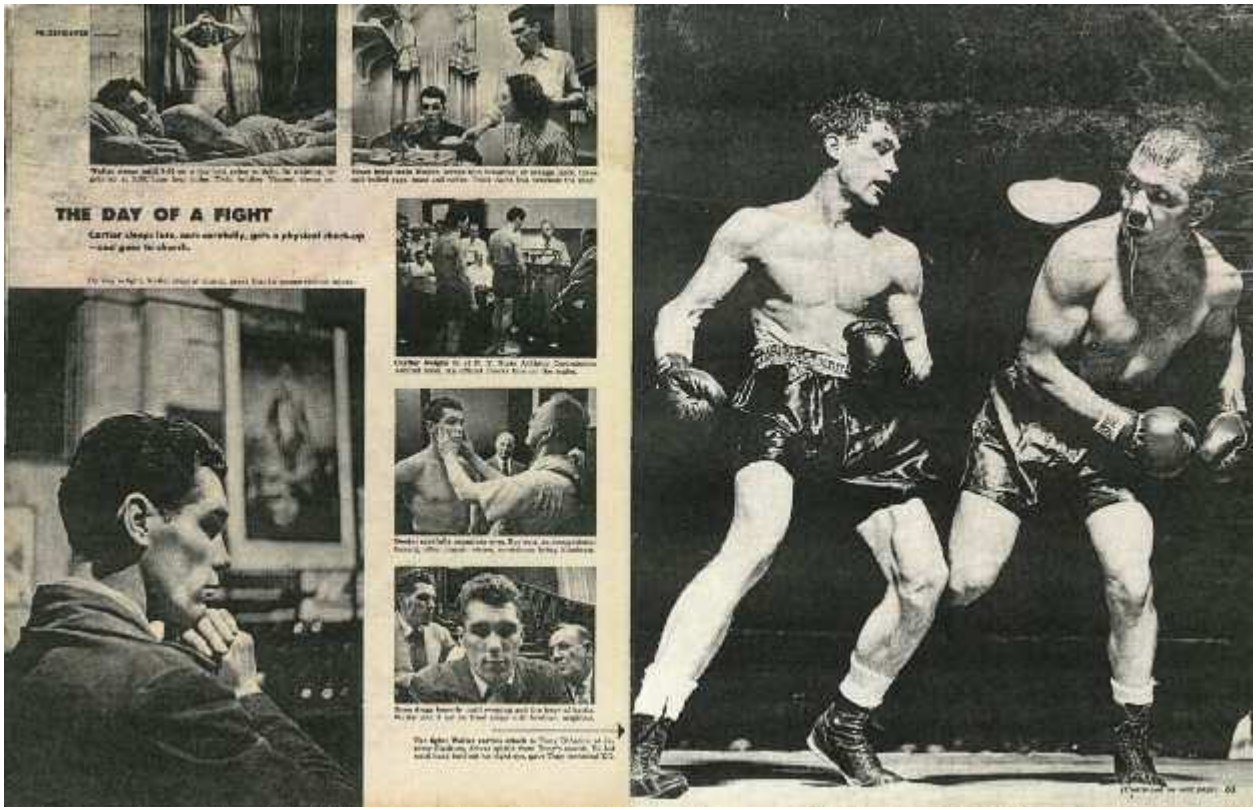
71 Opening page spread from Robert Frank, *The Lines of My Hand* (New York, 1972).

The Photo-Story Continued

In the immediate post-war years documentary photography refined the photo-story format that had borrowed heavily from narrative cinema in the 1930s. In particular, *Life* and *Look* magazines in the United States synthesized forms of shooting and editing into sequences that were formulaic, containable and saleable to other magazines internationally. They were rarely stories in the linear sense, but profiles of people or places, orchestrated across several spreads. They were made up of image-types familiar from popular film: the establishing shot, narrative shots, close-ups, cut-aways, details and summary endings.[38]

In a few instances the magazines were a training ground for film-makers. The young Stanley Kubrick worked for *Look* in the late 1940s, producing dramatic stories. *Prizefighter* (1949), one of his last assignments, describes a boxer's life as he prepares for a match. The lighting resembles film noir and the images of the fight itself have the drama of film stills. Kubrick reworked the story for his first film, the documentary short *The Day of the Fight* (1951), which he made with the same boxer.

Between the 1940s and 1960s it became popular to transfer movies directly to the page by combining film stills with dialogue and captions. These photonovels were produced in large quantities, particularly in Italy, France, Spain, China and Latin America. Cheaply printed, they were souvenirs for filmgoers, but they also extended the reach of cinema culture to rural towns without movie theatres. The publishers also invented their own stories and hired aspiring actors. In Italy, where the format was most popular, several famous actors started out as *fotoromanzo* models, including Sophia Loren and Gina Lollobrigida.[39] In general, the format was safe, supplying the narrative structures of Hollywood on a regular basis. They tended to reduce cinema's visual system to close-ups and two-shots graphic enough for their small pages. In many ways the photonovel presents photography at its most obviously cinematic, but it is also the form with the most limitations. In its direct aspiration to the flow of filmic storytelling it risks becoming an impoverished version, all too literal and mechanistic. The implied momentum is undercut by the unavoidable stillness of each image. It is also the form



72 Page spread from the photo-essay 'Prizefighter' by Stanley Kubrick, *Look* magazine (18 January 1949).

that offers photography the least space for creativity because it seems so at odds with its own stillness. As Blake Stimson has argued, the photo sequence is at its most potent when it accepts that flow is not really its forte and embraces each static image as one poetically charged fragment among others.[40] That is to say, the stillness and the gaps are as important as the pace and the connections, and it is the tension between the two that permits complexity.

The more literal and linear the story, the greater the dependence on language too. In 1930 Germaine Krull, who had made photographic illustrations for a number of narrative books, attempted to make one with no text at all.[41] It was never published, but the maquette she left behind offers an insight into her ambition and the difficulty of the task.

73 An Italian *fotoromanzo* adaptation of *Un Posto al Sole* (*A Place in the Sun*, dir. George Stevens, 1951), starring Montgomery Clift and Elizabeth Taylor (Milan, 1951).





74 Germaine Krull, opening sequence from an unpublished maquette of a wordless photo-story, 1930.

Even from the first few pages it is clear that Krull's method involved adopting cinematic devices such as the dissolve and the cross-cut.

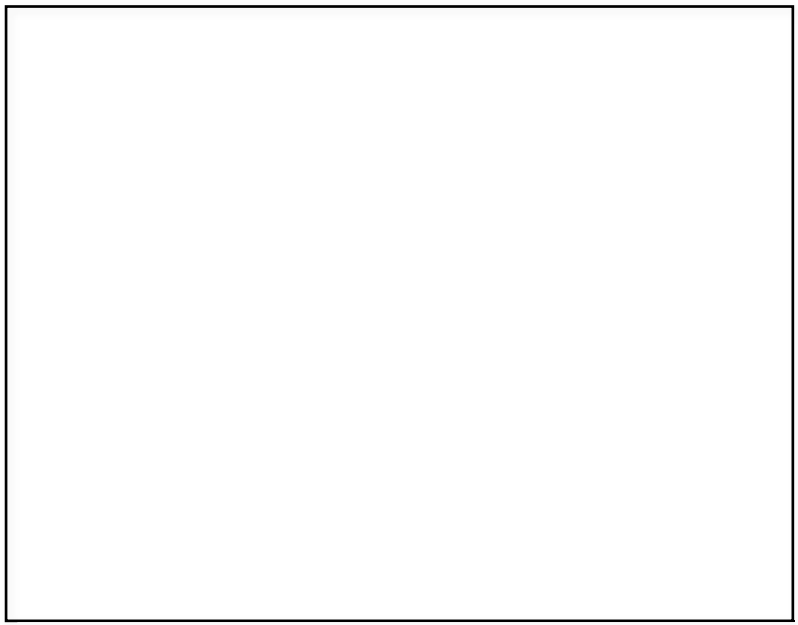
The New Critique

The photonovel began to die away in the 1960s with the rise of television, eventually becoming obsolete when domestic video made films 'possessable' and DVD supplied the supplements and commentaries beloved of fans and scholars. But as it waned the page did become the site for new forms of cinematic analysis. European filmmakers, particularly from the French New Wave, took up the book as a means of re-presenting and expanding their films. Alain Robbe-Grillet reworked his scripts written for films directed by Alain Resnais (including *L'Année dernière à Marienbad*, (1961) into *ciné-romans* or 'cine-novels'.

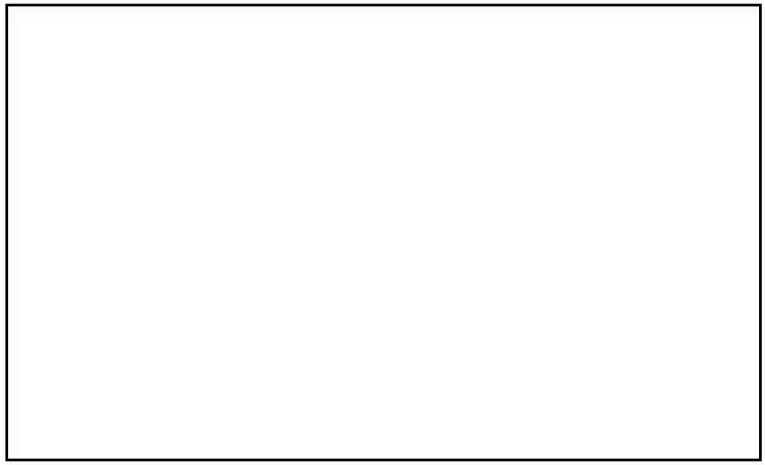
Halfway between illustrated script and novelization, he described the form as

> a detailed analysis of an audio-visual whole that is too complex and too rapid to be studied very easily during the actual projection. But the ciné-novel can also be read, by someone who has not seen the film, in the same way as a musical score; what is then communicated is a wholly mental experience, whereas the work itself [the film] is intended to be a primarily sensual experience, and this aspect of it can never really be replaced.[42]

In principle, any translation of a film into illustrated text opens up an interpretive gap. The fixed duration of a film is converted into the more private time of the reader. On the page text and image can be contemplated at will and in the process the film is always 'laid bare' to some extent. In 1965 Jean-Luc Godard suggested that 'one could imagine the critique of a film as the text and its dialogue, with photos and a few words of commentary'.[43] Godard published print versions of nearly all his films of the 1960s. Some were straightforward illustrated scripts, others more experimental. The book based on *Une femme mariée* (1964)



75 Spread from Alain Robbe-Grillet's ciné-novel of *L'Année dernière à Marienbad* (dir. Alain Resnais, 1962). New York, 1962.



76 Spread from Jean-Luc Godard, *Journal d'une femme mariée* (Paris, 1965).

recreates the episodic first-person structure of the film as word / image scrapbook.[44] Where the film shows the lead woman confronted with representations of commodified femininity on billboards, magazines and movie posters, the book appropriates various layout styles from popular culture.

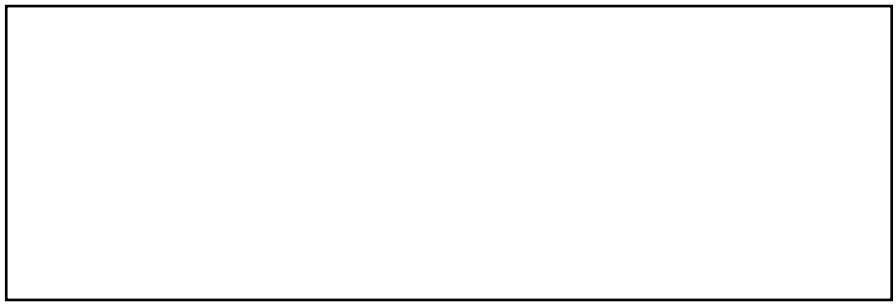
In 1974 Alain Resnais published *Repérages*, a book of photographs taken while looking for film locations. The images of streets and architectural details suggest an update of Eugène Atget's melancholic photographs of empty Paris, famously described as resembling the scenes of crimes. But, just as Resnais' films slip back and forth across time and memory, his book complicates the tense of photography. *Repérages* offers photographs that are both retrospective records and prospective ideas, made in anticipation of events yet to come.[45]

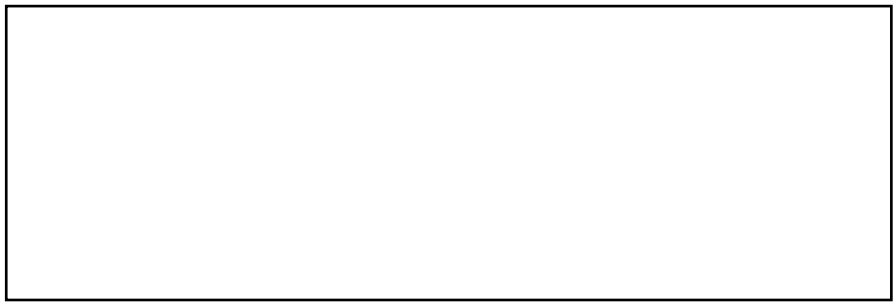
The filmic page took an explicitly analytical turn in the early 1970s with the beginnings of the more formalized and academic study of cinema. Reviewers and critics had tended to watch films in movie theatres along with everyone else. The emergence of film theorists – and even the term 'film theory' – came about when it became possible for specialists to access films via table-top Steenbeck viewers in archives and universities. Now movies could be stopped, started, reversed, repeated, played in slow motion and returned to at will. Films lent themselves to extremely close reading, or 'textual analysis', focusing on specific scenes or sequences. Access to optical printers enabled theorists to illustrate their analyses with sequences of frame grabs, rather than relying on misleading production stills. The result was a sudden profusion of columns and grids of film frames in specialist publications such as *Screen*, *Camera Obscura* and *Wide Angle*. The culmination of an intense decade of textual analysis came with Raymond Bellour's influential *L'Analyse du film* (1979), a set of chapter-length studies of film sequences (three from Hitchcock's films), each illustrated with upwards of 250 frames. Today, of course, a watered-down version of textual analysis informs all mainstream film viewing. The pause and rewind buttons along with online viewing have made analysts of us all to some extent. The screen has become the site of its own analysis without so much need for the illustrated page.

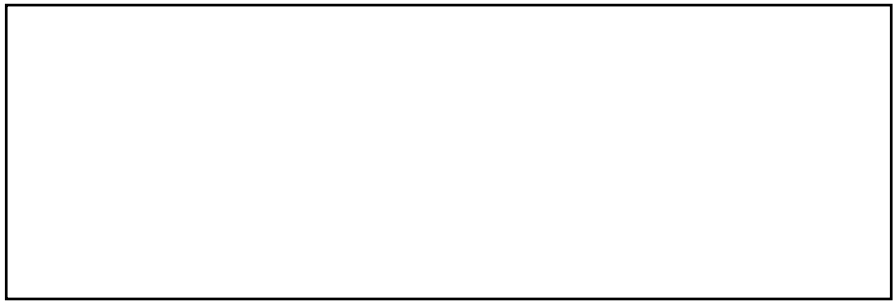
New Challenges

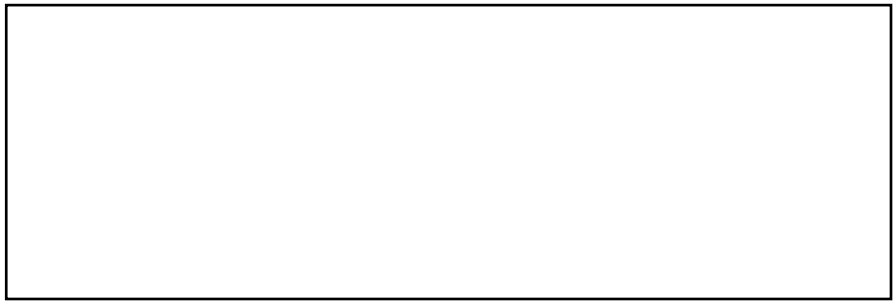
The book form has proved remarkably resilient to changes in viewing habits and responsive to shifts in our experience of the moving image.

77–80 Images from *Réperages* by Alain Resnais (Paris, 1974).







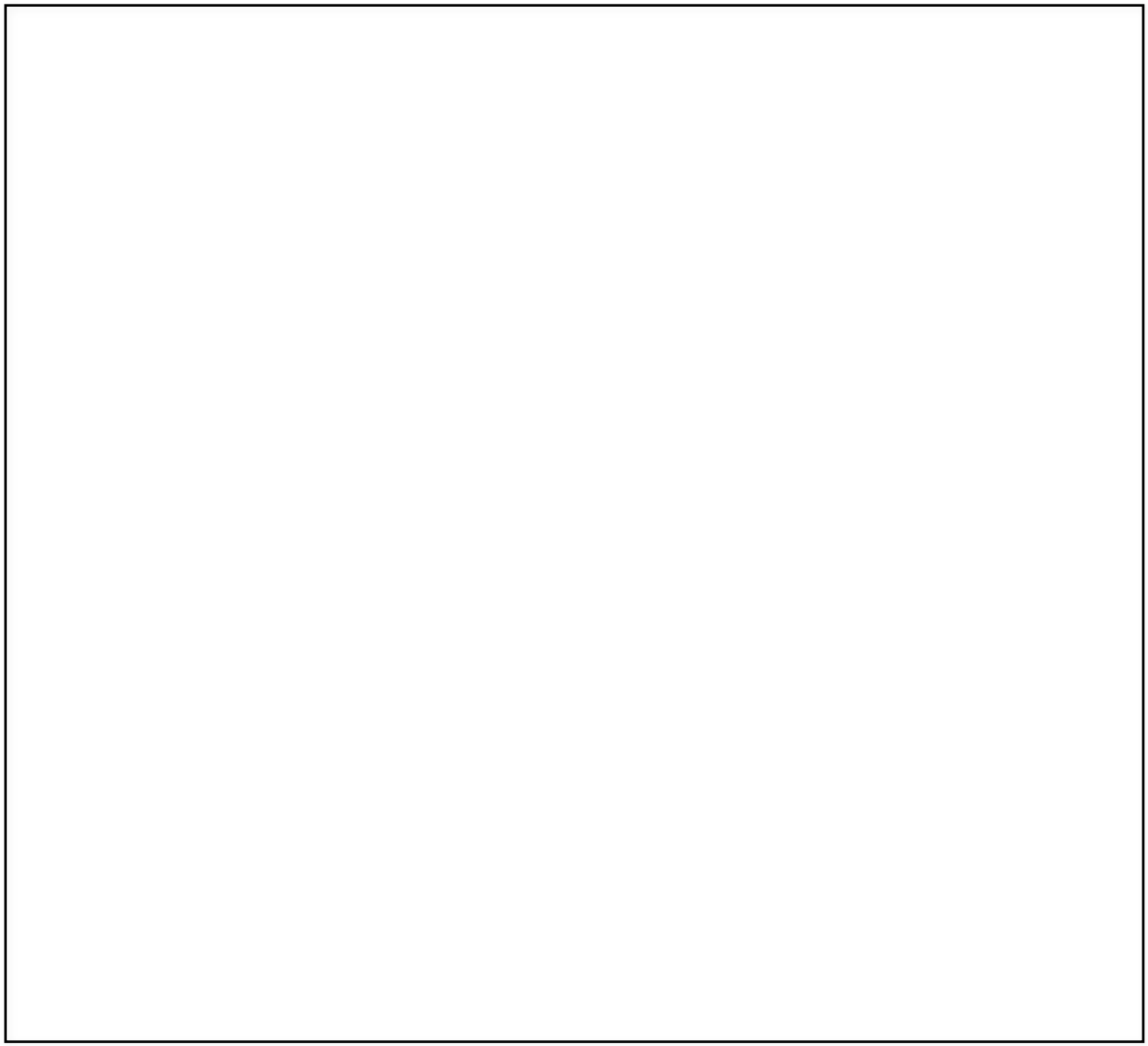


By way of a conclusion let us consider three recent publications that exemplify this in different ways.

Paolo Gasparini's *Megalopolis* (2000) is a print equivalent of the multi-narrative films dealing with the complexity of the contemporary city, such as Robert Altman's *Short Cuts* (1993) and Fernando Meirelles' *City of God* (2002). The book's pages are cut horizontally into three sections, a photograph on each, enabling the reader to assemble their own spreads and make their own associations. Gasparini shot in Los Angeles, Mexico and São Paulo, all in one style, looking for similar motifs. He adds to the density with multiple exposures, photos within photos and overlapping frames. The result is a hybrid city at once real and imaginary. Moreover, the spreads are endlessly different but endlessly the same. Like life for many of the inhabitants of these cities, the book is promising but pessimistic too, seductive yet full of false possibilities and empty choices.

Over the course of three decades the city has been a central theme for the artist and writer Victor Burgin. From the early 1970s he has conceived of his work, most often a mixture of writing, photographs and latterly video, as a practice belonging 'somewhere between the gallery and the book', as he put it. His relation to the book form has been consistently innovative, aided by a long-standing association with his graphic designers.

In the book *Venise* Burgin re-imagines for the page his short film of that title commissioned by the city of Marseilles. It takes as its cue the novel *D'entre les morts* by Pierre Boileau and Thomas Narcejac, which had been adapted by Alfred Hitchcock as *Vertigo* (1958). The novel was set in Paris and Marseilles, while *Vertigo* was set in San Francisco. Burgin's film and book take up the structure of the original story of a man losing his lover to suicide, only to be trapped by his desire to resurrect her in some way from his memory. Into this Burgin folds a meditation on the relation between love and cities, colonial and post-colonial Marseilles, and the place of the image in personal memory and public history. The book is a poetic weave of quotations, plot fragments and video grabs. A time-code runs along the top of each page, enabling us to sense the difference between the 'reading time' of the book and 'viewing time' of the absent film. In addition, each verso page includes a square of the image from the previous page and each recto a square from the page to come. But



81 Spread from *Megalopolis: Los Angeles, Mexico, San Paolo*. Photographs by Paolo Gasparini.

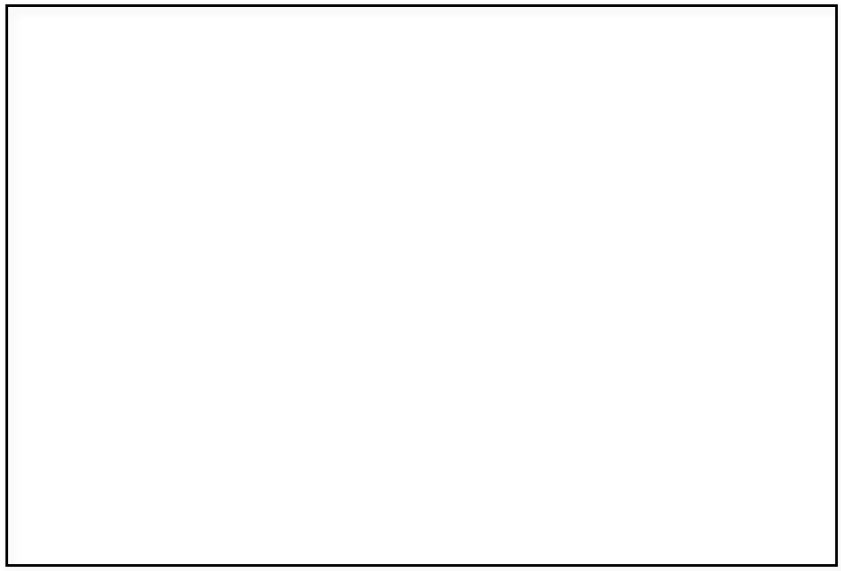
Burgin's unfolding of the themes is far from linear. Ideas and connections crop up as if in a dream-like reverie of mixed cities, mixed media and mixed memory.

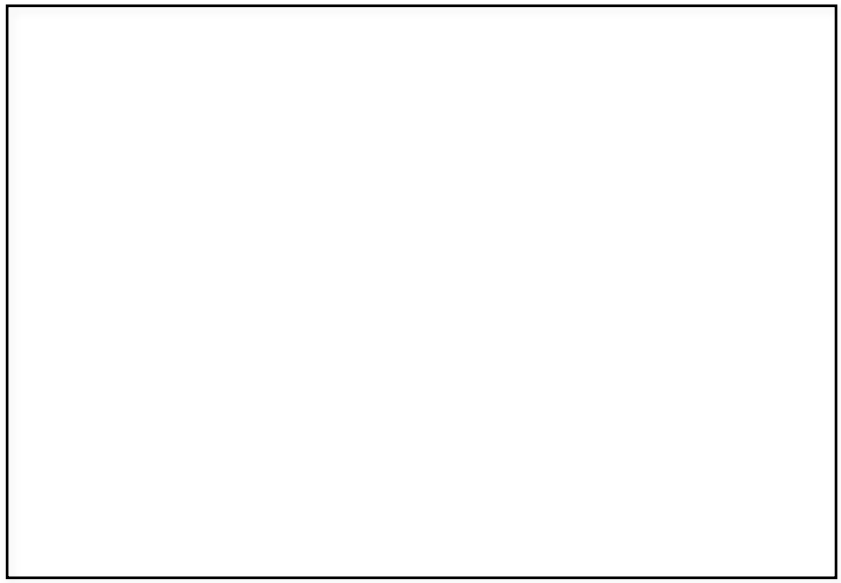
Jules Spinatsch's *Temporary Discomfort* (2005) is an experimental documentary of the world economic summits in Davos, Genoa, New

York, Evian and Geneva.[46] It switches between documentary styles – surveillance, paparazzi, landscapes and portraits. Spinatsch assembles a jigsaw-like assessment of what it is to photograph in these places, while the actual work of the summits is invisible, hidden behind a cloak of ostentatious and sinister security. *Temporary Discomfort* is a pessimistic and austere book, but many contemporary photographers share its central concern. How can one make apparent the gap between the facelessness of world economic power and individual citizenship, between the economically abstract and the materially visible, and between the independently produced image and the systems of global news management? And more to the point, what is the role of the still photograph in all this?

82 Spread from Victor Burgin, *Venise*, 1997. Design by Lucy Or Robert, London.

83–84 Spreads from Jules Spinatsch, *Temporary Discomfort Chapter I–V: Davos, Genoa, New York, Evian, Geneva* (Baden, 2005).





three

Photography in Film

In *Film* (1965), Samuel Beckett's only film, Buster Keaton plays a solitary man deeply troubled by signs of his own presence in the world. They are a source of existential horror and he wishes to be rid of them, to disappear beyond all perception. To film such a story presents something of a challenge, since the very presence of an observing camera would seem to make the task impossible. Beckett turns the paradox into the film's theme. Keaton is shot from behind so that the camera cannot see or be seen by his eyes (or *eye*, as it turns out: an eye patch makes him as monocular as the observing lens). He scurries past people in the street, avoiding their gaze. At home he sets about purging his room. He pulls down the tattered blind to shut out the sunlight, puts his coat over the mirror, removes from the wall a photo of a sculpted head with looming eyes, puts his cats out and covers the birdcage and goldfish bowl. Thinking he is truly alone, he sits down with a folder of photographs. Over his shoulder we see him peruse a set of images of his own life, from a babe in arms to a recent portrait. They are frontal family-album poses, ritual pictures that mark time. One by one he tears them up violently, stamping on the pieces. The photo of himself as a baby is on tough paper and difficult to destroy, as if it were the last stubborn proof. He slumps back exhausted, only to catch sight of the observing presence behind him. Startled, he confronts it, but instead of seeing the camera, he sees another version of himself, in counter-shot, smirking imperiously as if it is he who has been watching himself. The cruel moral of *Film* is revealed. We are doomed to live with our own self-awareness. The more traces we destroy, the more acutely we sense ourselves. Horrified, he covers his eyes. As his hands

85 Production still from Samuel Beckett's *Film* (Alan Schneider, 1965).



drop a close-up of an eyelid fills the frame. The lid lifts, the eye stares into the camera, the frame freezes and the words 'FILM by Samuel Beckett' superimpose.

Film is a simple and profound examination of cinematic perception. Even so, its use of still photographs is quite conventional. Were we to survey all the moments in which cinema deploys photos (and they are countless), we would find most often they concern its complex status as evidence.[1] Whether in mainstream or avant-garde, modern or post-modern film, the 'proof' of photography as memory or history is nearly always at stake.

In his book *Camera Lucida*, Roland Barthes attempts to locate an 'essence' of photography. He is led to the medium's relation to time and the trace. A photograph is an existential index of a place, a person, a thing or a scene 'which has been' at a particular moment. Something was there and a camera was there to record and fix it. As such, the photograph is marked by the trauma and enigma of death. Barthes was well aware that this mark is usually covered over, buried below other meanings (death is not what comes readily to mind when we look at food photography, fashion or advertising), but that founding condition is always there.[2] Strip away what 'tames' a photograph – text, context, other images, voice-over and so forth – and what remains is the uncertainty of a spectral presence. For Barthes, the images that dramatize this essential condition are the most powerful. 'Ultimately', he concluded, 'photography is subversive not when it frightens, repels, or even stigmatizes, but when it is *pensive*, when it thinks.'[3] Taking his cue from Barthes, the film theorist Raymond Bellour described as 'pensive' the response of the spectator faced with a photograph or freeze frame in a film.[4] Pensiveness is a suspension, a moment of anticipation when things are in the balance. Literally and psychologically, the still image in film causes a pause.

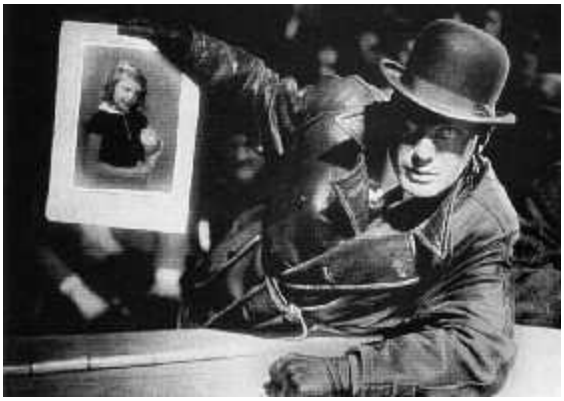
Viewing a photograph in a film is very different from viewing it directly. Film tends to overstate the photograph's difference, while presenting that difference as if it were its essence. We see the photograph exaggerated by those qualities that distinguish it from film: its stillness, its temporal fixity, its objecthood, its silence, its deathliness, even. Perhaps the purest illustration of this is an early film by Roberto Rossellini, the comic parable *La macchina ammazzacattivi* (*The Machine for Killing Bad People*, 1948). A photographer in a small Italian post-war village is granted by a man whom he assumes to be a saint the ability to kill people with his camera. This he can do not by photographing them directly, but by re-photographing photographs of them. At the instant he shoots, the victim – wherever they are – freezes for eternity in the pose they strike in their photo, as if turned to stone. The town doctor calls it 'total psycho-motor paralysis' (which is not a bad description of photography). The photographer begins by eliminating those he is convinced

are evil, but soon finds that he is unable to judge with certainty. The saint turns out to be a demon doing the devil's work. It is a fantastic story that carries within it a reflexive meditation on the differing accounts of time and mortality at work in the moving and still image. The wild premise ought to make it an exception in Rossellini's otherwise soberly realist œuvre. Even so, cinematic realism is based on a strong faith and reverence for the photographic image as a trace or 'death mask' of the subject before the camera. *The Machine for Killing Bad People* adheres closely to this tenet, if only to exaggerate it, rather than put it to work in a realist aesthetic.[5]

Cinema tends to dwell on the photograph as a mute and intransigent object from the past. Not surprisingly, the types of photograph to which cinema is attracted are those that already emphasize these qualities on some level. Police, forensic, news and family-album pictures are the most obviously 'cinegenic'. Not all film genres understand photographs in this way, but it is obvious which ones do: films noir, detective movies, melodramas, mysteries and histories. If one-fifth of all films noir feature photographs, it is because so many of the traits of the genre have an obviously photographic potential (the troublesome and haunting past, the totemic status of evidence, betrayal, blackmail and so forth).[6] When photographs have featured in more recent cinema, more often than not the films are 'neo-noirs'. Think of the fake childhood photographs given to the 'replicant' cyborgs as tokens of a past they never really had in *Blade Runner* (Ridley Scott, 1982); or the Polaroid evidence accrued by the hero in *Memento* (Christopher Nolan, 2000), the idyllic family snaps at the heart of *One Hour Photo* (Mark Romanek, 2002) or the hired killer who is also a Weegee-like photographer recording his deeds in *The Road to Perdition* (Sam Mendes, 2002).

When the policeman in Fritz Lang's *M* (1931) holds up to the massed crowd a studio portrait of a recently murdered young girl, the image does more than present her likeness. It implies her innocence and ignorance of her death. Twenty-five years later, Lang reversed the idea. *Beyond a Reasonable Doubt* (1956) shows us how easily crime scene photos can be faked and that the hero has been framed. Lang's films demonstrate the two competing claims made on behalf of the filmed photograph:





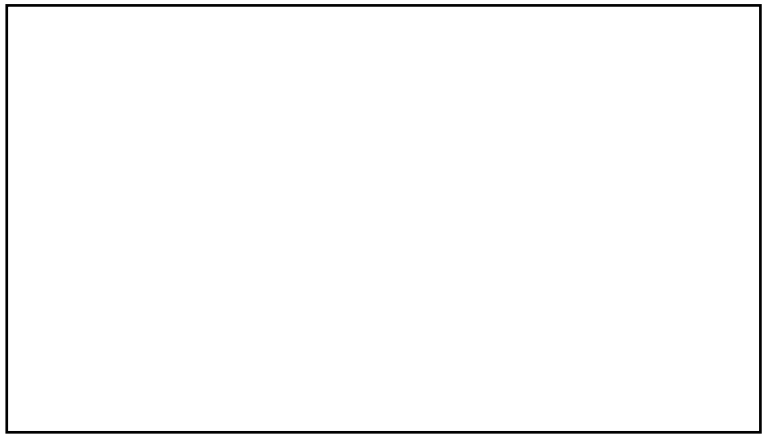
86 Jude Law as the assassin/photographer in *Road to Perdition* (Sam Mendes, 2002).

87 Publicity still from *M* (Fritz Lang, 1931).

indisputable and disputable proof. But, even when photographs appear to be undone and revealed as misleading or unreliable, they still tend to make that first presumption of uncomplicated testimony. To say that photographs lie rather than tell the truth, however, is, as Stanley Cavell put it, to 'replace the village idiot with the village explainer'.[7] Most of the photographs that surround us operate somewhere *between* fact and fiction, *between* history and memory, *between* the objective and the subjective.

Since film is prone to overemphasize the evidential in photographs, it is instructive to look beyond that bulk of films that see it simply as proof or its inverse. For example, can photography have a relation to the future? The director Nicolas Roeg once described cinema as a time machine, far better suited to mapping the convolutions of the mind than the narrowly linear narratives that dominate. His films are peppered with photographs, but rarely are they simple moments from time past. In *Don't Look Now* (1973), the most banal of images becomes a dreadful premonition. The opening scene crosscuts between a couple in their country house and their daughter playing outside in the garden. The husband (Donald Sutherland) examines slides on a lightbox of his work on the restoration of a Venetian church. In the foreground of one slide there is small figure in a red coat. Carelessly, Sutherland knocks water over it and Roeg cuts to the daughter in a similar red coat, drowning in the garden pond. He cuts back to the slide and the red colour creeps out across the image, oozing from the figure like a stigmata or blood under a

88 *Don't Look Now* (Nicolas Roeg, 1973), frame.



microscope. Sensing something awful, Sutherland rushes outside, but it is too late to save the girl. It is an unnerving scene, not least because we are unaccustomed to seeing photos as predictions. The mute photograph 'speaks' of what is to come. As the story moves to Venice, the entire film is haunted not just by the daughter's death but also by that animate photograph, which seems to foreshadow all that follows as the couple struggle with the scrambling of time and causality that comes with mourning.

Chris Marker's science-fiction film *La Jetée* (1962, released in 1964) is one of cinema's most complex articulations of time, a feat all the greater for its seemingly limited means. It is composed almost entirely of still images. Its closest genre is the photonovel, so often derided as a 'low' form inferior to literature and cinema proper, as we have seen.[8] Nevertheless, *La Jetée* addresses all the major themes that have preoccupied serious European filmmakers since 1945, including memory, history, war, identity, loss, desire and the uncertainty of the image. In less than half an hour it weaves a philosophical web across past, present and future. It announces itself as 'a story of a man marked by an image from childhood'. The image is of a man's death – a portent of the protagonist's own, it turns out – but he is equally marked by an image of a lost lover (there are allusions to Hitchcock's *Vertigo* and Cocteau's *Orphée* in the hero's pursuit of an elusive woman 'from the other side of time'). *La Jetée* is set in a subterranean prison camp in a post-apocalyptic Paris. The hero



89 *La Jetée* (Chris Marker, 1963), frames.

is being held as a guinea pig for scientists who send him, via his imagination, first into the past and then into the future to seek a way to avoid mankind's extinction. The film combines frames extracted from filmed footage, documentary photos, archival images and staged narrative shots. It squeezes every variant of time from its images of motionless ruins, birds in flight, stuffed animals in museums, statues, fleeting smiles and pensive frowns. Marker articulates them with an equally broad array of devices – dissolves, rostrum pans and zooms, narrative sequences, sharp juxtapositions, flowing music and a strong narrative voice-over. Played out in a timeless, placeless limbo, the story of *La Jetée* could have been evoked only through stills. It is the form best suited to express the tension between stasis and momentum, between the weight of memory and the possibility of a future.[9] As we have seen, it is the inevitable gaps that are characteristic of photo-stories, and rather than trying to

overcome them Marker uses them to speak of loss, of the patchy nature of the imagination and the promise of redemption.[10] *La Jetée* is not the only film to have been made from stills, but it is perhaps the only one to have understood the potential of the form so profoundly and exploited it so well. As a result the film itself seems as outside of time as the story it tells, as fresh today as it was in 1962. It belongs to no genre, has few dateable traits and a hybrid grammar all its own.

One brief sequence of *La Jetée* is moving footage. The hero is drugged and in a dream state. First we see what he imagines in a series of languorous dissolves between still images: he is remembering his lover. She too is sleeping but restless. Suddenly she blinks repeatedly into the camera in real time. A harsh cut to the still face of a scientist ends the shot before we can be sure what we have seen. Marker offers us the moving image right on the cusp between the stillness of sleep and the stirrings of wakefulness. The woman's blinking eyes mimic the shutter of the camera or the gate of the projector and return our own surprise at the image springing to life.

Something similar was at play in the films of Andy Warhol made around the same time, such as *Sleep* (1963). But it was *Kiss* (1964), a string of three-minute shots of couples in almost motionless embrace, that caused Irving Blum to question his vision. 'I looked and looked and looked and looked and looked and I said, "It's a still. It's not a motion picture at all" . . . at one moment I remember Marisol blinking, and the *shocked* response of everybody in the audience.'[11]

The Past Redefined

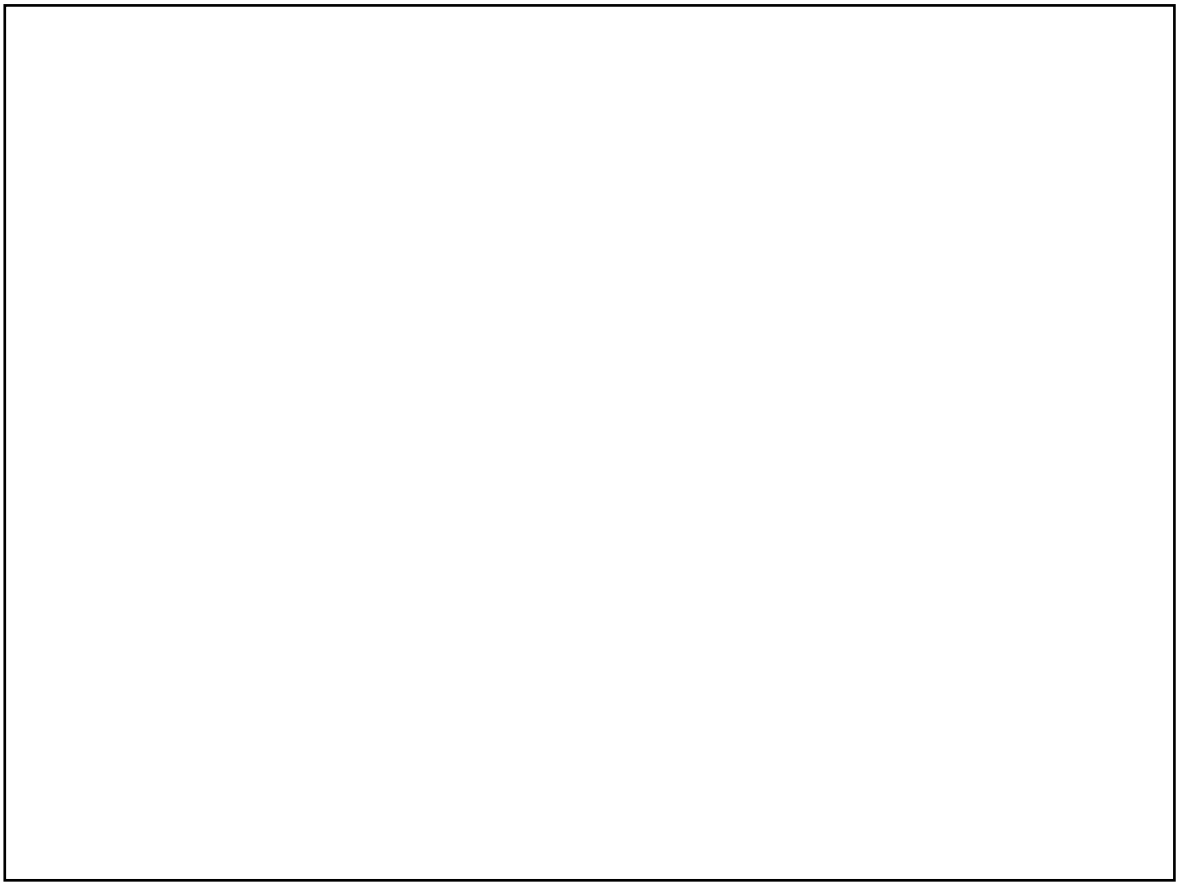
In Wim Wenders's *Wings of Desire* (1987), two angels wander the divided city of Berlin unseen by the living, eavesdropping on their daily routines. They watch as the citizens go about their lives, caught as they are between the upheavals of the past and the uncertainty of the future. In the grand Staatsbibliothek an old man is seated at a reading desk, an angel at his side. He is consulting a book of August Sander's portrait photographs, the great survey of German citizens that was cut short by the Second

World War. The man is old enough to have been one of the three young farmers on their way to a dance in 1914 in the famous image reproduced on the cover of the book.[12] As he browses the pages he ruminates on the nature of history and his own life, and we are given to see Sander's project not as an uncomplicated historical record, but as a set of images to be read in dialogue with their own time and their own people, to be measured against their experience. 'What is wrong with peace that its inspiration doesn't endure and that its story is hardly told?' the old man asks himself. Wenders cuts briefly to old newsreel footage of the carnage left by a wartime bombing raid. Over time the generations caught up in the war are dying out and direct experience of that inter-war period has all but disappeared. As a result, Sander's photographs have become much more of a factual record than they were in their time or were perhaps intended to be. For younger people who gaze upon them now they are a definitive record of the period and of 'the way things were'. But in this brief and simple scene, of a man weighing the pictures against his own memory, something of the provisional nature of Sander's images is permitted to resurface in a sliding between present and past.[13]

Sander's project was revisited more recently by the artist Fiona Tan. Her video installation *Countenance* (2002) comprises 250 contemporary portraits of Berliners drawn from the diversity of the city. The citizens pose as if for photographs but are filmed for half a minute or so, not unlike Warhol's *Screen Tests*. Tan used the movie camera on its side to produce a portrait-format image. The 'sitters' move a little and the world often goes on behind them, betraying the contrivance of the whole set-up. Many of the compositions reference Sander's own. His famous portrait of a baker with his great pudding bowl is restaged, this time with the baker's bowl rotating on an automated mixer. Sander's attempt to survey the social order of his time was always a little hubristic and has even less currency today, when appearances generate as much doubt as certainty and the demographics of our cities are so volatile. Tan accepts this. In the voice-over to her own filmed portrait she speaks of the antagonism between the inexplicable desire to make such a project and its inevitable shortcomings. The poses, compositions and lighting may echo Sander's order, but the shift from photography to the moving image becomes a measure of the instabilities of the present.



90 *Himmel über Berlin* [*Wings of Desire*] (Wim Wenders, 1987), frames.



91 Fiona Tan, *Countenance*, video installation (2002): 4 video projectors, 4 hi-fi audio speakers.

The place of the photograph in the films of Jean-Luc Godard deserves a book-length study of its own. Few directors have explored it so thoroughly. He has considered everything from the freeze frame (*Sauve qui peut (la vie)*, 1980) and advertising (*Une femme mariée*, 1964) to news photos (*Cinétracts*, 1968; *Je vous salue, Sarajevo*, 1993) and the tableau (*Passion*, 1982). In general, he sees photographs as social signs belonging to the construction of popular belief or ideology. His relation to them is invariably analytical; when they enter his work they are usually from the domain of the mass media, and on screen they are as much objects of cultural critique as filmic fascination. Two examples must

suffice here, but together they outline what has been particular about Godard's relation to photographs for nearly half a century. *Les Carabiniers* (*The Riflemen*, 1963), Godard's take on the war movie, is a political satire about two coarse young men joining a king's army on the promise of riches and the opportunity to kill. To their girlfriends back home they send banal picture postcards with equally banal comments: 'We shot seven men then had breakfast' (Godard appropriated real wartime correspondence). On their return the soldiers divide up a suitcase of more postcards, as if they were conquerors gloating over spoils. 'We've got the world's treasures!' boasts one. 'Monuments. Transportation. Stores. Works of Art. Factories. Natural Wonders. Mountains. Flowers. Deserts. Landscapes. Animals. The five continents. The planets. Naturally each part is divided into several parts that are divided into more parts.' They slam down endless images of cars, buildings, boats, houses and more. Then come images of women – from art history, pornography and Hollywood – as if women too were commodities promised by the state in exchange for their labours. Intentionally, the scene goes on far too long, making clear the numbing effects not just of war but also of photographs as casual substitutes for knowledge and experience.

Godard's most sustained engagement with photography is *Letter to Jane: An Investigation about a Still* (1972). It is a 52-minute film centred on just one image, a news photo that had appeared in *L'Express* in 1972 captioned 'Jane Fonda interrogeant des habitants de Hanoi sur les bombardements américains' ('Jane Fonda questions Hanoi residents about US bombings'). Fonda had just starred for Godard and Jean-Pierre Gorin in *Tout va bien* (1972), as a journalist covering a factory strike. She is faced with the question of whether to join the workers in solidarity or try to report neutrally (the role of the intellectual in political life has been central to Godard's work). When Fonda went to North Vietnam to protest against US foreign policy, her visit was covered extensively by the Western media. *Letter to Jane* takes the rough newsprint image as what it calls a 'social nerve cell', and through voice-over the filmmakers attempt to examine its political functions.[14] Despite her evident concern about the war, the film sees Fonda as ultimately limited and contained by bourgeois liberalism, whether her own or that of the newspaper's readers.[15]



92 *Les Carabiniers* (Jean-Luc Godard, 1963), frames.

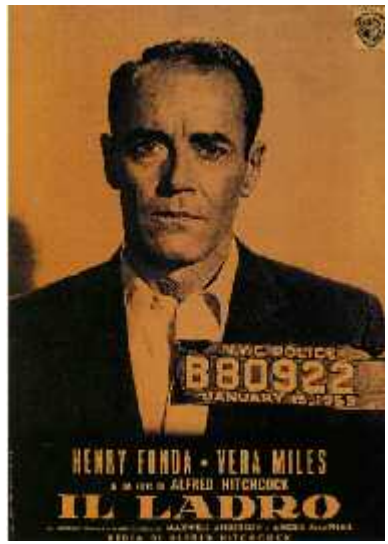
It also critiques the often counter-productive role of Western media coverage. The story here was not the Vietnam War but Fonda's presence. Audiences identify with her and not the North Vietnamese. The 'concerned star' is so easily converted from well-meaning interventionist to containable media commodity. The film's reading of the image is very close. It looks at the consequences of Fonda being in focus while her expression is, politically speaking, out of focus. By contrast, the face of the North Vietnamese man behind her is fuzzy, while his daily life is stark. The filmmakers ask why the caption in *L'Express* describes her as questioning when she may well be listening or inwardly absorbed. Like *Les Carabiniers*, *Letter to Jane* is relentless. Its hectoring tone blends Brechtian counter-caption with Situationist *détournement*, pushing the function and the meaning of the photograph back on the viewer over and over. Godard and Gorin shared the voice-over duties, realizing perhaps that just one voice alone would dominate the still. Even so, they speak as one, and several critics suggested that the film lapsed into the very kinds of political shortcuts it aimed to unmask. Either way, to listen while a mute photograph undergoes an hour of solid attack, to which of course it cannot respond, is uncomfortable, if deliberately so.[16] The film's argument is that whatever small meanings such a photograph may contain

they are always subject to the wider political and economic forces that put it to work. Both sides in the war made use of this picture for their own ends. A photograph is useful not because it 'speaks', or 'says a thousand words'; rather its silence makes it useful. 'A photograph talks through the mouth of the text written beneath it', declares Godard at one point. He points out that the silence is restated in the muteness of Fonda's own face. Her expression operates as an abstracted and reified 'concern', insulating audiences from meaningful political reflection. Her face suggests that she knows a lot about things without saying what or how much. Godard traces her expression back to depictions of the New Deal in American cinema. After the stock-market crash of 1929, which was also the first year of sound in cinema, actors' faces carried into the 'talkies' the exaggerated visage of concern honed in the silent era. In 1940 Jane's father, Henry Fonda, had starred in the film of John Steinbeck's novel *The Grapes of Wrath* (John Ford). A story of destitute sharecroppers moving west to California in the 1930s, the film derived its visual style from the documentary photographs of the Farm Security Administration. That facial expression is consistent throughout the famous images by Dorothea Lange, Margaret Bourke-White, Horace Bristol and others.[17] For decades, Henry played the common man caught in circumstances beyond his control who triumphs not through politicized action but stoic patience. By the time he came to star in Hitchcock's *The Wrong Man* (1956), it was almost a caricature. A false accusation of murder stuns his character into passivity, and for most of the film he remains virtually inert. It is an exaggeration of that neutralized style of acting that in principle allows the audience to project their own emotions. But Fonda is almost too vacant, too blank. In the film his wife cannot cope with his docile demeanour, as if she is trying to converse with a mere image of his former self. Eventually it sends her mad.

Sustaining a long, unbroken look at a single photograph can be difficult. Even Godard and Gorin cut away from the image of Jane Fonda from time to time. Just before Agnès Varda began her first film, *La Pointe courte*, in 1954, she took a photograph on an Egyptian shore. It shows a naked man staring out to sea, while a sitting boy looks into the camera and a dead goat occupies the foreground. Its composition is crisp and



93 *Letter to Jane: An Investigation about a Still* (Jean-Luc Godard and Jean-Pierre Gorin, 1972), frame.



94 Italian poster for Alfred Hitchcock's *The Wrong Man* (1956).



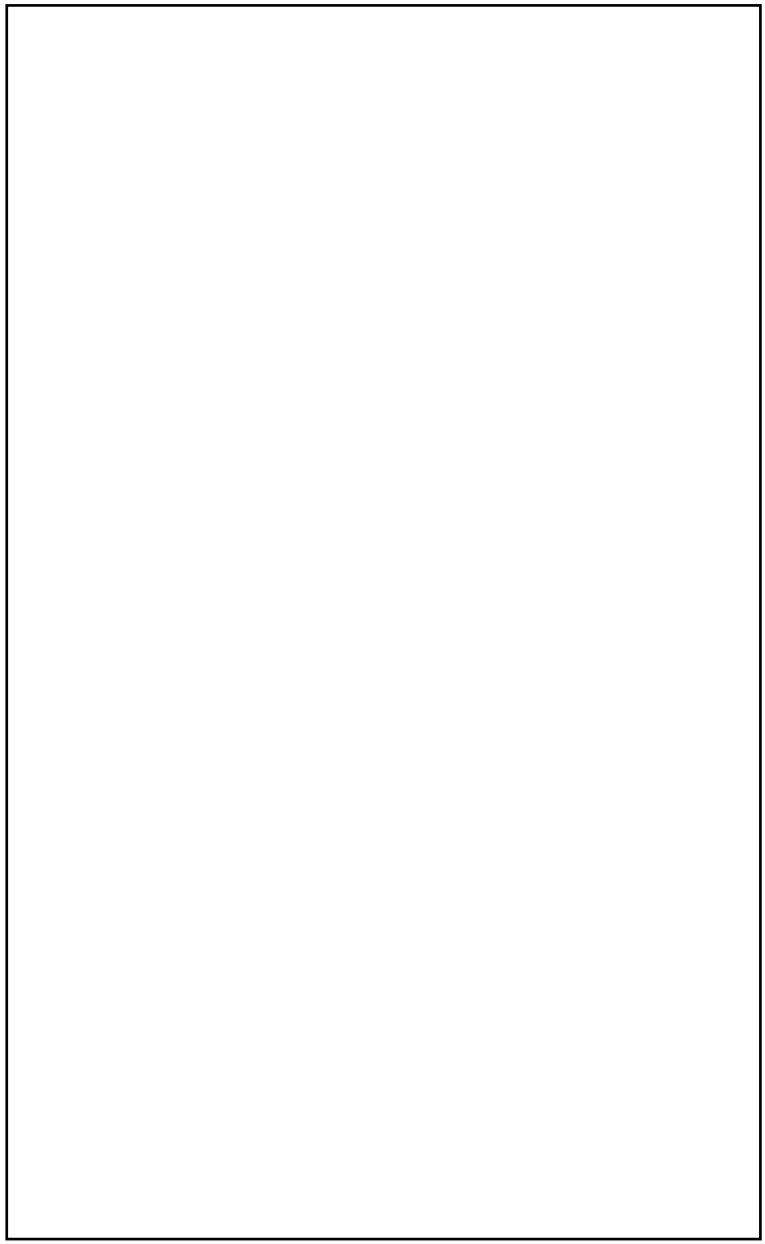
95 Agnès Varda, *Ulysse* (1954). Black and white photograph.

definite, its meaning less so. Varda looked at the photo from time to time over the following decades and was compelled eventually to turn her fascination into the film *Ulysse*, in 1982. In it she offers several approaches to the image. First she explores how it marked her transition from photographer to filmmaker. Then she takes the photo as a document belonging less to her personally than to history. Varda researches national and world events that happened the month she took the photo, but none seems to have any bearing on it. She goes in search of the two people. The man, Fouli Elia, was a model in 1954. By 1982 he was a director of photography at *Elle* magazine. Varda contacts him, but he is not interested in remembering. The boy, Ulysse, is the son of Spanish refugees who were

friends of Varda. She finds him running a bookshop in Paris and shows him the picture, but he remembers nothing. She shows him a painted copy he once made, but he can add no more, replying: 'It's reality and fiction'. (She shows the photo to a goat too. It eats it.) Varda has added next to nothing to her understanding. So, since the boy is called Ulysse, she opts instead for a freer interpretation via Greek mythology. This soon becomes tiresome and forced. The boy's mother then appears, telling Varda that 'Ulysse' was really just his nickname all along. The hold a photograph can have over us may be unaccountable, even with detailed research. It may not be explained literally through its manifest content or through the moment of its making. Varda's quest is not satisfied directly and perhaps it never could be. Even so, a compelling film emerges from the salutary realization that memory cannot always be recalled, rewritten or invented, even in the face of photographic evidence.

The animated short *Frank Film* (1973) avoids evidence altogether. The American Frank Mouris narrates his own life with the aid of 11,592 separate images, none of which is autobiographical in the familiar sense.[18] His film is a permanently shifting collage of magazine cut-outs of consumer goods and commodified body parts. There is a double soundtrack, forming its own collage. On one track Mouris's deadpan voice recounts his uneventful middle-class upbringing in post-war North America. He speaks of being saved from tedium only by discovering animation and making this very film. On the other he simply lists things beginning with 'F'. As the life story meanders along, the hyperactive collage presents equivalents for his every experience: dozens of tumblers of whisky flood the screen when Mouris discovers alcohol; endless lipsticks spiral when he starts dating women; hundreds of car tyres roll past when he learns to drive. It all ends in comic anticlimax when he has no great insight to offer about all this. It is a confessional film with nothing much to confess. Even so, Mouris produces something idiosyncratic out of the unpromising material, refusing to judge whether individuality can survive the marketed desires of mass culture. The whole film is resolutely homespun, an artisanal assembly in which every one of the images has been through Mouris's hands and scissors, conferring unexpected personality upon them and him.

96 Collages from *Frank Film* (Frank Mouris, 1973).



Frank Film was made the only way it could have been in 1973, before the coming of digital technology. Within a few years such labour-intensive construction would appear nostalgic. A quarter of a century later the theme returned in Peter Weir's parable of media spectacle, *The Truman Show* (1997). Jim Carrey plays Truman Burbank, a man adopted at birth by a broadcasting corporation. Unwittingly, he grows up as the only 'authentic' person in a giant domed town populated by actors. His life is filmed around the clock as a live reality TV show for a worldwide audience. Life in the bubble is essentially an insular and nostalgic 1950s, with little sense of the wired planet beyond. He falls in love with an extra, but when she tries to tell him what is really going on she is hastily removed from the show. Distraught and confused, Truman longs for her. He buys magazines every morning and reconstructs her face from cut-out scraps from fashion and cosmetics ads. It is a quaint resemblance of his lost love, in stark contrast to the state of the art collage used to promote the film.

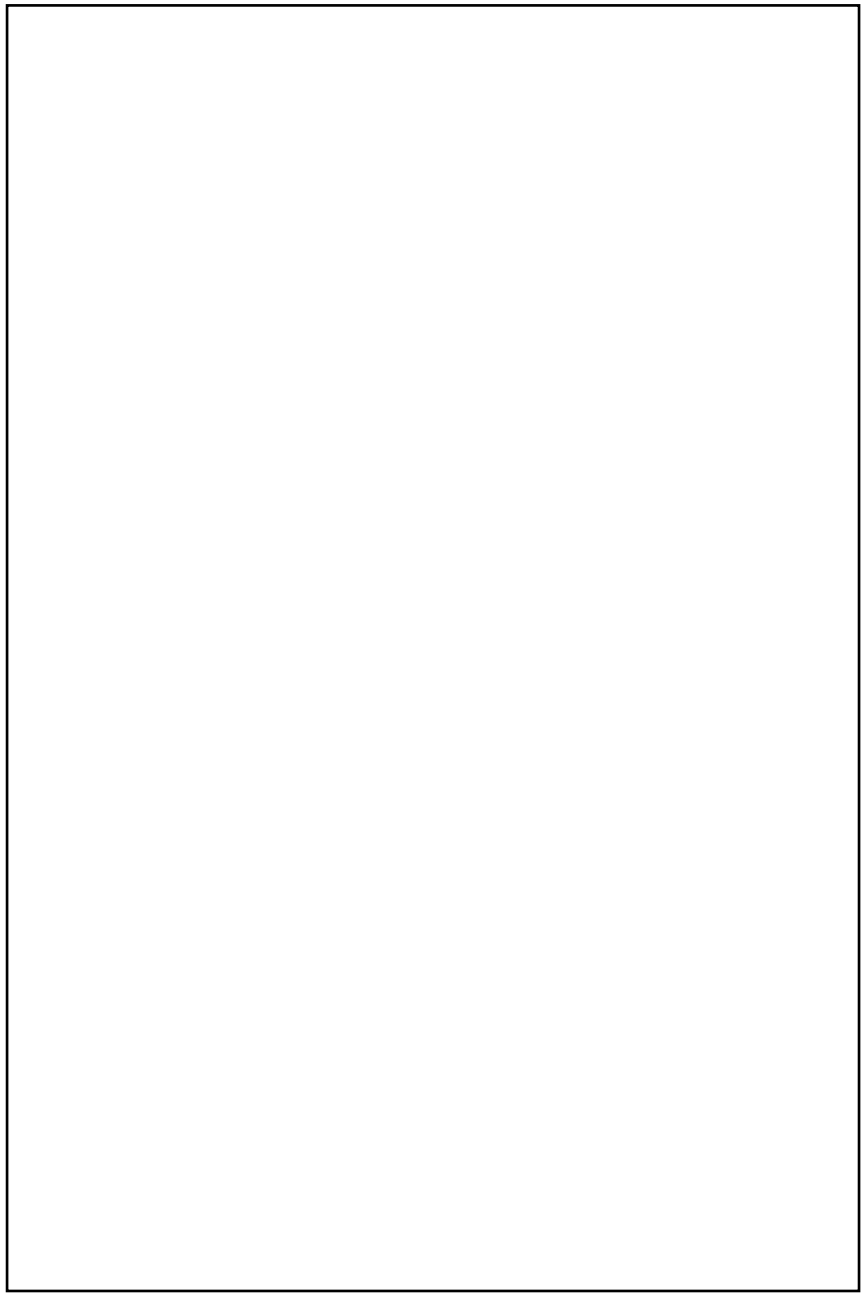
The poster and trailer for *The Truman Show* featured a photo-mosaic grid of thousands of images from the film.[19] Assembled by computer from a digitized archive, they conjure up Truman's face, but it is legible only from a distance. Quite literally, he is a product of his environment, a mirage that disintegrates into its parts upon closer inspection. These two modes of collage – handmade 'cut and paste' and digital assembly – correspond to two technological epochs of the photographic image. The achievement of *The Truman Show* is to hold them in suspension, mobilizing both registers at once. In doing so the film is able to dramatize the two contradictory fantasies of our time: the regressive wish for a small-town life in a pre-global, pre-digital village and the hope of being singled out as 'someone special' from the electronic networks of globalized anomie.

The Truman Show take its place in a list of films that have made telling use of photography at different turning points in its evolution. Often the nature of a technology becomes clear to us just as it is about to mutate or disappear. Cinema seems to have been attracted to different forms of the photographic image at such moments. As we have seen, Hitchcock's *Rear Window* concerned a wheelchair-bound photographer with nothing to do in his apartment but look into his courtyard. It was made in 1954, just as television was beginning its inexorable transformation into the dominant



97 *The Truman Show* (Peter Weir, 1997), frames.

98 Poster for *The Truman Show*.



mass medium, eclipsing still photography in the process. With a TV in the home, never again would people have to stare out of a window to satisfy their curiosity (television promised to be 'a window on the world'). In this sense, *Rear Window* is, among other things, an early farewell to life without the small screen and an equally prescient farewell to the sidelining of cinema and photojournalism.

Antonioni's *Blow-up* (1966) was famously critical of the fashion industry, but it was made at a moment, perhaps the last moment, when such criticism could bite. By the end of the 1960s fashion photography, like the visual culture of capitalism in general, had developed a carapace of irony and self-parody that seemed to head off or absorb any critique.[20] Christopher Nolan's *Memento* (2000), a story told backwards about a man with no long-term memory who is trying to solve a murder, makes compulsive use of Polaroid photos. The hero takes shots of significant faces and places and relies on them to tell him who is and what he must do next. Attractive to filmmakers since the 1970s, the Polaroid has been in some respects cinema's ideal other. The whole process from shooting the image to holding it in the hand and watching it develop can be filmed in one place in real time.[21] For cinema, the Polaroid seems authoritative and tangible, utterly tied to its time and place.[22] Yet *Memento* was made just as the expensive and wasteful technology was being replaced by cheap and accessible digital cameras, moving the photograph from object to pure image. Indeed, the Polaroid company filed for bankruptcy protection in 2001.

In a similar vein Mark Romanek's *One Hour Photo* (2002) is the story of a sinister technician at a shopping mall photo lab. He runs off his own copies of snaps of an ideal family in order to insinuate himself into their lives, first in his fantasies, then in reality. Digital cameras were already cutting out the lab technician at the turn of the millennium. *One Hour Photo* was made at that last point when a contemporary film could linger legitimately over celluloid negatives, sprocket holes, gurgling chemicals and all the rest of the production process. It is not just the photographic image that cinema has found attractive. It is the highly visual system that goes with it, from the red light of darkrooms with images slowly appearing in liquid baths to the mechanics of the manual camera and the dust of the archive.[23] As these disappear either cinema's romance

99 *Memento* (Christopher Nolan, 2000), frames.

100 *One Hour Photo* (Mark Romanek, 2002), frames.



with photography will fade or, more likely, new means of articulating the digital still will emerge.

Photographers on Screen

We can extend the question of whether film has access to an essence of photography by looking at the portrayal of photographers themselves. With a few exceptions cinema tends to depict them as rather dysfunctional outsiders. They are often misfits and loners immersed in, yet out of kilter with, the worlds they inhabit. We can trace this persona back at least a far as Lloyd Bacon's *Picture Snatcher* (1933), in which James Cagney plays an ex-convict turning to the 'honest' profession of photography, only to end up sneaking illegal pictures of an execution. It has continued up to and beyond the naïve amateur hailed by the art world in John Waters's *Pecker* (1998).

This may be a misrepresentation, but in many respects this is what photographers value about their medium. It permits them an involvement in the world, while enabling them to remain apart from it. If we were uncharitable, we could see this as an essence of the medium in the sense that many of photography's more pessimistic critics (Siegfried Kracauer, Jean Baudrillard, Susan Sontag and Guy Debord among them) have argued that photography offers little more than a dangerous substitute for true intimacy, true exchange and true knowledge. For them, the glass lens is as much a barrier as a conduit of social exchange. Photographs may actually cut us off and insulate us in our partial view at the very moment they appear to offer their account of things.

From this perspective we can once again consider the photojournalist in *Rear Window.* He is unusual in that he takes no photographs during the film. For Hitchcock, a photographer is above all someone who looks for a living. Their voyeurism is socially licensed. It requires a safe distance, a vantage point for the observer beyond the reach of the observed. In *Rear Window* the photographer is cut off not just by the lens of his camera, the glass window of his apartment, or the abyss of the courtyard across which he stares. It is his *profession* that cuts him off, that demands his separation.



101 Poster for *The Picture Snatcher* (Lloyd Bacon, 1933).



102 *Rear Window* (Alfred Hitchcock, 1954), frames.

over: 103 *Blow-up* (Michelangelo Antonioni, 1966), frames.

Despite witnessing a murderer covering his traces, at no point does he feel the urge to get it on film. He uses his camera's long lens as a telescope, swapping it for binoculars when things get really intense.

Rear Window 'feels' photographic throughout, but for reasons that are thoroughly cinematic. Hitchcock's idea of pure cinema rested on the classical theory of montage. He takes the formula of shot / counter shot and turns it into a looped circuit of looking / action / reaction. A basic pattern of short, near-still shots dominates the film as the photographer observes the actions of the murderer and then reacts. The photographer's curiosity is merely Hitchcock's means to a thoroughly cinematic end. If proof were needed that photography was not really Hitchcock's subject, consider the bits of photographic activity that we do see in *Rear Window*, which are odd indeed. In the film's opening pan we glimpse a framed photo – taken from the middle of a racetrack – of two cars crashing. A tyre is hurtling towards the camera, presumably destined to hospitalize the photographer. In the same pan we see a crushed camera, then James Stewart's leg in plaster. A real photo of the crash would have been impossible to make and this image is clearly a montage. It is a quick expository device and its realism is not Hitchcock's concern. Later, the photojournalist consults a box of transparencies. They are the only photos he has taken of the courtyard and they record no action at all. He notices that plants in a flowerbed have grown shorter over a period of days, leading him to presume a body has been buried there. (No account is given of why he took such banal shots.) Then in the film's denouement the murderer spots the watching photographer and comes over to his apartment to confront him. As he enters the photographer attempts to slow his approach by firing flashbulbs at him repeatedly in the dark. The strobes temporarily blind him, deferring the moment of confrontation. Again, no actual photograph is taken.

From this perspective we can also return to Antonioni's *Blow-up*. This film too features a photographer experiencing in extreme form a similar social disconnection. It is also a film centred on a murder and it feels particularly photographic. It would do so even without the extended fashion shoots and darkroom scenes. In contrast to Hitchcock's montage, Antonioni's long takes assume an almost photographic stare at the surface



















of things (as discussed in chapter Two). In *Rear Window* the photographer takes a sure path towards knowledge, while in *Blow-up* the more the photographer looks the less certain he becomes. Has he accidentally photographed a murder? Can he prove it? Are his photographs evidence?[24] For all its analytical, existential aspirations, *Blow-up* does not get far past the obvious warning that while photographs are forceful as evidence, they need to be read carefully and corroborated by testimony. But perhaps the real insight Antonioni offers is not to be found in the film as such. What is striking is that *Blow-up* seems so different in photographs. The fashion shoots, so modish and seductive in the film's publicity stills, are deliberately awkward and cruel in the film. The photographer (played by David Hemmings and loosely based on David Bailey and others) looks focused and purposeful in stills, but is really a listless man veering between entropy and excitement with his lifestyle. The film's celebrated estrangement of the world it depicts is only achieved through its drawn-out pacing and extended silences. In stills the film resembles the 'groovy, swinging sixties' that Antonioni was attempting to unmask. In some ways this was subversive. The publicity for *Blow-up* (posters, press photos, magazine features) could not help but mislead, suggesting that the film was more accessible and familiar to a mass audience than it really was. Appropriately, *Blow-up* was Antonioni's only film to meet with critical and commercial success.

So often when cinema approaches photography it does so indirectly, as a means to something else. We might see this as evasive, that while cinema is attracted to it, it cannot properly account either for photography or for its own attraction. There is a blind spot here. Even so, cinema's tendency to look awry at photography may tell us a great deal about the nature of the relationship between the two, but it requires that we too approach the matter indirectly.

four

Art and the Film Still

In 1939 Edward Weston made a small number of photographs on the back lot of MGM studios in Hollywood. He shot architectural fragments, stunt dummies and painted backdrops. This junkyard of fakes and substitutes was unusual subject matter for him. Although Weston lived in California, the artifice of Hollywood was a long way from his preoccupation with nature and platonic form. Nevertheless, he included the images in a solo show at the Museum of Modern Art in New York in 1946, where they came to the attention of Clement Greenberg, America's foremost art critic. In his review he wrote:

> The best pictures in the show are two frontal views of 'ghost sets' in a movie studio. Here the camera's sharply focused eye is unable to replace the details left out by the scene painter or architect; and the smoothly painted surfaces prevent the eye from discovering details it would inevitably find in nature or the weathered surface of a real house. At the same time a certain decorative unity is given in advance by the unity, such as it is, of the stage set.[1]

These images present visual fact as *trompe l'œil*, describing surfaces while reflecting on realism as a form of illusion. As modernist photographs they are descriptive, straight and true. They are also indirect and allegorical, anticipating the more postmodern demand that the photograph offer a commentary on its own status as representation.[2]

John Swope, an assistant film producer, also photographed those MGM back lots for his insider book *Camera Over Hollywood* (1939). He



104 Edward Weston, *MGM Studios*, 1939.

even shot the same backdrop as Weston. His camera is further away and off to the side. We see the scaffolding behind the backdrop and a set builder at work. Its anti-illusionist caption reads: 'Cities flourish for the duration of production; a few brushstrokes wipe them out forever.'[3] Swope's photography shows up the shallowness of the cinematic spectacle. Weston does this too, but he plays it as a formal game between the depth and the flatness of the photograph. In different ways both make use of the medium's technical and cultural difference from cinema to comment upon it as a source of popular myth.

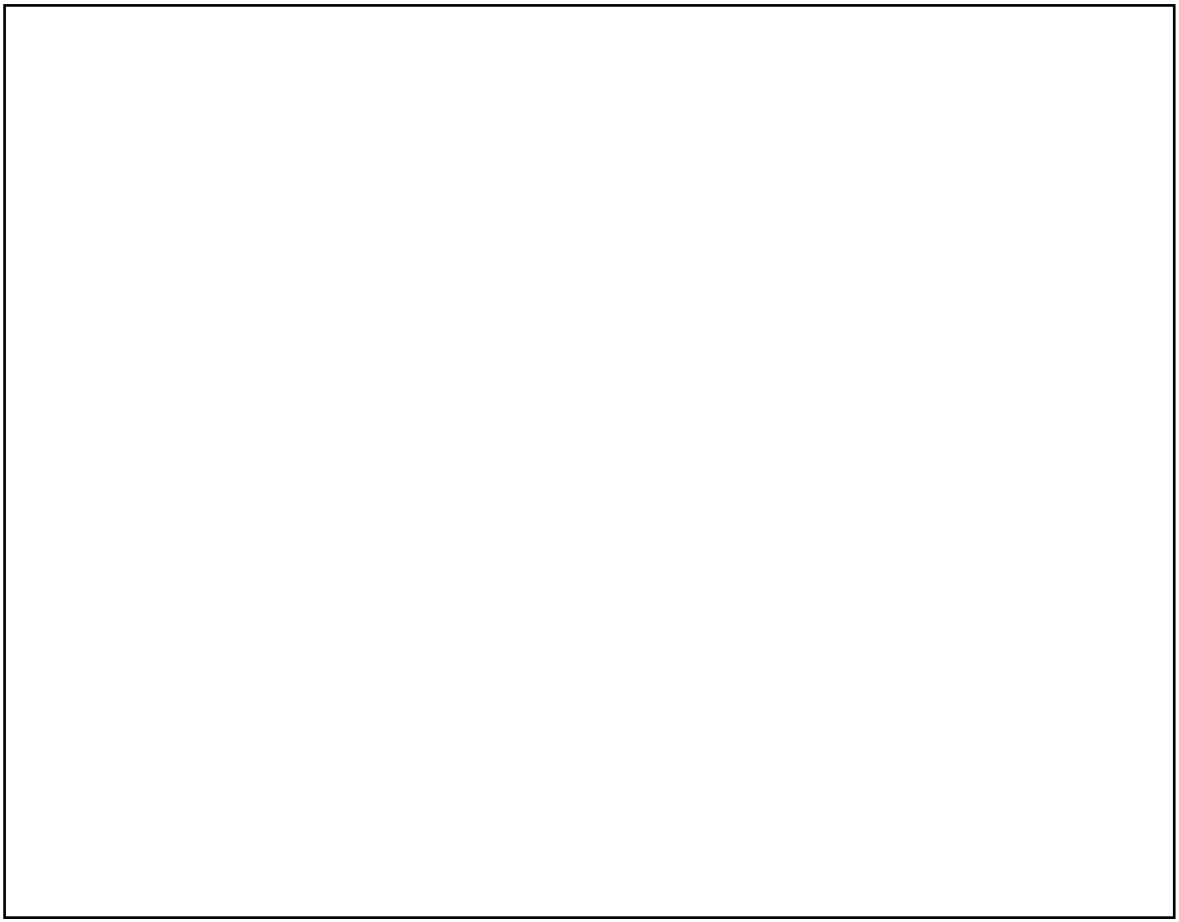
The stark superficiality of film sets has attracted many photographers independent of the industry. In general, the results tend to be meditations on artifice. Consider the image taken by the artist Robert Cumming in 1977 of a mechanical shark's fin, made for *Jaws II* (1978). There is a particular consonance between the physicality of Cumming's camera and the ingenious subaquatic machine. Cumming used a 10 x 8-inch plate camera capable of rendering extraordinary detail. The shark's fin is a minor miracle of improvised tubing, rudders and motors. Who



105 John Swope, 'Cities flourish for the duration of production; a few brush-strokes wipe them out forever', from *Camera Over Hollywood* (New York, 1939).

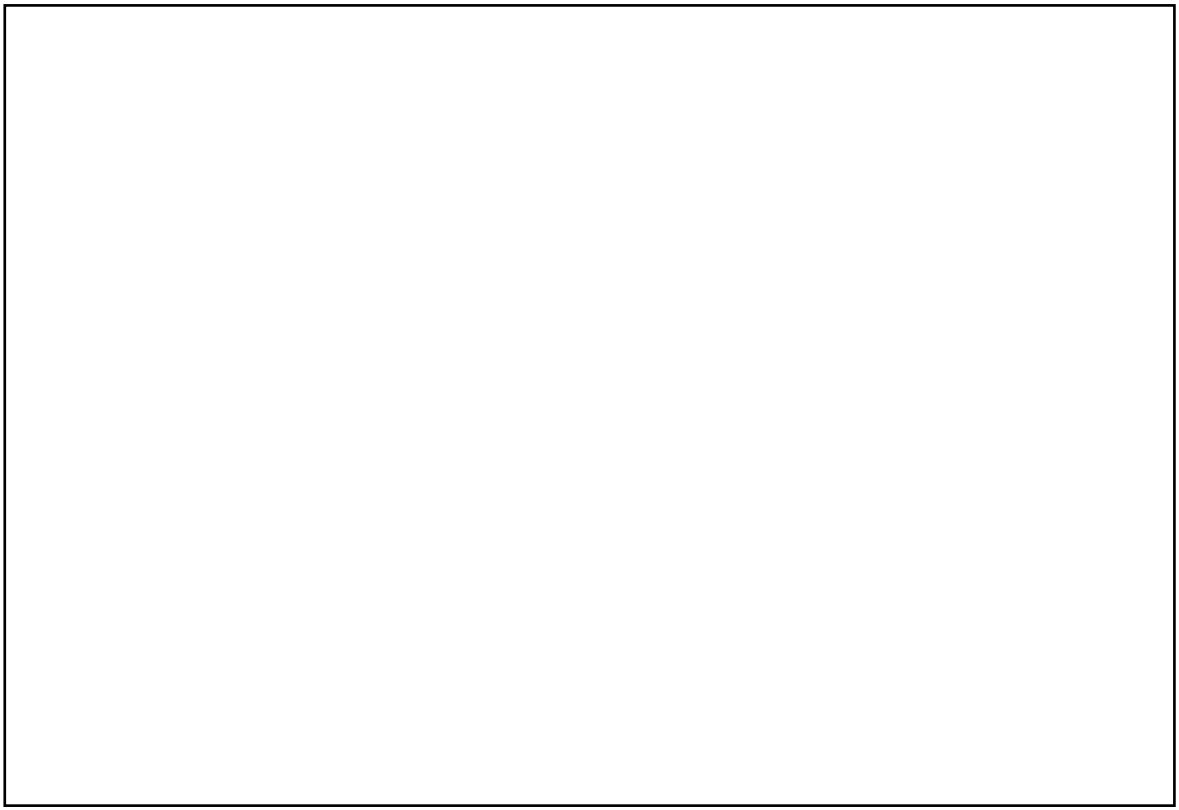
would make such a contraption today in the era of computer-generated imagery? And what would a behind-the-scenes photo of a contemporary shark movie look like? Perhaps a portrait of a computer whizz-kid in an office-like studio, poring over photographs and footage of real sharks in an attempt to get the virtual one on the screen to look right. Photography may have given way to CGI, but it still provides its realist aesthetic.

Gus van Sant's 'sixty-million-dollar art-movie' *Psycho* (1998) is a shot-for-shot remake of Alfred Hitchcock's original of 1960. Van Sant takes for granted the audience's familiarity with the film to play all manner of games with their cultural memory (what happens when a film's



declared frame of reference is not the world but another film?) The remake was shot by the cinematographer Christopher Doyle, who is also an adept photographer. He regularly shoots personal stills on set. In one of these, the actress Ann Heche is seated in a car in a film studio while a back projection of a road plays behind her. It is a 'real' back projection, not a digital one added afterwards – Van Sant was sticking to cinema's old tricks. Heche is playing Marion Crane, the bank clerk on the run with stolen money. Or perhaps she is playing the original actress Janet Leigh playing Marion Crane. Doyle's shot of Heche's

106 Robert Cumming, *Shark fin atop pneumatic water sled, from 'Jaws 2' (1978)*, March 28, 1977. Black and white photograph, 10 x 8 in.



107 Christopher Doyle, *Anne Heche on the Set of Psycho* (Gus van Sant, 1997).

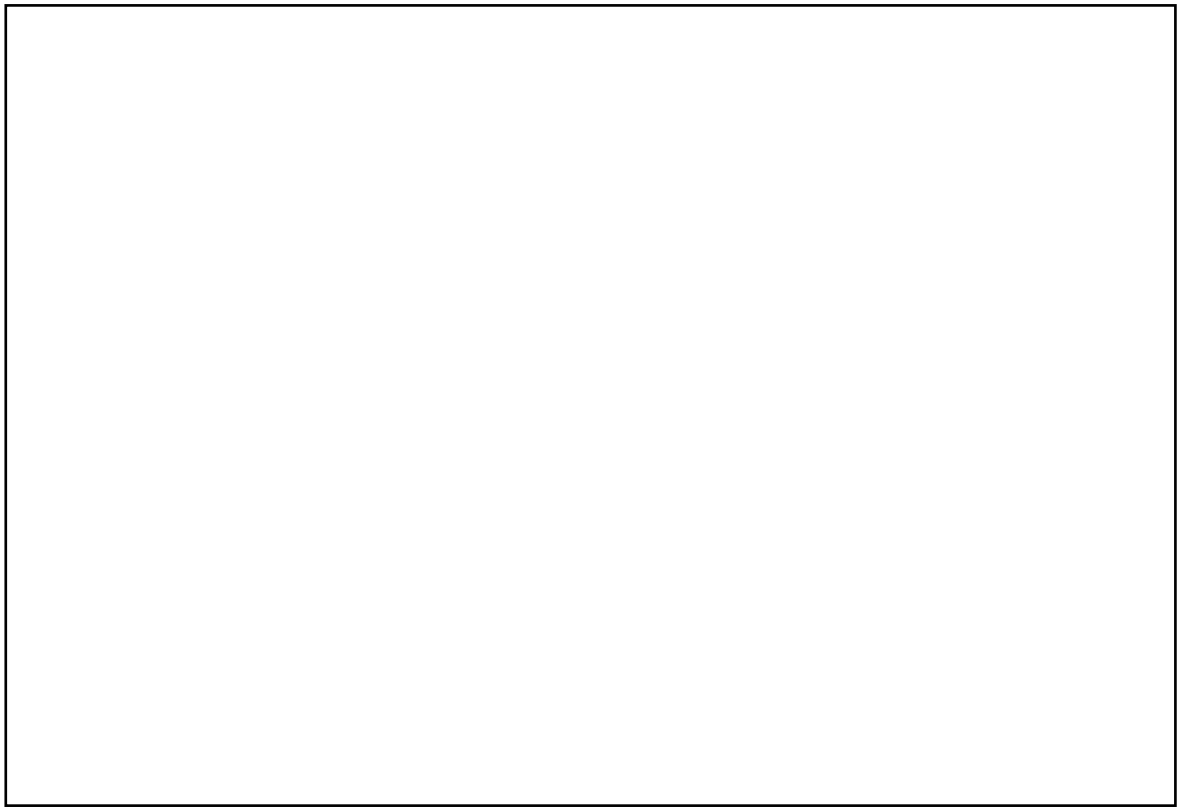
ambivalent face expresses the dizzying layers of representation. Is she preoccupied with the past projected behind her or the future projection of her own performance?

These examples are a long way from typical in-house production photographs in which comment and individual style are discouraged. They are in general the exception, not the rule, although there is a long history of independent-minded photographers working on set. As the economic power of the film studios waned in the 1960s and '70s, budgets for production photography were cut dramatically. At the same time some directors and actors sought greater autonomy, which led on occasion to more informed pairings of photographers and films. Photo-journalists would often be invited on set in the hope of free publicity. For

example, the documentarist Mary Ellen Mark was assigned a photo story on the making of *One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest* (Milos Forman, 1975). The film was being made on location in a men's psychiatric ward in Oregon State hospital. While she was there Mark met women patients on the high-security ward. She returned after the shoot to document their daily lives, eventually publishing the results as the book *Ward 81*.[4] More recently, Mike Mills's *Thumbsucker* (2004) was covered by Mark Borthwick, Todd Cole, Takashi Homma, Ryan McGinley and Ed Templeton, who all move fluidly between editorial commissions and art. Alejandro Gonzáles Iñárritu's *Babel* (2006) was documented by Mary Ellen Mark, Patrick Bard, Graciela Iturbide and Miguel Rio Branco. Lynne Ramsay, a photographer herself, asked Gautier Deblonde to shoot the making of her film *Morvern Callar* (2002). In these instances the photographers were chosen on the basis of an affinity between their style and those of the filmmakers, but all were encouraged to shoot in their own way rather than mimic the look of the films.[5]

The most celebrated case of independent photographers working on set is the extensive coverage of John Huston's *The Misfits* (1961) by nine Magnum agency photojournalists, including Eve Arnold, Henri Cartier-Bresson, Elliott Erwitt and Inge Morath.[6] At the time their images were effective publicity.[7] In the decades since their function has changed. *The Misfits* had an unusually troubled shoot and turned out to be the last completed film for two of its stars, Clark Gable and Marilyn Monroe. The on-screen story and the film's production were both dominated by strained relationships and emotional turmoil, and over time the two have become inseparable in the popular imagination. Many of the photographs, particularly of the fragile Monroe, work equally as film stills and reportage since we cannot tell if she is in or out of character.

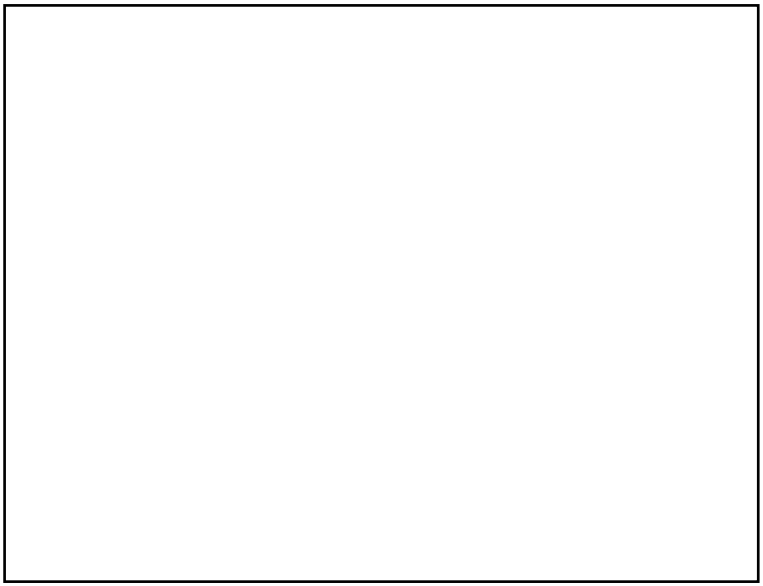
By contrast, an unlikely experiment with photographers on a later John Huston film has almost been forgotten. For the production of the Depression-era musical *Annie* (1982), 'the best young photographers' were invited by the producer to shoot 'whatever they want on set'.[8] Again there were nine, including William Eggleston, Garry Winogrand, Stephen Shore, Joel Meyerowitz and Mitch Epstein, all art photographers working broadly within the documentary style. The resulting folios were



108 Eve Arnold, *Marilyn Going Over Lines for a Difficult Scene*, set of *The Misfits*, 1961.

as distinct from each other as from the film. Eggleston ignored cast and crew to look at quiet architectural details. His only concession was shooting low, from the orphan Annie's point of view. Winogrand pursued his characteristic black-and-white street photography, catching chance moments on set.

Stephen Shore focused on street corners, shop fronts and the unnamed extras. This was the kind of everyday subject matter he had documented in road trips across America in the 1970s. On set he shot with the same eye for detail on the same large-format camera. Even so, he was acutely aware of the oddity of recording the everyday of the 1930s. The film's New York streets were built at Burbank Studios under bright California skies. Shore accepted this, avoiding the 'East Coast' light



109 Stephen Shore, *On the Set of Annie*, Burbank, California, 1981.

provided by the technicians. The detailed sets and costumes had been fabricated using old photographs as reference. These included images by Jacob Riis, Lewis Hine, Berenice Abbott and Paul Strand, all classics of photographic history.[9] Shore's style descends from theirs, so in effect he was shooting his own influences.

Lost and Found

Away from fine-art photography, many artists who emerged in the 1960s had been attracted to photography as a mass cultural and lowbrow medium, inseparable from other image forms.[10] Film imagery was central to the mixed-media work of Pop artists (such as Robert Rauschenberg, Andy Warhol and Richard Hamilton), to Conceptual art (Ed Ruscha, John Baldessari, John Hilliard, Victor Burgin, James Coleman, John Stezaker), and to artists emerging in the late 1970s (Jeff Wall, Cindy Sherman, Robert Longo, Bruce Charlesworth, Sarah Charlesworth). Moreover, a great deal of the significant art of the last thirty years has been in dialogue with film

culture, and much of it has made use of photography as a medium at once distinct yet connected to it. By the 1990s it was clear that just about all art forms were going to have make their peace with a world dominated by the moving image. As Jeff Wall put it in 1996, 'no picture could exist today without having a trace of the film still in it, at least no photograph'.[11]

The early 1970s was a turning point in this relationship. Many cinema chains and distribution companies were off-loading their holdings of publicity photos onto the second-hand market. There was little use for the material, since television had taken up the function of repertory cinema. These informal archives were thought to have little cultural or economic value. Cut loose from their sources, the images were left to fend for themselves, their meanings up for grabs. New audiences of collectors, film fans, historians and dealers emerged. Collections were assembled not just by film title, but also by actor, genre, director, studio, period and individual photographer. Out of these significant new archives of film history were established, such as the John Kobal Collection.

Others were attracted to less obvious meanings: a mood, an oddness of gesture, a compelling composition or an inexplicable situation. What sense do we make of an image when we do not know where it has come from? What does it mean if we cannot recognize the film or if it barely resembles cinema at all? The beauty and craft of the image are robbed of reason, but a new fascination may fill the void. In this regard the fate of the film still embodies the potential fate of any photograph. Made for one purpose, it is easily detached and redefined elsewhere. Several artists were drawn to those discarded glossies. For example, John Baldessari in the US and John Stezaker in the UK began to invent their own poetic and allegorical uses for them. Their collages and juxtapositions are full of enigmatic associations and unspoken subtexts. To classify his informal collection of stills, Baldessari invented his own A–Z with little to do with film industry categories. 'A' was for 'Attack, Animal/Man, Above, Automobiles (left), and Automobiles (right)'. 'B' was for 'Birds, Building, Below, Barrier, Blood, Bar (man in) Books, Blind, Brew, Betray, Bookending, Bound, Bury, Banal, Bridge, Boat, Birth, Balance, and Bathroom'. No stars, no titles, no dates.

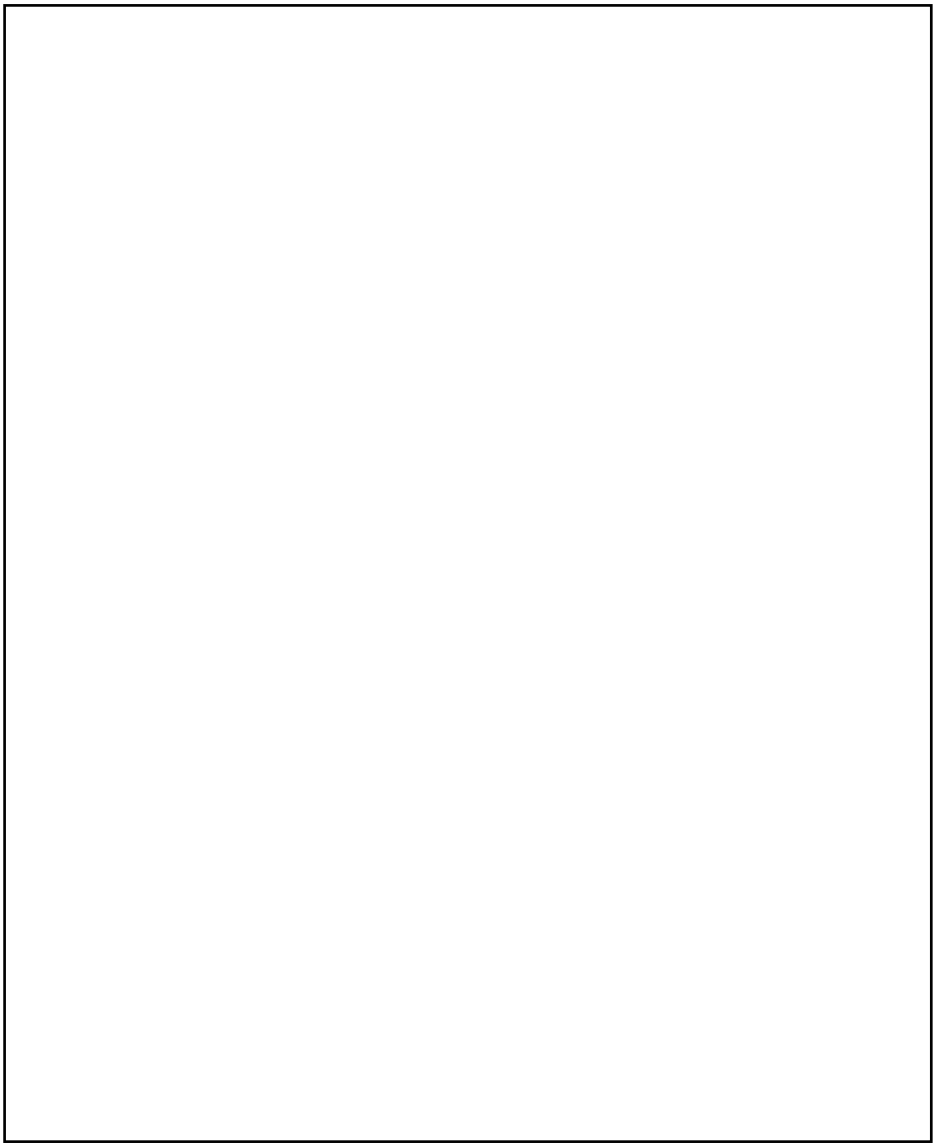
Before he began working with film stills John Stezaker explored old *photo-romans* from continental Europe. These were cut up and

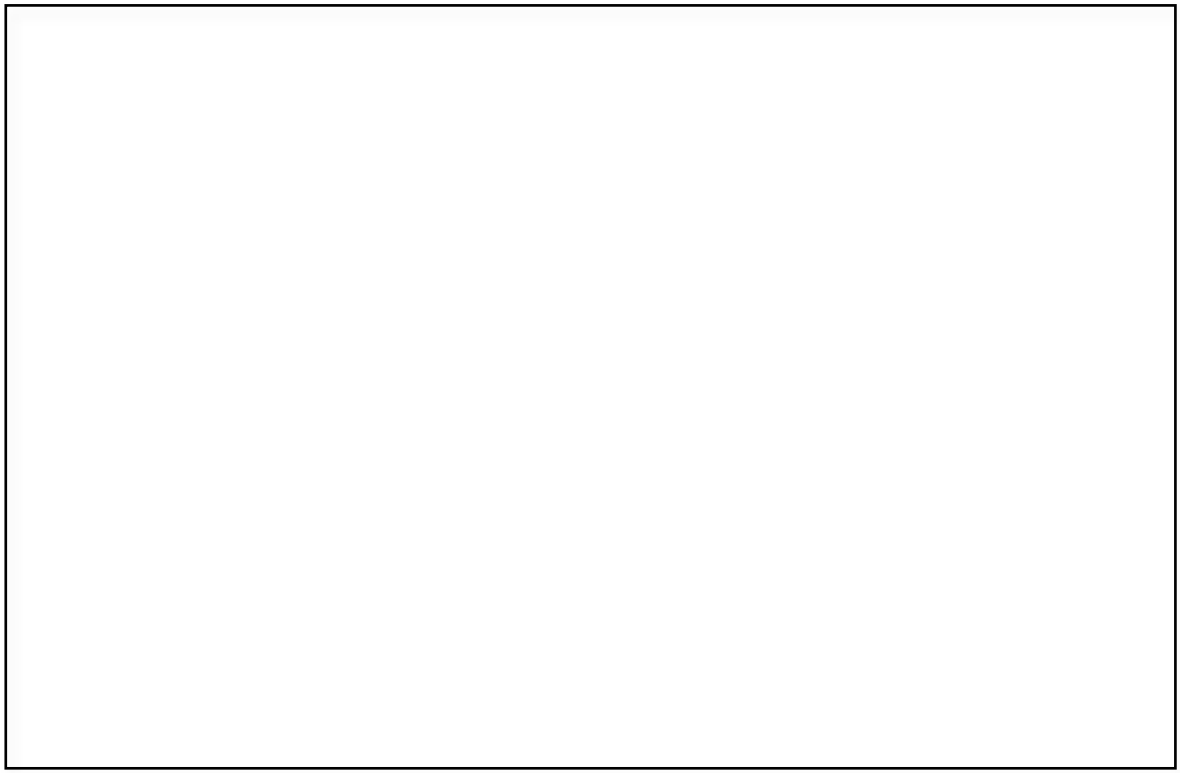
111 John Stezaker, *Cross-Connections* (1976).

recombined into broken narratives in a style that mixed Dada, Surrealism and Situationist graphics. Turning to film stills in the late 1970s, Stezaker refined a near-minimalist approach to collage. Joining just two images either with precise cuts or by simply laying one fragment upon another, he aimed to extract the maximum effect from the least promising source material. His subversions of film portraits in particular seem to unmask the repressed psychological charge that drives characters in even the most generic narrative films.

Other artists have examined the *gaps* that exist in cinema's archives. Zoe Leonard and Cheryl Dunye noticed how little documentation there is of many African-Americans who worked in film. *The Fae Richards Photo Archive* is a fabricated but entirely plausible album of the life of a black actress and singer (Fae Richards, 1908–1973). She starts her career with bit-parts, playing housekeepers and maids. She comes into her own in the bohemian jazz age, becomes a famous star, gets involved in the civil rights movement, but spends her last years forgotten. The archive has been published as a book and exhibited as a set of museum 'artefacts'. They were also used in Dunye's film *The Watermelon Woman* (1996), a story of a young black gay filmmaker who goes in search of evidence of the forgotten Fae.[12]

opposite: 110 John Baldessari, *Junction Series: Landscape, Seascape, Woman (with Hat) and Woman Painting Toe Nails* (2002). Digital photo print with acrylic on sintra panel. 8 parts, 214 x 206 cm.





113 Zoe Leonard and Cheryl Dunye, pages from *The Fae Richards Photo Archive* (San Francisco, 1996).

Make it Big (2002) by Shezad Dawood is a similar exploration of myth. Dawood traveled to Karachi to attempt a Pakistani remake of Antonioni's *Blow-up*.[13] Shooting began in the former colonial film studio on the outskirts of the city. He played the part of the photographer himself, recruited the country's top models and actresses, hired the best hair and make-up artist and commissioned the legendary Faiz Rahi to hand paint designs for the film poster. An inveterate storyteller, Dawood has recounted that the shoot did not go well and was eventually abandoned. On returning to London the rushes were lost and all that remains of the whole enterprise is a clutch of production stills and poster designs.

opposite: 112 John Stezaker, *Film Portrait (She) VIII*, 2005.

Many film companies have retained at least some parts of their archives. In the mid-1990s the artist John Divola visited the holdings





of Warner Brothers studios. He looked through files of continuity stills. These are documents made of sets between takes to record the position of props and lighting. In the 1920s and '30s they were technically exacting images, shot on large-format cameras by highly skilled technicians. Divola found them filed by film title, but he was struck by their generic repetition (even by the 1920s production was formulaic). He retrieved and reorganized several dozen by type, exhibiting them as grids of *Hallways*, *Mirrors* and *Evidence of Aggression*.[14] The last group records the scattered remnants of pretend fights and fake rage. Rescued and hung in the gallery, they suggest forensic evidence, but are clearly caught between cool documentation and theatrical artifice. With perfect lighting, perfect printing and perfect detail in perfect focus, the sheer excess of visual information has the perverse effect of making them look unreal.[15] Today, very few images shot on set are made with this level of attention. Polaroids soon became the norm and now digital documentation is standard. While making the film *Pecker* (1998), the comic story of a naïve snapshot photographer propelled unwittingly to art-world fame, director/artist John Waters took a series of photographs of the set floors. *Hit Your Mark* shows the legs of actors as they stand by bits of

114 Production still from Shezad Dawood's *Make it Big* (2002).

115 Hand-painted poster by Faiz Rahi commissioned by Shezad Dawood (2002), reworking the original poster design for Michelangelo Antonioni's *Blow-up*.



116–119 John Divola, images from *Evidence of Aggression* from the project *Continuity* (1995).
Clockwise from top left: *Larceny Lane* (Blond Crazy), 1931, Warner Brothers, directed by Roy Del Ruth. *Miss Pinkerton,* 1932, First National Pictures, directed by Lloyd Bacon. Unidentified, c. 1930. *The Public Enemy*, 1931, Warner Brothers, directed by William Wellman, art director Max Parker.

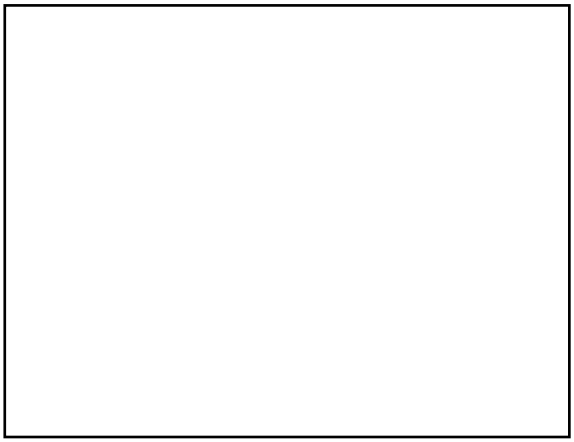


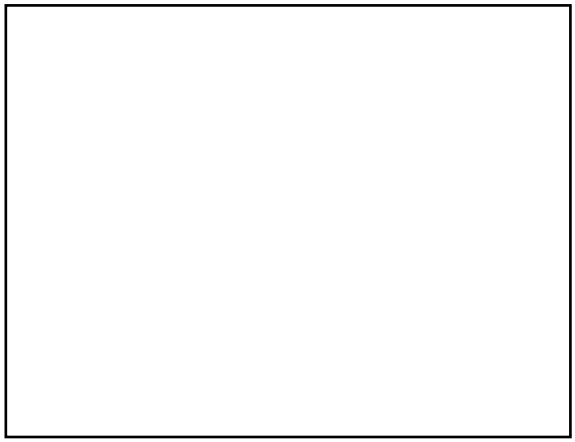
coloured tape on the floor during rehearsals. Waters's 'point and shoot' simplicity echoes the perfunctory pictures made by Pecker in the film.

120 John Waters, *Hit Your Mark* (1998).

Cinema at a Standstill

In 1973 *Artforum* magazine published Roland Barthes' essay 'The Third Meaning: Research Notes on Some Eisenstein Stills'.[16] Barthes was interested in the idea that the mechanically recorded image, filmic or otherwise, contains more potential meaning than can ever be accounted for. In cinema we do not to see this excess, since the individual images are not there long enough for us to contemplate them. Imagine a cinema audience watching a narrative film. At any one moment most eyes will be focused on just a small portion of the screen, usually a face or something on the move. Given just a single frame to look at, the gazes will begin to drift around the image in more individual ways. Eyes and mind can wander, chancing upon details beyond the conscious intention of the director or performers. Barthes' essay was a kind of revenge upon the power of the moving image. He looked at single frames from films by Eisenstein and found new meanings, many of them non-specific and incomplete. The story and acting were of lesser interest to Barthes than the capacity of the still frame to scatter our attention, returning the making of meaning to the spectator. His choice of filmmaker was provocative. Famously, Eisenstein had championed the putting of one shot after another in a sequence to implant a very different kind of 'third effect' (e.g., shot of marching soldiers + shot of injured mother = the indifferent might of the state). Much more disturbing, Barthes' third meanings reside *within* the single shot and will always have the potential to escape control, even from the tightly organized imagery of the Russian avant-garde.[17] More to the point and quite against the grain of popular wisdom, Barthes argued





121, 122 Cindy Sherman *Untitled (film still)* nos 17 and 10 (1978).

that what was truly filmic about a film revealed itself only once the movie was deprived of movement. Only when it is stilled do we have the necessary distance to contemplate the filmic-ness of film.

This idea has been enormously appealing to artists and photographers. Still photography had struggled with narrative as storytelling. For Barthes, an image could be filmic without being a film. And by extension the term 'narrative' could be grasped more as an adjective than a noun. An image could simply *be* narrative without belonging to *a* narrative. The pictorial conventions to be found in film frames were rich in association and full of dramatic possibility. No other kind of photograph seemed to imply such a complex world within and beyond the frame. By the late 1970s artists' awareness of the film still was opening up new possibilities for photography. Cindy Sherman and Jeff Wall, who began to make staged narrative photographs around the same time, were attracted by this compact power that seemed to set in motion meanings that could never be resolved fully.[18]

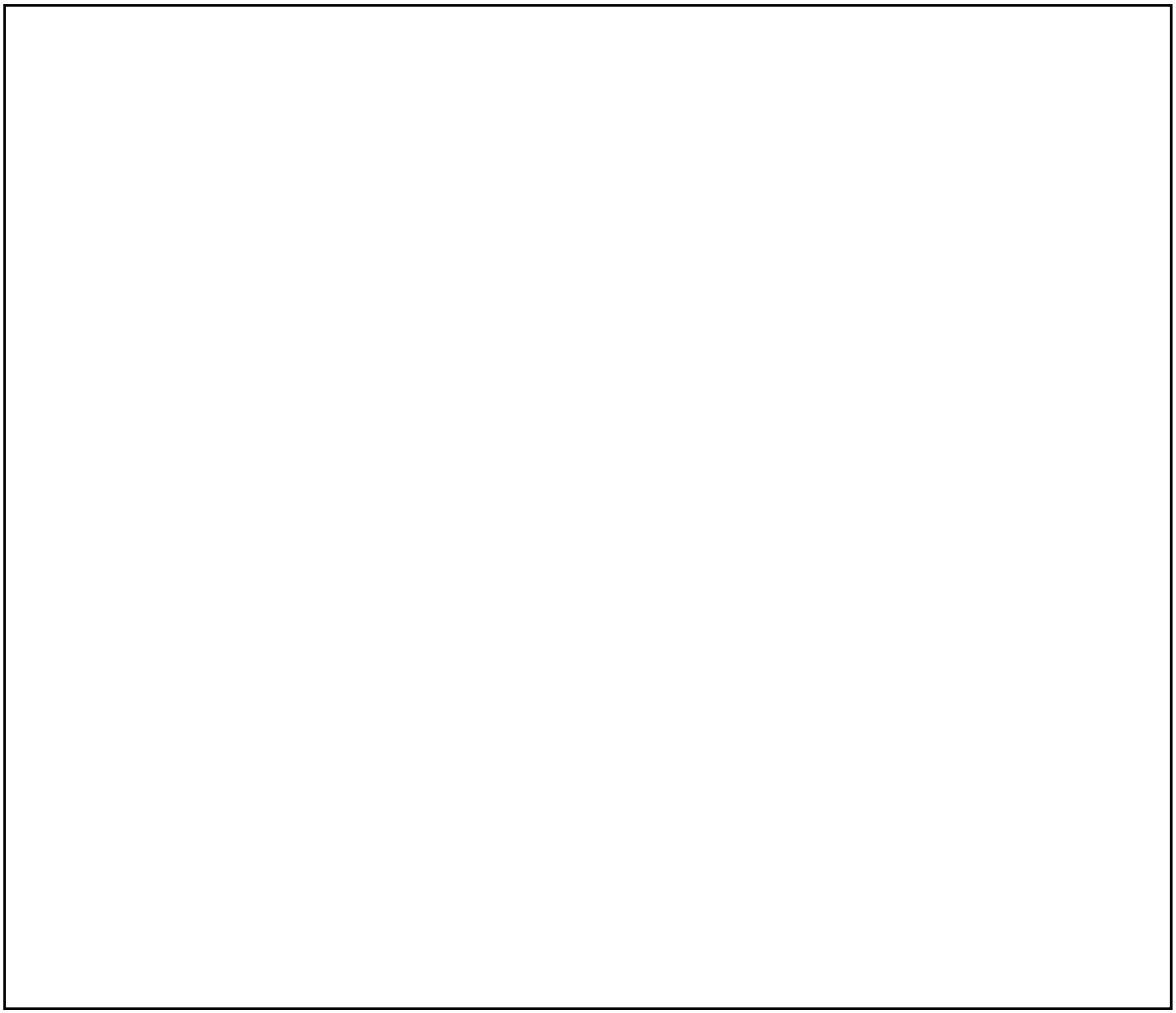
No longer confined to posing for the camera, figures in art photographs began to *act*, or at least to pose as if they were acting in isolated scenes. Sherman's *Untitled Film Stills* remain influential almost thirty years on. Mimicking the iconography of cinema, Sherman staged herself as various types of femininity from popular and art-house movies. In the gallery context her 10 x 8-inch prints were deceptive. On one level they

resembled discarded publicity stills from real films. On another, they adopted the preferred format of purist fine-art photographers, many of whom were quite baffled by Sherman's game. Later, as art photography began to explore greater scale, Sherman reprinted the series much larger, evoking the cinema screen itself.

We should note here the ambiguity of the term 'film still'. It can refer to the extracted film frame (what Barthes called the *photogramme*) or to the publicity image taken by a photographer. After a successful take film actors are often asked to do things 'once more for stills'.[19] They convert their acting into posing for a photographer, who must try to condense something of the scene into a single, comprehensible shot. The advantages of this are twofold. The photograph will be less grainy than a tiny frame from the film-strip, and the gestures need not be grabbed from the continuum but can be clarified for the still, avoiding some of the ambiguity that Barthes described. However, Sherman's stills seem to encompass the staged photo and the extracted frame. Sometimes they resemble publicity shots, sometimes grabbed moments, while many belong somewhere between the two. Does Sherman pose or act, or act as if posing, or pose as if acting? Does she pose *for* the camera or is she posed *by* it? Or is it something even more complicated? Whichever it is, we can say that Sherman hijacked the 'look' of classical narrative cinema in three senses: its visual style, the camera's look at the scene and the performer's directed looking, often at a point somewhere outside the frame. Across her set of 69 stills it is this triple register of the look that Sherman crystallized so effectively. Indeed, whenever we sense that a photograph resembles a film still it is usually because it invokes something of each of these three looks.

Jeff Wall has described many of his images as 'cinematographic', but all he signals by the term is the preparation and collaboration involved in their making.[20] For Wall, Barthes had simply clarified the fact that all cinema images are photographic in origin and thus all the techniques associated with the making of film imagery could be put at the service of still photography. Wall's abiding interest has been the depiction of everyday life, but early on he renounced the direct recording of it. Moments, decisive or otherwise, could be noticed but passed

over in favour of their staged reconstruction. This staging could be avowedly faithful, or less so. Several things follow from this. While Wall's photographs still describe the real world, they are shifted into the register of semi-fiction. The documentary function of the medium is partially suspended and the camera as witness is replaced by pictorial hypothesis: 'This was' gives way to 'What if this was?' In traditional documentary practice the subjects are photographed in their continuous relationship with the world they inhabit. To stage an image is to rupture that continuum, producing a photograph as imaginary as it is lucid. (This perhaps is the only distinction we can make between a documentary photograph that is 'taken' and one that is 'made', although it can never be absolute). *Mimic* (1982) was Wall's first image staged outdoors. He had witnessed a casually racist gesture in the street and decided to re-enact it for a photograph. A white man and girlfriend are walking slightly behind an Asian man. On the edge of each other's fields of vision the white man makes a loaded gesture as his middle finger pushes back his eyelid. Wall selected the street and the players, rehearsing the scene before shooting it. Achieving convincing narrative gestures in photographs is notoriously difficult. Wall has tried everything from paying people to perform things over and over for long periods before attempting to shoot, to filming rehearsals on video then freeze-framing the ideal gestures and replicating them on location.[21] The title 'Mimic' can be read at any number of levels: photography as a 'mirror of nature' mimics the world; photography mimics film; the white man mimics the Asian man; models mimic actors who mimic real people; Wall mimics the event he saw; the central gesture is a depiction of the unthinking mimicry of a reactionary ideology; and for the gallery the image is printed very large, mimicking the scale of the viewer's own body. Wall has pursued levels of clarity and precision beyond what we usually see in reportage or street photography. He uses a large-format camera that can record scenes in great detail but is slow to use. *Mimic* could only have been staged, not just because of the detail but also because of the point of view. The camera sees everything that is important here, in focus and without blur. Moreover, the three people act as if the photographer and his bulky equipment were not there right in front of them. Such disavowal of the



123 Jeff Wall, *Mimic* (1982). Transparency in lightbox, 198 x 228.5 cm.

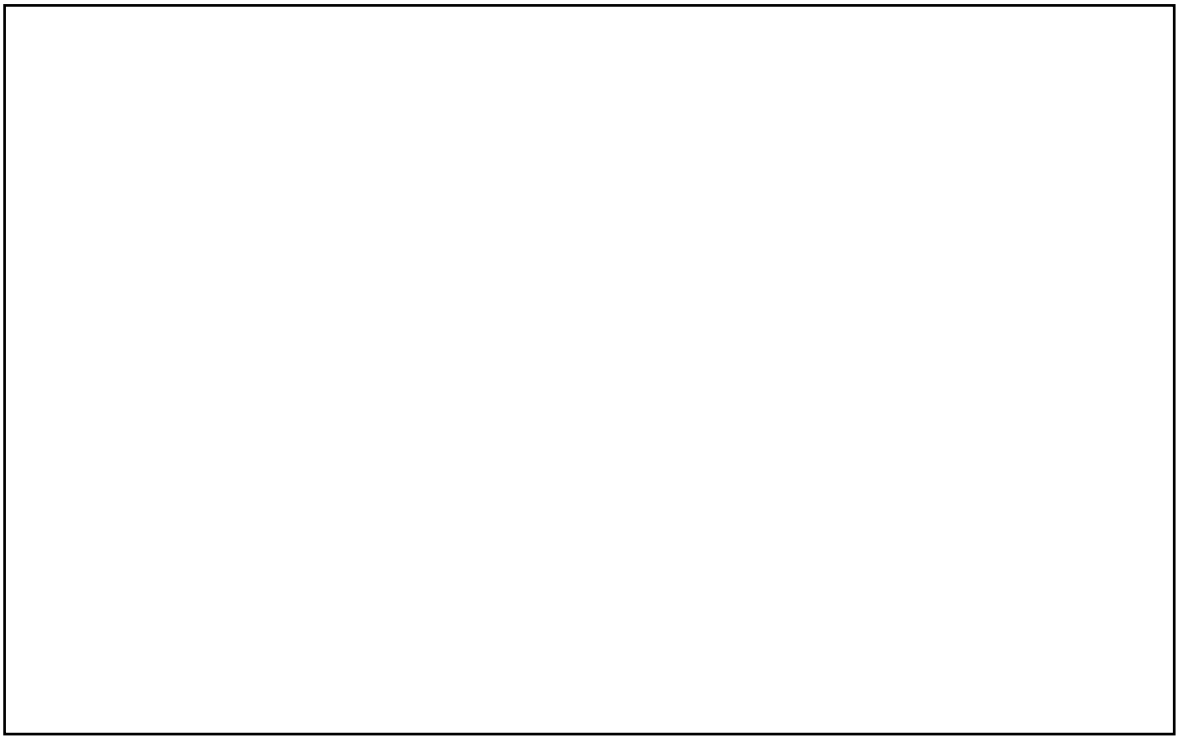
camera's frontal presence is standard in mainstream narrative cinema because it inherited the implied 'fourth wall' of realist theatre.[22] Things appear to happen as if there was no audience, even though they are performed *for* the audience. In cinema and theatre the sweeping along of the spectator in the unfolding of the drama before them is what suspends the disbelief. (This is why the 'breaking of the spell' beloved

of avant-garde cinema and theatre tends to involve stopping that flow, shocking audiences out of their daydream, often by having players look directly at them.) The stillness of photography is, of course, denied that voyeuristic unfolding. Photography can suspend the world but not the disbelief. Consequently, the staged narrative photograph that pretends that the camera is not present, that depicts action in the realm of fiction, never quite achieves cinema's naturalism. It is always haunted by movement and estranged by its own fixity.

The narrative photography that has become widespread in art in recent years has made a virtue of this shortcoming, accepting and incorporating the inevitable awkwardness. Wall himself depicts situations that are awkward anyway, where the human figures are already stiffened and hampered by restrictive social relations. The unfreedom expressed by reified body language has been a constant theme in his work and it is entirely suited to the uneasy effects of staged photography. Similarly, Cindy Sherman has depicted moments of psychological uncertainty. The characters in her photographs seem to be stilled as much by conflicting emotions as by the camera.

The gestural language in these kinds of image may strike us as curiously automatic, deadly robotic even, as if the people are somehow enacting gestures of which they do not appear to be fully conscious. To become automatic is to commit blank mimicry, not unlike the act of photography itself. Roger Callois once talked of mimicry possessing an estranging force, while Henri Bergson remarked that humans behaving like automata or robots may be a source of unexpected or uncanny affect, even anxious humour.[23] In art the strangeness of photographed mimicry has been used to distance us from the familiar. The narrative pose can draw attention to its own arrestedness, setting up a space from which to rethink representations while making new ones. Everyday life can be re-examined through engagingly static images of petrified social unrest.

Not surprisingly, the points of reference for this kind of photography have been works that themselves play on overlaps between absorption and theatricality, and between depicted movement and stillness. Many art photographers cite or even quote the paintings of Vermeer, Chardin and Hopper along with the films of Bresson, Antonioni, Hitchcock and Lynch.



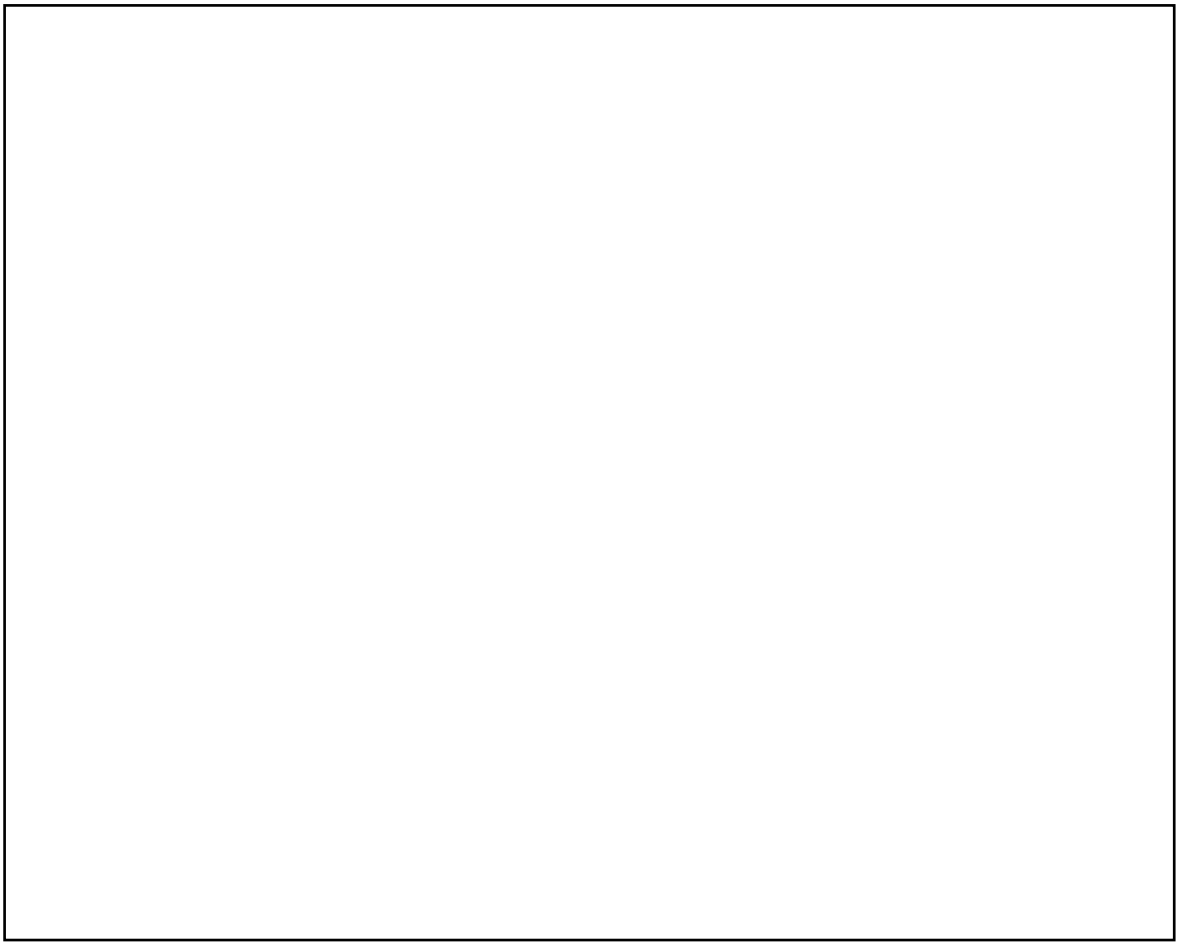
124 Gregory Crewdson, from *Dream House*, 2002, digital c-print, 29 x 44 in.

Melancholy, pensiveness, listlessness, boredom and fatigue are the states that seem to appeal to contemporary tableau photographers, not least because the actors or models need not do very much. As long as they do little and the photography does a lot, in the form of staging, then a good result can be achieved. Narrative can still be present if entropic, while the pitfalls of hammy performance (always a danger given the restrictions of stillness) can be avoided. Gregory Crewdson makes narrative cinematic photographs, yet at the heart of all his spectacular productions is the same basic human gesture: an exhausted person standing or sitting, slump-shouldered and vacant. The gap between the pacified humans and the over-active staging can be so extreme as to be humorous, undercutting the slightly sinister moods.

Sherman used thrift-store clothing, found locations and used just herself in front of the camera. Budgets were negligible in the 1970s.

Similarly, buying old film stills to reuse them cost next to nothing.[24] Artists worked cheaply and there was no art market to support them. But in the last decade or so the market has grown and more artists have been able to make photographs at a scale more typical of cinema. (Meanwhile, of course, significant films are being made on digital video for less than the budgets of some photo shoots.)[25] Crewdson has even hired film crews to help him realize his tableaux and used Hollywood actors as models. His catalogues boast production credits like those at the end of movies. One photograph from the series *Dream House* features Julianne Moore, sitting pensively on her bed while a man sleeps beside her. Moore had already refined a withdrawn demeanour in several film roles, notably Todd Haynes's *Safe* (1995), in which her gestures are unnervingly minimal. Crewdson finds a suitable overlap between her contained screen persona and her presence in the photograph.

Of all cinema's genres it is film noir and its derivatives that have proved the most attractive to photographers whether in fashion, advertising or art. What they appropriate most often is a shorthand style or mood. Certainly it is easy to think of 'noir' as a set of visual motifs – high-key lighting, deep focus, dark shadows, silhouettes, disorienting *mise-en-scène*, vertiginous angles and extreme close-ups. But it is more than a visual style. There are many movies that have this look that are not really noir films, while many noir films look very different.[26] They can be set on a spaceship or in a desert because the essence lies beyond the visual in matters of human psychology (guilt, suspicion, jealousy, betrayal, weakness, revenge). For a photographer seeking more than pastiche or a short cut to moodiness this can present a problem. One of the more successful engagements is the photographer and filmmaker Mitra Tabrizian's series *Correct Distance* (1986). One image is modelled on a scene from Michael Curtiz's *Mildred Pierce* (1945). Mildred (played by Joan Crawford) comes across her lover in an embrace with her daughter. We see the two kissing, followed by a counter-shot of Mildred's tense reaction. Tabrizian condenses the two shots the way a stills photographer would, so that the situation can be grasped in one frame. She also condenses the emotion of the situation. We get the action and the reaction combined, enriched by a text that mixes the language of psychoanalytic



All her life
She had been a successful writer and speaker.
Yet after every public performance
she felt intensely anxious
'Had she really done well?'
She looked to men for reassurance,
seducing them,
'I am Mildred's rival, but fear her;
to escape my mother's anger,
I became my father,
to conceal the identity I have stolen
I pose as a woman'.



126 Henry Peach Robinson, *Fading Away*, 1858, albumen silver print.

theory with the cheap psychology beloved of film noir trailers and posters.

The conversion of an edited film scene into a single photograph entails a shift from the diachrony of the sequence to the synchrony of the still. This is also a conversion of space, from film's multiple positions to the frontal organization of the classical tableau. In photography this makes for a very particular effect. The indexicality of a photograph combined with its stillness tends to produce not just a fixed record of the world but a fixed pointing *at* it. A photograph seems to say 'look at this' or 'this'.[27] More than that it says 'look how things were at this moment', whether that moment is fiction or fact. Photography points at the world but also seems to orientate the world towards the camera, promising its understanding. Hence the characteristic 'insistence' and didacticism that permeates all photographs a little. The frontal, anti-narrative photograph is the type most accepting of this and the one that predominates in modernism. It is typified by the sober, 'straight' photography of Eugène Atget, Walker Evans, Edward Weston, Paul Strand, August Sander and Bernd and Hilla Becher. Until recently, modernist histories of the medium have tended to suppress overtly theatrical forms, such as the nineteenth-century Pictorialist tableaux of Oscar Rejlander and Henry Peach Robinson, along with image sequences, narrative fashion and advertising photography and, of course, film stills.

Even so, frontality comes with its own theatricality and perhaps its own awkwardness too. We see it in the portraiture of Diane Arbus and Rineke Dijkstra, for example. Allan Sekula's 'disassembled movie' *Untitled Slide Sequence* (1972) is a brilliant dissection of it, dramatizing the tension that can exist in the physical encounter between the photographer and the subject. Sekula placed himself directly in the way of aerospace technicians going home at the end of a shift. Tired, they file past him. Some workers look into the camera, but since these are still photos projected as a slow sequence, we cannot tell if they are quick glances or longer stares. Some workers accidentally bump into the photographer until he steps

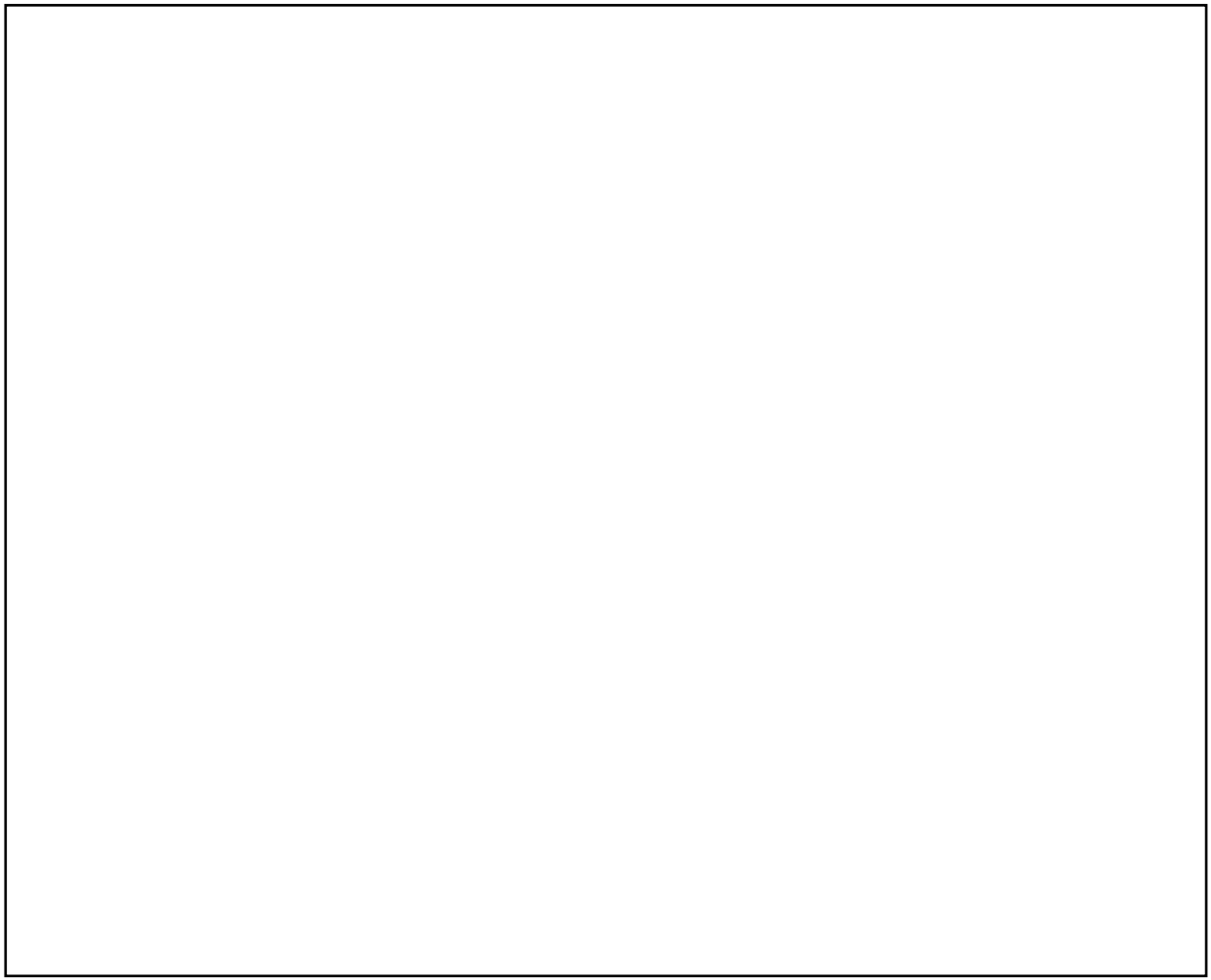
opposite: 125 Mitra Tabrizian, from *Correct Distance* (1986).

aside. Eventually, Sekula is removed by security guards for trespassing.[28] The reference to the first publicly screened film, the Lumières' *Workers Leaving a Factory* (1895), is clear but the difference is stark.

Photography has triumphed in art less by asserting some unique essence than by connecting itself to the widest world of images. The gallery has become the space to look again at the general field of the photographic, to engage directly or indirectly in a dialogue with it. Thus the gallery has come to be the host for 'art versions' of all the different fields of photography: fashion, the snapshot, the portrait, the medical photograph, the architectural photograph, the passport photo, the archival image, the legal image, kitsch, the topographic image and, of course, the film still. These forms sit alongside photography's place within the existing genres of the depictive arts: the still life, the portrait, the landscape, the city scene.

Art has become both a dissecting table to which the social photographic is brought for creative reflection and a set upon which it can be reworked. *Dissecting table* and *set*: these two metaphors map very well onto what have become the two important impulses behind recent photographic art. On the one hand there is the forensic interest in evidence and the photograph's unrivalled but fraught relation to 'the real'. On the other there is the cinematic or anti-cinematic interest in the arts of movement. Photography in art is somehow obliged to find its relation to visual evidence and to the dominant culture of the moving image.

The story of art in the twentieth century and early twenty-first has been played out as a tension between the artwork as fragment and the artwork as unified whole. Should art show us the disunity of modern life or attempt to piece it together? So it is little surprise that the film still has engaged artists in different ways at different times. However consummate its composition, however assured its realization, however perfect its technical control, the film still always remains a piece of something else. It is total and partial at the same time, whole yet fragmentary. Full of meaning yet half empty.



127 Allan Sekula, *Untitled Slide Sequence*, 1972; 25 black-and-white transparencies show the end of the day shift at the General Dynamics Convair Division aerospace factory, San Diego, California, on 17 February.

Afterword

I began this book with a description of the Lumières' 1895 film of the French Congress of Photographic Societies disembarking from their boat. I have watched it often, not in a cinema but on the very computer on which this book was written. Each time I pressed 'play' I was reminded of the different terms the English language has for viewing: one 'goes to see' a film at the cinema; one 'watches' a film on a television or computer. By contrast, there seems to be one basic word for our relation to photographs: looking. As I wrote I played the Lumière film on a loop from time to time in the corner of the screen. At points repetition rendered it almost abstract, but sometimes it seemed so fresh that I was compelled to watch more intently. The switch in attitude brought back the days I spent as a cinema usher in my youth. At first I would 'see' the film with everyone else. Then, to keep my sanity in the subsequent screenings, I would invent ways to watch, concentrating on the extras, looking for mistakes, scanning the backgrounds, putting in earplugs, taking naps the better to half-dream it. Over time the film changed from being quite ethereal and mirage-like to something more domesticated and rather object-like. But I could never rule out the possibility that it might change back again. By contrast, the photographs that have fascinated me over the years felt very much like objects when they were new to me, but now seem ever more virtual. Again, I can never rule out their changing back. This does and does not have something to do with technology. Images are transformed equally by the means with which we view them and the moments in which we view them.

Books about photography and cinema so often end on a technical note and it would be tempting to point to the 'convergence of media' or

to the new technologies that are said to be blurring the once distinct boundaries between them. I have discussed some of these at different points. Yet, it would be a mistake to think that this alone is the source of the fascination and healthy confusion that photography and cinema have generated over the last century or so. Neither has changed *fundamentally* since its invention, but this has not stopped them changing in every other respect.

References

Introduction

1 This was *La Sortie des usines Lumière* [*Workers Leaving a Factory*] (1895), screened in Paris on 28 December 1895. That year the Lumière brothers also made a fictional comic film about a photographer growing impatient with a sitter who would not keep still (*Photographe*, 1895).

2 *Arrivée des congressistes à Neuville-sur-Saône* (1895). The film is also known as *Congrès des sociétés photographiques de France* and is usually translated as *The Photographic Congress Arrives in Lyon*. The man taking the snapshot in the film is Jules Janssen, the astronomer and pioneer chronophotographer.

3 *Film und Foto* toured Germany and was also staged in Japan (Tokyo and Osaka) in 1931.

4 For summaries of the *Film und Foto* exhibition, see the catalogue *Internationale Austellung des Deutschen Werkbunds Film und Foto* (Stuttgart, 1929), and Beaumont Newhall, 'Photo Eye of the 1920s: The *Deutsche Werkbund* Exhibition of 1929', in *Germany: The New Photography, 1927–33*, ed. David Mellor (London, 1978), pp. 77–86. Newhall describes the photography comprehensively, but covers the film festival in a single paragraph. The catalogue itself was a fairly conventional publication, but the event generated other significant books: Franz Roh, *Foto Auge / Oeil et photo / Photo-Eye*, designed by Jan Tchichold (Stuttgart, 1929); Werner Gräff, *Es kommt der neue Fotograf!* [Here Comes the New Photographer!] (Berlin, 1929); and Hans Richter, *Filmgegner von Heute: Filmfreunder von Morgen* [Enemy of Film Today, Friend of Film Tomorrow] (Berlin, 1929).

5 For a detailed study of photographer-filmmakers, see Jan-Christopher Horak, *Making Images Move: Photographers and Avant-Garde Cinema* (Washington, DC, 1997).

6 Even Franz Roh's introduction to *Photo-Eye* struggles to stake out the relation between the two. See Franz Roh, 'Mechanism and Expression: The Essence and Value of Photography', in his *Foto Auge*, pp. 14–18.

7 Christian Metz, 'Photography and Fetish', *October*, 34 (Fall 1985); reprinted in *The Cinematic*, ed. David Campany (Cambridge, MA, and London, 2007), pp. 124–33.

8 The young Michelangelo Antonioni wrote the script for *The White Sheikh* and planned to make it *his* first film as director. He had shot a short pseudo-documentary on the making of a *fotoromanzo*, *L'amorosa menzogna* (Lies of Love) in 1949. Under some pressure, however, Antonioni sold the script.

9 An e-mail exchange in 2005 between Mike Figgis and Jeff Wall, in *The Cinematic*, ed. Campany, pp. 156–65.

10 Andy Warhol and Pat Hackett, *Popism: The Warhol '60s* (New York, 1980), p. 110.

11 Andy Warhol, cited by Bill Jeffries in 'Warholian Physiognomy: The *Screen Tests* of 1964 to 1966', in *From Stills to Motion and Back Again*: *Texts on Andy Warhol's* Screen Tests *and* Outer and Inner Space (Vancouver, 2003), p. 41.

12 Gilles Deleuze, *Cinema 2: The Time-Image* (New York, 1989), p. 17.

13 See Constance Penley, 'The Imaginary of the Photograph in Film Theory' [1984], in *The Cinematic*, ed. Campany, pp. 114–18.

14 The phrase is Jeff Wall's from his '"Marks of Indifference": Aspects of Photography in, or as, Conceptual Art', in *Reconsidering the Object of Art, 1965–1975*, ed. Ann Goldstein and Anne Rorimer (Los Angeles, Cambridge, MA, and London, 1996), pp. 246–67.

one: Stillness

1 Christopher Isherwood, 'Goodbye to Berlin' [1939], in *The Berlin Stories* (New York, 1952).

2 Henri Cartier-Bresson, introductory essay in *The Decisive Moment* (New York, 1952), p. 2; reprinted in *The Cinematic*, ed. David Campany (Cambridge, MA, and London, 2007). The title *The Decisive Moment* was used with poetic licence for the American co-edition instead of the French *Images à la sauvette*, a phrase that evokes chance as much as decisiveness.

3 He cites as his crucial films: '*Mysteries of New York* with Pearl White; the great films of D. W. Griffith – *Broken Blossoms*; the first films of Stroheim – *Greed*; Eisenstein's *Potemkin* and Dreyer's *Jeanne d'Arc* – these were some of the films that impressed me deeply.'

4 An illuminating discussion of this duality is Thierry de Duve, 'Time Exposure and Snapshot: The Photograph as Paradox', *October*, 3 (1978); reprinted in *The Cinematic*, ed. Campany, pp. 52–61.

5 I discuss this in greater depth in 'Safety in Numbness: Some Remarks on the Problems of "Late" Photography', in *Where Is the Photograph?*, ed. David Green (Brighton, 2003), pp. 123–32. For a more detailed assessment of cinema's reconstitution of time, see Mary Ann Doane, *The Emergence of Cinematic Time: Modernity, Contingency, the Archive* (Cambridge, MA, 2002).

6 Peter Wollen discusses the present-tense narration of the newspaper caption in 'Fire and Ice' [1984], in *Art and Photography*, ed. David Campany (London, 2003), pp. 218–20.

7 Cartier-Bresson made his first film in 1937, having been introduced to filmmaking by Paul Strand in 1935. He continued to make documentary films until 1970. For a summary of his work in film, see Serge Toubiana, 'Filmmaking: Another Way of Seeing', in *Henri*

Cartier-Bresson: Man, Image, World. A Retrospective (London, 2003), pp. 348–55.

8 Launched in France in 1920 and manufactured by Debrie, the clockwork Sept had become popular by 1922. It took 17 feet (250 frames) of 35mm film and had seven (*sept*) functions. As well as shooting stills, short sequences and movies, with the addition of a lamp housing it converted to a contact printer, optical printer for film-strips, projector and enlarger. Sales were not sustained, since it was complicated to use. Rodchenko is known to have shot sequences of market traders with his Sept.

9 Jean-Luc Godard, 'Introduction à une véritable histoire du cinéma', *Camera Obscura*, nos 8-9-10, pp. 75–88 (1980). See also 'Angle and Montage', in Jean-Luc Godard and Ioussef Ishagpour, *Cinema* (Oxford, 2004), pp. 15–18.

10 Dziga Vertov 'We' [1922], reprinted in *Kino-Eye: The Writings of Dziga Vertov*, ed. Annette Michelson (Berkeley, CA, 1984), p. 8.

11 Dziga Vertov, 'Kinoks: A Revolution' [1923], reprinted in *Kino-Eye*, ed. Michelson, p. 17.

12 Alexander Rodchenko in *Novy Lef*, 4 (1928).

13 Helmar Lerski, *Köpfe des Alltags* (Berlin, 1931).

14 August Sander, *Antlitz der Zeit: 60 Fotos Deutscher Menschen* (Munich, 1929).

15 Siegfried Kracauer noted: 'None of Lerski's photographs recalled the model; and all of them differed from each other. Out of the original face there arose, evoked by varying lights, a hundred different faces, among them those of a hero, a prophet, a peasant, a dying soldier, a monk. Did these portraits, if portraits they were, anticipate the metamorphoses which the young man would undergo in the future? Or were they just plays of light whimsically projecting on his face dreams and experiences forever alien to him?' Siegfried Kracauer, *Theory of Film* (London, 1960), p. 162. See also Helmar Lerski, *Metamorphosis through Light* (Essen, 1982).

16 Moï Ver, *Paris* (Paris, 1931). Born in Lithuania, Moï Ver studied at the Bauhaus and under the influence of László Moholy-Nagy, and went on to Ecole Technique de Photographie et de Cinématographie, Paris.

17 Siegfried Kracauer, 'Photography' [1929], trans. in Thomas Y. Levin, *Critical Inquiry*, 19 (Spring 1993), p. 428.

18 Hollis Frampton 'For a Metahistory of Film: Commonplace Notes and Hypotheses', in *Circles of Confusion: Film, Photography, Video. Texts, 1968–80* (Rochester, NY, 1983), p. 114.

19 See Victor Burgin's discussion of this in his introduction to *The Remembered Film* (London, 2005), pp. 7–28.

20 Sergei Eisenstein would refer to the cinema of the long take as 'starism' (stare-ism).

21 Wim Wenders, 'Time Sequences, Continuity of Movement: *Summer in the City* and *The Goalkeeper's Fear of the Penalty*' [1971], in The *Logic of Images* (London, 1991), pp. 3–6.

22 See, for example, Michelangelo Antonioni's loose trilogy *L'avventura*, *La notte* (both 1961) and *L'eclisse* (1962).

23 In fact, Wearing hired actors to play police officers.

24 James Coleman, *La Tache aveugle* (1978–90).

25 Similarly, Adam Broomberg's and Oliver Chanarin's *Chicago* (2005) documents a mock Palestinian settlement built deep in the Israeli desert for the training of troops.

26 See Campany, 'Safety in Numbness'. See also Peter Wollen, 'Vectors of Melancholy', in *The Scene of the Crime*, ed. Ralph Rugoff (Cambridge, MA, and London, 1997).

27 Fredric Jameson sees Grant's movements as almost Brechtian in their estrangement. See his 'Spatial Systems in *North by Northwest*', in *Everything You Always Wanted to Know About Lacan . . . But Were Afraid To Ask Hitchcock*, ed. Slavoj Zizek (London, 1992), pp. 47–72.

28 Laura Mulvey notes that in the melodramas of Douglas Sirk, for example, the actors' performances are 'slightly marionette-like . . . to privilege gestures and looks, suspended in time'. Laura Mulvey, *Death 24x a Second: Stillness and the Moving Image* (London, 2005), p. 146.

29 Robert Bresson, *Notes on the Cinematographer* [1975] (London, 1986), pp. 4 and 22.

30 Cinema has endless versions of this scene. Two of the best known are from films by Michael Powell and Emeric Pressburger. In *Black Narcissus* (1946), Kathleen Byron plays a troubled nun with murderous passions. In the denouement she bursts through a convent door and stands there charged with rage. Her habit and veil are gone and she stares wild-eyed into the camera, her hair dancing in the mountain air. In *A Canterbury Tale* (1944), Sheila Sim stops on a hilltop on the Pilgrim's Way, seeming to hear sounds from the time of Chaucer. In the wind, she listens intently.

31 Katherine Albert, '"A Picture That Was No Picnic": Lillian Gish Has Something To Say about the Location Tortures Accompanying the Filming of "The Wind"', *Motion Picture Magazine* (October 1927).

32 Harold Evans, *Pictures on a Page: Photojournalism, Graphics and Picture Editing* (London, 1978).

33 Mike Leigh presents a similar sequence in *Secrets and Lies* (1996), in which a high-street studio photographer provokes momentary mirth in his awkward or unhappy sitters. With practised speed he snaps their smiles, fixing forever images of happiness that last barely longer than the camera's click.

34 Roland Barthes, 'The Face of Garbo' [1956], in *Mythologies* (New York, 1972).

35 Truffaut was well aware of the potentially overpowering effects of the freeze, but continued to explore its potential: ' . . . it can quickly get to be a gimmick. I stopped doing it as a visual effect after a few films. Now I use freeze frames as a dramatic effect. They're interesting provided viewers don't notice. It takes eight frames for a [still] shot to be noticed. A shot under eight frames is virtually unreadable. Unless it's a big close-up. So what I try to do now – in *La Peau Douce*, which I find satisfactory is to freeze the image for

only seven or eight frames instead of like here [Jeanne Moreau's frozen poses in *Jules et Jim*] which are frozen for thirty to thirty-five frames. So when it's a simple look frozen for seven frames it has real dramatic intensity. You can't say, just looking at it, unless you're an editor or director, "Hey a freeze frame! I'm interested in invisible effects now".' From an interview with François Truffaut in the short film *François Truffaut; ou, l'esprit critiqu*e by Jean-Pierre Chartier, 1965. In Truffaut's *Jules et Jim* (1962), Jeanne Moreau's character flirts with her boyfriends *and* the camera. She strikes a run of poses as if for a photographer and Truffaut freezes the frame briefly each time, catching the chance abandon in her hair.

two: Paper Cinema

1 Victor Burgin, 'Photography, Phantasy, Function', *Screen*, xxi/1 (Spring 1980), pp. 43–80.

2 'The Art of Living a Hundred Years: Three Interviews with M. Chevreul . . . on the Eve of his 101st Year', *Le Journal illustré* (5 September 1886). It was Felix Nadar's son Paul who actually took the photographs. The sequence was chosen from a total of 88 images. Nadar had planned to make an audio recording too, but this came to nothing and he made do with his memory of the conversation. See Michèle Auer, *Le Premier Interview photographique: Chevreul, Félix Nadar, Paul Nadar* (Paris, 1999).

3 Alvin Tolmer, *Mise en page* (London, 1932).

4 This was El Lissitzky's declaration ('The Topography of Typography', *Merzhefte*, 4, 1923):

1. The words of the printed sheet are to be seen, not heard.
2. One conveys concepts through conventional words; the concepts should be shaped by the printed letters . . .
4. The construction of the book-space . . . according to the laws of typographic mechanics must correspond to the expanding and contracting pressures of the content . . .
6. The continuous sequence of pages. The cinematic book.
7. The new book requires a new writer. The inkwell and the goose feather are dead.
8. The printed sheet overcomes space and time. The infinity of books. THE ELECTROLIBRARY.

5 The need to rework existing images extends from Dadaist and Cubist collage through Pop, Conceptualism and Postmodern art right through to the present. In 2003 Colin McCabe, speaking of Jean-Luc Godard's appropriations of film clips that comprise his *Histoire(s) du Cinéma*, suggested that 'in a world in which we are entertained from cradle to grave whether we like it or not, the ability to rework image and dialogue . . . may be the key to both psychic and political health.' Colin McCabe, *Godard: A Portrait of the Artist at 70* (London, 2003), p. 301.

6 See Philippe-Alain Michaud, 'Crossing the Frontiers: Mnemosyne between Art History and Cinema', in *Aby Warburg and the Image in Motion* (New York, 2004), pp. 277–91. Warburg's Atlas was eventually published as *Der Bilderatlas Mnemosyne*, ed. Martin Warnke and Claudia Brink (Berlin, 2000).

7 The photographer Gisèle Freund recalls demonstrating to Malraux the possible effects of photographic lighting and the cropping of sculpture in *Photographie et société* (Paris, 1974).

8 See in particular Malraux's *Le Musée imaginaire de la sculpture mondiale* (Paris, 1952), with its almost purely visual form and minimal text.

9 Beaumont Newhall, *Photography: A Short Critical History* (New York, 1937), p. 89.

10 Arnold Fanck and Hannes Schneider, *Wunder des Schneeschuhs: ein System des richtigen Skilaufens und seine Anwendung. Mit 242 Einzelbilder und 1000 Kinematographischen Reihenbilder* (Hamburg, 1925). Moholy-Nagy's *Painting, Photography, Film* also pairs film strips from Viking Eggeling's abstract animation *Diagonal Symphony* (1921–4) with longer strips of skiing by Fanck.

11 Dr Arnold Fanck, 'Photographed Movement', in the English -language supplement to *Das Deutsche Lichtbild* (Berlin, 1932), pp. 23–7.

12 Indeed, Fanck later junked the instruction and re-presented his film frames as visual spectacle in *Das Bilderbuch des Skiläufers* [The Picture-book of Skiers] (Hamburg, 1932).

13 Many of the landmarks of modernist graphic design make use of the film-strip, including Karel Teige, *Film* (Prague, 1925); Franz Roh and Jan Tschichold, *Photo Auge / Oeil et photo / Photo-Eye* (Stuttgart, 1929); Werner Gräff, *Es kommt der neue Fotograf!* (Berlin, 1929); Hans Richter, *Filmgegner von Heute – Filmfreunder von Morgen* (Berlin, 1929); A. Arrosev, *Soviet Cinema* [designed by Alexander Rodchenko and Varvara Stepanova] (Moscow, 1936); and G. Schmidt, W. Schmälenbach and P. Bächlin, *Der Film* (Basle, 1947).

14 Zapruder sold the film to the Time-Life Corporation for $150,000. *Life* magazine used the frames in several issues, including those of 29 November and 7 December 1963; 2 October 1964; 25 November 1966; and 24 November 1967. A copy of the film was made for the FBI. Bootleg copies circulated, but the first public screening was on the US television show *Goodnight America* in March 1975.

15 Pier Paolo Pasolini, 'Observations on the Long Take', *October*, 13 (1980), pp. 3–6; reprinted in *The Cinematic*, ed. David Campany (Cambridge, MA, and London, 2007).

16 Newhall, *Photography*, p. 89.

17 Brandt was un-credited in *Picture Post* for these photographs. Adopting the lighting and angles of the film, they have nothing of his own style.

18 *Lilliput*, 140 (February 1949). The directors were David Lean, Charles Crichton, The Boulting Brothers, Carol Reed, Anthony Asquith, Alberto Cavalcanti, Ronald Neame and Robert Hamer.

19 'The Perfect Parlourmaid', *Picture Post*, iv/4 (29 July 1939), pp. 43–7.

See David Campany, 'The Career of a Photographer, the Career of a Photograph: Bill Brandt's Art of the Document', in Tanya Barson et al., *Making History: Art and Documentary in Britain from 1929 to Now* (Liverpool, 2006), pp. 51–61.

20 See Stefan Lorant, *Chamberlain and the Beautiful Llama and 101 More Juxtapositions from* Lilliput (London, 1940).

21 Bill Brandt, *A Night in London: A Story in 64 Photographs* (London and Paris, 1938).

22 Brandt was impressed by Surrealist film, particularly Luis Buñuel's *Un chien andalou* (1929) and *L'Age d'or* (1930). Jennings was a part of the British Surrealist movement, out of which Mass-Observation was formed.

23 The best-known citation of the passage is by Walter Benjamin in his 'A Small History of Photography' [1929], in *One-Way Street and Other Writings* (London, 1979), pp. 240–57.

24 On this absence, see Sally Stein, 'Good Fences Make Good Neighbors: American Resistance to Photomontage between the Wars', in *Montage and Modern Life*, ed. Matthew Teitelbaum (Boston, MA, 1992), pp. 129–89.

25 Alan Trachtenburg reads Evans's sequencing through Sergei Eistenstein's theories of montage. See his *Reading American Photographs: Images as History. Matthew Brady to Walker Evans* (New York, 1989), pp. 258–9. Only the first half of the book is sequenced this way. The second half is much more of an album of collected images.

26 Lincoln Kirstein, 'Photographs of America: Walker Evans', in Walker Evans, *American Photographs* (New York, 1938), pp. 192–3.

27 Jeff Wall, '"Marks of Indifference": Aspects of Photography in, or as, Conceptual Art', in *Reconsidering the Object of Art, 1965–1975*, ed. Ann Goldstein and Anne Rorimer (Los Angeles, Cambridge, MA, and London, 1996), pp. 246–67.

28 'A Hard Look at the New Hollywood' [photographs by Robert Frank, essays by Orson Welles, Ben Hecht and Dwight McDonald], *Esquire* (March 1959), pp. 51–66.

29 There are different versions of both of these images by Frank in his book *The Americans*. There was actually a premiere taking place at the cinema the night that Frank shot the ticket taker whom *Esquire* described as looking 'lethargic'. *The Americans* includes a portrait of a glamorous fur-clad woman in front of the same Art Deco façade titled 'Hollywood Premiere'. While the general point about the decline of cinema was right, there was some licence taken in the use of the image of the ticket seller.

30 Alexey Brodovitch, *Ballet* (New York, 1945).

31 William Klein, *Life Is Good and Good for You in New York: Trance Witness Revels* (Paris and London, 1956).

32 William Klein, 'Preface', in *New York, 1954–55* (London, 1996), pp. 4–5.

33 Van der Elsken's images ran in four issues of *Picture Post* in February 1954.

34 Chris Marker, quoted by Martin Harrison's afterword in *William Klein: In and Out of Fashion* (New York, 1994), p. 249.

35 Daido Moriyama quoted in *Things as They Are: Photojournalism in Context since 1955*, ed. Mary Panzer (London, 2005), p. 178.

36 Robert Frank, *The Lines of My Hand* (New York, 1972). The book was first issued in a different design in Japan.

37 See Larry Clark, *Tulsa* (New York, 1971); Nobuyoshi Araki, *A Sentimental Journey* (Tokyo, 1971); Susan Meiselas, *Carnival Strippers* (New York, 1976); Danny Lyon, *Pictures from the New World* (Millerton, NY, 1980); Nan Goldin, *The Ballad of Sexual Dependency* (Millerton, NY, 1986); Larry Sultan, *Pictures From Home* (Boston, MA, 1992); Jim Goldberg, *Raised by Wolves* (New York, 1995); Wolfgang Tillmans, *Truth Study Center* (Cologne, 2005), Rinko Kawauchi, *The Eyes, the Ears* (Tokyo, 2005).

38 See Maitland Eddy's introductory essay in *Great Photographic Essays From Life*, ed. Constance Sullivan (Boston, MA, 1978).

39 Lollobrigida featured in what is regarded at the first *fotoromanzo*, *Nel fondo del cuore* ('Deep in My Heart'), published in 1947.

40 Blake Stimson, 'Introduction: The Photography of Social Form', in *The Pivot of the World: Photography and Its Nation* (Boston, MA, 2006), pp. 13–58. The simplicity of the photonovel and cartoon photosequence did have other advantages. In the 1970s they became useful tools in mass-literacy initiatives and public-health campaigns in Central America and the Hispanic communities in the United States. They also live on in the form of the love-story comics produced for adolescents (mainly girls), who seem to identify with the inherently awkward poise of its form, and in post-modern parodies and critiques of the form, such as the artist Suky Best's *Photo Love* (1995–7)

41 Krull's best-known narrative photo book is *La folle d'Itteville* (Paris, 1931). She supplied the images for the story by Georges Simenon.

42 Alain Robbe-Grillet, *The Immortal One*, trans. A. M. Sheridan Smith (London, 1971), pp. 5–6.

43 Jean Luc-Godard, 'Parlons de Pierrot', *Cahiers du Cinéma*, 171 (October 1965); translated as 'Let's Talk about Pierrot', in *Godard on Godard*, ed. Tom Milne (New York, 1972), pp. 215–34.

44 Jean-Luc Godard, *Journal d'une femme mariée* (Paris, 1965).

45 Alain Resnais, *Repérages* (Paris, 1974). Resnais took the photos between 1956 and 1971, many while looking for possible locations for his still unmade film based on the fictional detective Harry Dickson.

46 Jules Spinatsch, *Temporary Discomfort Chapter I–V: Davos, Genoa, New York, Evian, Geneva* (Baden, 2005).

three: Photography in Film

1 Garrett Stewart seems to have done just this in his exhaustive *Between Film and Still: Modernism's Photo Synthesis* (Chicago, IL, 1999).

2 'In the daily flood of photographs, in the thousand forms of interest they seem to provoke, it may be that the *noeme "That has been"*

is not repressed (a *noeme* cannot be repressed) but experienced with indifference, as a feature which goes without saying.' Roland Barthes, *Camera Lucida: Reflections on Photography* (New York, 1980), chapter 32.

3 Ibid.

4 Raymond Bellour, 'The Pensive Spectator', *Wide Angle*, IX/1 (1987), pp. 6–10; reprinted in *The Cinematic*, ed. David Campany (Cambridge, MA, and London, 2007).

5 André Bazin, the realist critic who championed Rossellini's work, wrote the essay that became the cornerstone of realist accounts of cinema the year after *La macchina ammazzacattivi*. In 'The Ontology of the Photographic Image' (1949), Bazin argues that what distinguishes the photographic image is its status as a direct trace of life, like a death mask.

6 Nancy West and Penelope Pelizzon make this calculation in 'Snap Me Deadly: Reading the Still in Film Noir', *American Studies*, XLIII/2 (Summer 2002), pp. 73–101.

7 'If the purpose is to counter those, real or imagined, who bluntly claim that photographs never lie, then the counter only replaces the Village Idiot by the Village Explainer. There must be some more attractive purpose. I believe the motto serves to cover an impressive range of anxieties centered on, or symptomatized by, our sense of how little we know about what the photograph reveals: that we do not know what our relation to reality is, our complicity in it . . . that we do not understand the specific transformative powers of the camera, what I have called its original violence; that we cannot anticipate what it will know of us or show of us.' Stanley Cavell, 'What Photography Calls Thinking', *Raritan*, IV/4 (1985), pp. 1–21.

8 The title sequence of *La Jetée* tells us it is a 'photo-roman', while a later book version of the film describes itself as 'ciné-roman'. See Chris Marker, *La Jetée: ciné-roman* (New York, 1992). Marker also produced a page version in image and text for the French magazine *L'Avant-scène*, 36 (1964), pp. 23–30.

9 *La Jetée* has become one of the most discussed and theorized short films. See in particular Victor Burgin, 'Marker Marked', in *The Remembered Film* (London, 2005), pp. 89–108; Uriel Orlow, 'The Dialectical Image: *La Jetée* and Photography-as-Cinema' [1999, revised 2007], in *The Cinematic*, ed. Campany, pp. 177–84; and Jean-Louis Scheffer, 'On *La Jetée*', *The Enigmatic Body: Essays on the Arts* (Cambridge, 1995), pp. 139–45.

10 Réda Bensmaïa makes this interpretation of the gaps between *La Jetée*'s stills in 'From the Photogram to the Pictogram', *Camera Obscura*, 24 (September 1990), pp. 138–61.

11 Irving Blum recalls his experience of the premiere of Warhol's *Sleep* in an interview with Patrick Smith in Smith, *Andy Warhol's Art and Film* (Ann Arbor, MI, 1981), pp. 223–4. 'Marisol' is the artist Marisol Escobar who kisses Harold Stevenson in the film.

12 The book of Sander's work that we see in the film is the anthology *Menschen des 20. Jahrhunderts Gesamtausgabe Fotos* [Citizens of the Twentieth Century]. It is the grand album that Sander himself never managed to publish in his lifetime, because of the intervention of the war and the confiscation of his work by the Nazis.

13 The moment brings to mind Jean-François Lyotard's remarks about the fate of documents: 'Reality succumbs to this reversal: it was the given described by the phrase, it became the archive from which are drawn documents or examples that validate the description.' Jean-François Lyotard, *The Differend: Phrases in Dispute* (Minneapolis, MN, 1988), p. 41.

14 *Letter to Jane* was a development of Godard's critique of news photographs in his *Ciné-Tracts*, a series of eight three-minute films produced quickly in 1968.

15 Jean-Luc Godard and Jean Pierre Gorin, 'Retour de Hanoi: Excerpts from the Transcript of Godard and Gorin's *Letter to Jane*', *Women and Film*, I/3–4 (1973), pp. 45–51. For a detailed discussion, see Julia Lesage, 'Godard and Gorin's Left Politics, 1967–1972', *Jump Cut*, 28 (April 1983), pp. 51–8.

16 See, for example, Carol Davidson, 'A Critique: *Letter to Jane*', in *Women and Film*, I/3–4 (1973), p. 52.

17 See 'Speaking of Pictures', *Life* (19 February 1940), pp. 10–11. The year before, *Life* had run a piece on Steinbeck's novel *The Grapes of Wrath*, suggesting that 'never before had the facts behind a great work of fiction been so carefully researched by the news camera' (*Life*, 5 June 1939).

18 Mouris' *Frank Film* won the 'Oscar' for best animated short film in 1973.

19 A second poster for *The Truman Show* featured a crowd watching the face of a sleeping Truman on a huge public video screen, making Andy Warhol's film *Sleep* seem all the more prophetic.

20 This is perhaps why Robert Altman's fashion satire *Prêt-à-Porter* from 1994 falls a little flat. It underestimated just how well inoculated from criticism the industry had become.

21 For example, in Sidney Lumet's *The Verdict* (1982) we see a lawyer played by Paul Newman taking a Polaroid photograph of a dying woman. It is only as he/we watch as the image appears that the full force of her mortality is felt.

22 Even so, the hero of *Memento* must supplement his Polaroids with copious notes written on them. Not even Polaroid facts explain. They require explanation.

23 Fredric Jameson makes a brilliant analysis of cinema's crisis of visuality engendered by the replacement of analogue technologies by digital ones in 'Totality as Conspiracy', in *The Geopolitical Aesthetic: Cinema and Space in the World System* (Bloomington, IN, 1992), pp. 9–84.

24 The photographs of the murder that the photographer blows up in his darkroom were taken for the film by the photojournalist Don McCullin.

four: Art and the Film Still

1 Clement Greenberg, 'The Camera's Glass Eye: A Review of an Exhibition of Edward Weston', *The Nation* (9 March 1946); reprinted in *Art and Photography*, ed. David Campany (London, 2003), pp. 222–3.

2 I discuss this idea in more detail in 'Straight Images, Crooked World', in *So Now Then*, ed. Christopher Coppock and Paul Seawright (Cardiff, 2006), pp. 8–11.

3 John Swope, *Camera Over Hollywood* (New York, 1939). This particular photograph was taken in 1937. Margaret Bourke-White also photographed MGM back lots in 1937, including the same sets as Weston and Swope; see 'Sound Stages Hum with Work on Movies for 1938', *Life* (27 December 1937), pp. 39–46. Forty years later the artist John Divola documented MGM's unused and derelict New York back lot at Culver City, California (see *www.divola.com*).

4 Mary Ellen Mark, *Ward 81* (New York, 1979).

5 See *Thumbsucker: Photography from the Film by Mike Mills* (New York, 2005); *Babel: A Film by Alejandro Gonzales Inarritu* [photographs by Mary Ellen Mark, Patrick Bard, Graciela Iturbide and Miguel Rio Branco] (Cologne, 2006); and Gautier Deblond, *Morvern Callar* (London, 2002).

6 The other photographers were Cornell Capa, Bruce Davidson, Ernst Haas, Erich Hartmann and Dennis Stock. See Serge Toubiana, *The Misfits* (London, 2002), and George Kouvaros, *'The Misfits*: What Happened around the Camera', *Film Quarterly*, LV/4 (Summer 2002), pp. 28–33.

7 See James Goode, *The Story of the Misfits* (Indianapolis, IN, 1963).

8 See Anne Hoy, ed., *Annie on Camera* (New York, 1982). The other photographers were Jane O'Neal, Neal Slavin, Eric Staller and Robert Walker. The project was the idea of the film's producer, Ray Stark.

9 Using photographs as reference is common practice is film production design. Twenty years after *Annie*, Jacob Riis's photographs were again used as reference for the sets of Martin Scorsese's *Gangs of New York* (2002), built at Cinecittà, Rome. Stephen Shore's photograph reworks the composition of Paul Strand's *The Lusetti Family, Luzzara, Italy* (1953).

10 I trace this historical difference, which was once very real, between 'art photographers' and 'artists using photography' in *Art and Photography*, pp. 16–20.

11 Jeff Wall, 'Interview / Lecture', *Transcript*, II/3 (1996).

12 Zoe Leonard and Cheryl Dunye, *The Fae Richards Photo Archive* (San Francisco, 1996); *The Watermelon Woman* (Cheryl Dunye, 1996).

13 'Make it big' is a literal Urdu translation of 'blow up', which also hints at the aspiration of the project.

14 John Divola, *Continuity* (New York, 1998).

15 In 1978 Divola visited the abandoned 'New York' back lot built by MGM in Culver City outside Hollywood (location shooting had become cheaper and audiences preferred it). He photographed the flimsy façades, derelict cars and fake boulders. The back lot was falling into ruin and was demolished shortly after. See David Campany, '*Who, What, Where, With What, Why, How and When?* The Forensic Rituals of John Divola', in *John Divola: Three Acts* (New York, 2006).

16 Roland Barthes, 'The Third Meaning: Research Notes on Some Eisenstein Stills', *Artforum*, IX/5 (January 1973). First published as 'Le troisième sens', *Cahiers du cinéma*, 222 (July 1970).

17 There are echoes here of Walter Benjamin's notion of the 'optical unconscious' that might be brought to the surface of things when the high-speed shutter or close-up lens appear to penetrate the obvious meanings of the world and reveal something deeper. Walter Benjamin, 'A Small History of Photography' [1931], in *One Way Street* (London, 1979), pp. 240–57.

18 Wall discusses his relation to cinema and the still in 'Frames of Reference', *Artforum* (September 2003), pp. 188–93.

19 See John Stezaker, 'The Film Still and Its Double', in *Stillness and Time: Photography and the Moving Image*, ed. David Green and Joanna Lowry (Brighton, 2006); and David Campany, 'Once More for Stills', in *Paper Dreams: The Lost Art of Hollywood Still Photography*, ed. Christoph Schifferli (Göttingen, 2006).

20 'It was not a question of imitating cinematic techniques or making pictures that resembled film stills. It was only a question of following the thread of recognition that films were made from photographs and were essentially acts of photography.' Jeff Wall, 'Frames of Reference', pp. 188–93.

21 The former method was used in the making of *Volunteer* (1996), a photograph of a tired man mopping the floor of a community centre, the latter in the making of *Eviction Struggle* (1988) and *Outburst* (1986), a photograph of a sweatshop boss exploding with rage at an employee. See 'Posing, Acting and Photography', in *Stillness and Time*, ed. Green and Lowry.

22 Of course, the convention goes a long way back in the history of art. Think of the odd but pictorially natural way in which the disciples sit along just one side of the table in depictions of the *Last Supper*.

23 Roger Callois, 'Mimicry and Legendary Psychasthenia', *October*, 31 (1984), pp. 17–32; Henri Bergson, 'The Intensity of Psychic States', in *Time and Free Will: An Essay on the Immediate Data of Consciousness* (London, 1910).

24 In 1995 a full set of Sherman's 65 *Untitled Film Stills* sold to the Museum of Modern Art in New York for a million dollars (far more than any 'real' film stills).

25 See the email exchange between Jeff Wall and the filmmaker Mike Figgis in *The Cinematic*, ed. David Campany (Cambridge, MA, and London, 2007), pp. 158–67.

26 For a visual definition of film noir, see J. A. Place and L. S. Petersen, 'Some Visual Motifs in *Film Noir*', in *Movies and Methods*,

ed. Bill Nichols (Los Angeles, 1976), pp. 325–38; for a non-visual definition, see Slavoj Zizek, '"The Thing That Thinks": The Kantian Background of the Noir Subject', in *Shades of Noir: A Reader*, ed. Joan Copjec (London, 1993), pp. 199–226.

27 See David Green's illuminating discussion of 'this' in 'Marking Time: Photography, Film and Temporalities of the Image', in *Stillness and Time*, ed. Green and Lowry, and David Campany, 'Glass Camouflage: Photography of Objects, Photography as Object', in *The Ecstasy of Things: From Functional Object to Fetish in Twentieth Century Photography*, exh. cat., Museum Winterthur Steid (2004).

28 Sekula has developed a highly reflexive documentary practice, but it owes little to the history of documentary photography. Instead, he has looked to experimental documentary film, notably the work of Chris Marker, Fernando Solanas, Jean-Luc Godard and Jean Rouch. See Benjamin Buchloh's conversation with the artist in *Allan Sekula: Performance under Working Conditions*, ed. Sabine Breitwieser, Generali Foundation (Vienna, 2003), pp. 20–55.

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Index

Abbott, Berenice 126
Ahtila, Eija-Liisa 39
Akerman, Chantal 37
Altman, Robert, 90
Antonioni, Michelangelo 37, 55, *57*, 69, 112, 112, 115, *116*, *117*, 118, 131, 139
Araki, Nobuyoshi 82
Arbus, Diane 143
Arnold, Eve 124
Atget, Eugène 9, 26, 88, 144

Bacon, Lloyd *114*
Bailey, David 118
Baldessari, John 126, 127, *128*
Bard, Patrick 124
Barthes, Roland 54, 96, 134, 135, 136
Baudrillard, Jean 114
Beckett, Samuel 94, *95*
Bellour, Raymond 88, 96
Bergman, Ingmar 37
Bergson, Henri 139
Biermann, Aenne 9
Blum, Irving 101
Boileau, Pierre and Thomas Narcejac 90
books 26, *30*, *33*, *35*, 60–93, *131*
Borthwick, Mark 124
Brady, Matthew 49
Brandt, Bill 69, 70, *71*, *72*
Brecht, Bertolt 72–3
Bresson, Robert 37, *48*
Brodovitch, Alexey 75, *76*
Bruguière, Francis 10
Burgin, Victor 39, 41, *42–3*, 60, 90– 91, *92*, 126

Cagney, James *114*
Callois, Roger 139
Carrey, Jim *110*, *111*
Cartier-Bresson, Henri 25–9, 74, 124
Chaplin, Charlie 9, 70, *71*
Chardin, Jean-Baptiste Siméon 139
Charlesworth, Bruce 126
Charlesworth, Sarah 126
chronophotography 22–4
Cinématographe 7–8, 22
cinematography 18, 22, 27, 32, 34, 122,137
Claerbout, David 39
Clair, Réné 9
Clark, Larry 82
Cocteau, Jean 17–18
Cole, Todd 124
Coleman, James 39
Connell, Will 15, *16*
Crewdson, Gregory 140, *140,* 141
Cumming, Robert 120, *122*
Curtiz, Michael 141

Davies, Terence 37
Dawood, Shezad 131, *132*
death 57, 96, 97, 99
Deblonde, Gautier 124
Debord, Guy 36, 114
Deleuze, Gilles 18
De Palma, Brian *69*
Dijkstra, Rineke 143
Divola, John 132–3, *133*
Donen, Stanley 54, *56*
Douglas, Stan 39
Doyle, Christopher 122, *123*
Dreyer, Carl Theodor 9
Dunye, Cheryl 129, *131*
DVD 12, 40, 86

Eggleston, William 124
Eisenstein, Sergei 9, 29, 134
Ekberg, Anita *15*
Epstein, Mitch 124
Erwitt, Elliott 124
Evans, Walker 73, *74*, 143

Fanck, Arnold, 65, *66*
fashion imagery 9, 19, 50, 54–56, *80*, 96, 110, 112, 116–18, 141, 143
Fellini, Federico, 13, *14*, *15*
fetishism 11
Figgis, Mike 16
Film und Foto 9, 10, 63
film stills 19–20, 50–51, 63, 70, 83, 119–44
Forman, Milos 124
fotoromanzo 14, 83, *85 see also photo-roman*
found images 12, 126–33
Frampton, Hollis 36
Frank, Robert 10, 74–5, 77, 82

Gable, Clark 124

Garbo, Greta 49, *50*, *51*, 54, 55, 70
Gasparini, Paolo 90, *91*
Gish, Lillian 50–51, *52*
Godard, Jean-Luc 29, 34, 86, *87*, 103, 104, *105*, *106*
Goldberg, Jim 82
Gordon, Douglas *39*
Gorin, Jean-Pierre 104, *105*
Grant, Cary 47, *48*,
Greenberg, Clement 119

Hamilton, Richard 126
Haynes, Todd 141
Heartfield, John *9*, 73
Heche, Anne, 122, *123*
Hemmings, David 118
Hilliard, John 126
Hine, Lewis 126
history 27, 36, 69, 90, 95, 98, 99, 102, 107, 123
Hitchcock, Alfred 19, *20*, 39, 47, *48*, 88, 90, 99, *106*, 110, 114, *115*, 121, 141
Hitler, Adolf 70, *71*
Höch, Hannah 9
Homma, Takashi 124
Hsaio-Hsien, Hou 37
Huillet, Danièle and Jean-Marie Straub 37
Huston, John 124

Iñárritu, Alejandro González 124
Isherwood, Christopher 25, 34
Iturbide, Graciela 124

Jennings, Humphrey 72

Kawauchi, Rinko 82
Keaton, Buster 16, 49, 94, *95*
Kelly, Grace, 19, *20*
Kirstein, Lincoln 73–4
Kisch, Irwin 34, *35*
Klein, William 10, 76, *78*, 79, 80
Kobal, John 127
Kracauer, Siegfried, 32, 62, 114
Krull, Germaine 9, 84, *85*
Kubrick, Stanley 37, 83, *84*

Lang, Fritz 97, *98*
Lê, An-My 46
Leonard, Zoe 129, *131*
Lerski, Helmar *31*, 32
Levitt, Helen 10
Lewis, Mark 39, 40, *41*
Liang, Tsai-Ming 37
Lissitzsky, El 6, 62, 63
Lockhart, Sharon 39
Lollobrigida, Gina 83
'long takes' in film 17, 18, 20, 36, 37, 40, 55, 68, 118,
Longo, Robert 126
Lorant, Stefan 69–70, *71*
Loren, Sophia 83
Lumière, Auguste and Louis *7*, 8, 19, 22, 24, 40, 62, 146
Lyon, Danny 82

McCullin, Don 51, *53*
McGinley, Ryan 124
Macmillan, Tim 58, *59*
Malraux, André 63, *64*
Mamoulian, Rouben 49, *50*, *51*
Man Ray, 9, 10
Marey, Etienne-Jules 22, *23*, 27, 59
Mark, Mary Ellen 124
Marker, Chris 79, 99, *100*, 101
memory 74, 88, 90, 92, 95, 98–110, 121
Mendes, Sam 97, *98*
Meirelles, Fernando 90
Metz, Christian 11
Meyerowitz, Joel, 45, 124
Mills, Mike 124
Moholy-Nagy, László 9, 10, 63, 64, *65*
Monroe, Marilyn 124, *125*
montage 9, 10, 18, 29–36, 49, 63, 69–74, 115, 118
Moore, Julianne, *140*, 141
Morath, Inge 124
Moriyama, Daido 79, *81*
Morrison, Bill *12*
Mouris, Frank 108, *109*
movement 7–8, 11, 13–18, 22–42, 47–59, 134–144
Muybridge, Eadweard 22, *23*, 24, 27, 59, 66

Nadar, Paul *61*
narrative 8, 11, 17, 19, 36, 37–44, 47, 49, 61, 73, 78, 83, 86, 129, 136–9
Nolan, Christopher 97, 112, 113
Norfolk, Simon *45*

Ozu, Yasujiro 18, 37

paparazzi 15
Pasolini, Pier Paolo 37, 68
photojournalism 19, 20, 28, 47, 112, 114, 115, 123, 124
photo-roman 127
photographers (depicted in films) 13–16, 19, 96–8, 114–18, 131–2